



ANNUAL REPORT

2024-2025

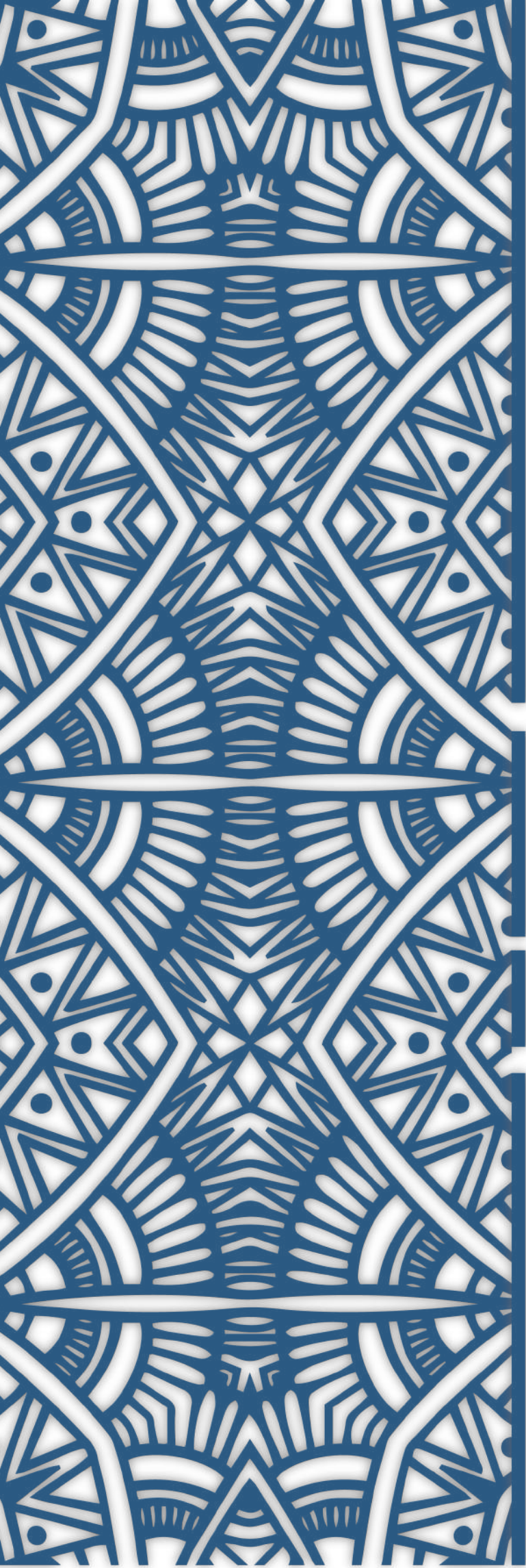


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MISSION

SECTION A

VISION

A bargaining council
positioned to advance and
influence change in the labour market environment.

MISSION

Promoting sound labour
relations through collective
bargaining and dispute
management both locally and internationally.



OUR VISION

CHAIRPERSON'S RECOGNITION TRIBUTE

In Memoriam: Ms Sebolelo Ingrid Dimo

Chairperson of the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (2018–2025)



It is with deep sorrow and profound respect that the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council records the passing of its esteemed Chairperson, Ms Sebolelo Ingrid Dimo, who passed away in March 2025.

Ms Dimo served the PSCBC with distinction from 2018 until her untimely passing, becoming the first female Chairperson of the Council. Her unanimous appointment reflected the high regard in which she was held across Employer and Labour constituencies, and her tenure was marked by principled leadership, wisdom, and an unwavering commitment to fairness and social justice.

A stalwart of South Africa's labour relations landscape, Ms Dimo brought more than two decades of experience in labour law, human resources management, and dispute resolution across both the public and private sectors. Her leadership was characterised by integrity, inclusivity, and an exceptional ability to foster constructive dialogue, even in the most complex negotiations. Under her stewardship, the PSCBC advanced key collective agreements that strengthened labour stability in the public service and contributed meaningfully to improved working conditions for public servants.

Ms Dimo's professional achievements were underpinned by strong academic credentials, including a Master's Degree in Labour Law, a Bachelor of Laws (LLB), and several postgraduate qualifications. A passionate advocate for lifelong learning and institutional excellence, she continuously sought to elevate the professionalism of labour relations structures.

Beyond the PSCBC, Ms Dimo served in several influential roles within the labour relations community, including as General Secretary of the National Bargaining Council for the Chemical Industry, Chairperson of the National Association of Bargaining Councils, and as a commissioner across various sectoral bargaining councils. Her contribution to collective bargaining and dispute resolution has left a lasting imprint on South Africa's labour relations framework.

Following her passing on 2 March 2025, the PSCBC hosted a memorial service attended by representatives from Employer and Labour parties, Sector Bargaining Councils, the Commission for Conciliation, Mediation and Arbitration, and other key stakeholders. Tributes paid during the service reflected on her historic leadership, her role in concluding recent collective agreements, and her unwavering dedication to unity and solution-driven engagement. She was also celebrated as a tireless advocate for women's empowerment and a mentor to emerging leaders.

To those who worked alongside her, Ms Ingrid Dimo was more than a Chairperson—she was a mentor, a trailblazer, and a compassionate leader whose warmth and humility endeared her to many.

The PSCBC extends its heartfelt condolences to her husband, Harry; her children, Lerato and Oratilwe; her sister, Tshidi; and her extended family. While the Council mourns the loss of an exceptional leader, it honours and celebrates the enduring legacy she leaves behind. Her commitment to justice, dignity, and unity will continue to guide the work of the PSCBC in the years ahead.

**Ingrid, your legacy of service, leadership, and fairness will
forever be etched into the heart of this Council.**

May your soul rest in eternal peace.

FOREWORD BY THE GENERAL SECRETARY



Mr Frikkie De Bruin

It is my pleasure to present this Annual Report, highlighting the major activities that the PSCBC has embarked on during the 2024/2025 financial year in accomplishing its mandate of promoting labour peace in the public service. As clearly stated in our mission, the promotion of labour peace through collective bargaining and dispute management remains our top priority. During this reporting period, Council facilitated and successfully concluded the following key collective agreements:

PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2024: Amendment to Resolution 3 of 2017 Negotiation Protocol Agreement: Wage Negotiation Process. This resolution amended the existing negotiation protocol to improve the efficiency and structure of wage negotiations in the public service.

PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2025: Agreement on the Payment of Salary Adjustments and Improvement of Conditions of Service in the Public Service. This resolution secured a 5.5% salary increase for public servants for the 2025/2026 financial year and committed to CPI-linked increases for the 2026/27 and 2027/28 periods. It also included adjustments to housing, medical aid, danger, and police service allowances.

PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025: Agreement on Matters Referred to a Further Process for Research, Investigation, and Negotiations in the Financial Year 2025/2026. This resolution earmarked several important issues for further work, including the death grant, breastfeeding and childcare facilities, recruitment policy, bursary scheme for dependents, standardisation of uniforms, the incentive framework, and comprehensive danger insurance.

Council also continued its implementation of the Public Service Summit Declaration, and to that effect, a National Task Team remained active. The task team had previously created four workstreams: Collective Agreements, Professionalisation, 4IR, and women, youth and people with disabilities. These workstreams continued to drive progress on strategic themes critical to the evolution of the public service.

Consistent with Council's tradition, a debriefing session was held post-wage negotiations to reflect on the process, identify challenges, and recommend improvements. This year's debriefing took place on the 12-13 March at Kievits Kroon.

Council convened multiple Executive Committee and Council meetings, as well as the Annual General Meeting (AGM) on the 13th of June 2024, during which the Annual Report for the previous financial year was presented and endorsed. Leadership of the Council remained stable, with Ingrid Dimo continuing as Chairperson, ably supported by two Vice-Chairs: Aubrey Zungu representing Labour, and Mompoti Galorale representing the Employer.

A major achievement was the continued rollout and enhancement of the PSCBC e-referral platform, making it easier for users to access Council services.

The Dispute Management Unit recorded a 6% decrease in the referral rate during the 2024/2025 financial year. From 1 April 2024 to 31 March 2025, a total of 401 referrals were captured and screened, compared to 426 referrals in the previous reporting period. This slight decline reflects ongoing efforts to resolve disputes efficiently and promote labour peace within the public service.

The Finance Committee (FINCOM) exercised strong oversight over Council's finances. Independent auditors, BDO South Africa, confirmed the accuracy of our financial statements, reaffirming our sound financial position.

During the 2024/2025 financial year, significant progress was made in the development of the new PSCBC Office Park. Key milestones included the completion of bulk service contributions, and the connection and installation of electricity and water meters. The City of Tshwane approved the rezoning and consolidation rights after the PSCBC successfully navigated a series of complex town planning processes. The Executive Committee reviewed stage two of the development, which encompassed the architectural concept design and space planning needs. Funding for the project will be drawn from Council's investment savings, with any additional funding requirements to be submitted for Executive Committee approval. The project is slated to commence in the third quarter of the 2025/2026 fiscal year, with finalization of project costs and appointment of the building contractor currently underway.



Council invested heavily in Capacity development, with Members participating in several strategic workshops and Conferences, including:

- National Certificate in Public Administration – Procurement (NQF level 5)
- Skills Programme: Apply Labour and Dispute Prevention Approaches (NQF level 6)
- Sage Pastel Essential of Leave and Absenteeism Seminar
- POPIA Act Regulatory short courses (ENS Africa)
- Result Driven Monitoring- and Evaluation Training (Prospen Africa)
- Advanced Executive Secretaries and PA's Master Class (Global Business Events and Training)
- Employee Health, Wellness and HIV/AIDS Conference
- Biennial SAMEA Conference
- Skills Programme in Advance Accounting
- National School of Governance training programmes (Basic Writing for Government, Advance Writing for Government, Know and Live our Constitution, Introduction to Strategic Planning and Management)

Staff development continued through the PSCBC bursary scheme, with several staff members successfully completing formal qualifications. The Council remains committed to staff development and received positive feedback from PSETA, with an approved WSP for 2024/2025 and ATR for 2023/2024. Through this partnership, two staff members were afforded the opportunity to pursue National Certificate qualifications, reinforcing our focus on skills growth and capacity building.

In terms of Corporate Social Responsibility, Council undertook impactful initiatives in identified communities, the details of which are covered in the Communications section of this report.

The Communications Unit also played a vital role in enhancing our digital presence, strengthening stakeholder engagement, and promoting the Council's brand.

In conclusion, I wish to acknowledge the commitment and leadership of Council, the Executive Committee, all stakeholders, and the secretariat staff, whose collective contributions have ensured that the PSCBC continues to fulfil its constitutional mandate and strategic objectives.



MESSAGE FROM THE VICE CHAIRPERSON: EMPLOYER



As we reflect on the 2024/2025 financial year, it is with great pride that I acknowledge the strides we have made in strengthening labour relations and promoting a workplace culture grounded in dignity, mutual respect, and productivity.

This year has been marked by both challenge and opportunity. Amid shifting economic pressures and evolving workforce dynamics, our commitment to constructive engagement and social dialogue has remained steadfast. Through strategic collaboration with our labour counterparts, we have successfully advanced initiatives that support fair labour practices, responsive human resource strategies, and the wellbeing of our public servants.

The Employer's representation remains focused on building a capable, ethical, and developmental state. Our efforts in the bargaining council have contributed to improved service delivery, organisational efficiency, and the empowerment of our workforce. I am especially proud of our joint initiatives in wellness, capacity building, and inclusive policy development.

As we look ahead, let us recommit to the principles of transparency, equity, and progressive labour relations. I extend sincere appreciation to all parties, stakeholders, and employees who have made this year's achievements possible. Together, we continue to build a resilient and future-ready public service.

Mompoti Galorale

MESSAGE FROM THE VICE CHAIRPERSON: LABOUR



The 2024/2025 reporting period has underscored the power of collective voice and the importance of principled, values-driven engagement within the labour space. As Vice Chair representing Labour, I am proud to reflect on a year in which worker empowerment, social justice, and shared responsibility have remained central to our work.

We entered this year with a firm mandate: to safeguard the rights of workers while advancing conditions that enhance dignity, equity, and wellbeing across all spheres of public service. Through tireless advocacy and meaningful dialogue, we have helped shape agreements and frameworks that speak to the lived realities of our members, from mental health and safety, to fair remuneration and inclusive workplace policies.

This year, we also deepened our focus on building resilient leadership at all levels, recognizing that empowered workers contribute directly to a capable and ethical public sector. Our collaboration with the employer counterparts, while not without its challenges, has demonstrated that mutual respect and constructive disagreement can yield sustainable solutions.

To the workers we serve: your strength and commitment remain our guiding force. Let us move forward with courage, unity, and a renewed commitment to transformation and justice in the workplace.

Aubrey Zungu



SECTION B

OUR ORGANISATION



OUR ORGANISATION

The PSCBC operates under the governance structures of Council and EXCO. These comprise equal representation of Employer and Labour. The operations of Council are executed through 6 units/departments:

- Collective Bargaining
- Dispute Management
- Resident Panellist
- Strategic Monitoring & Evaluation
- Corporate Services
- Information Communications Technology

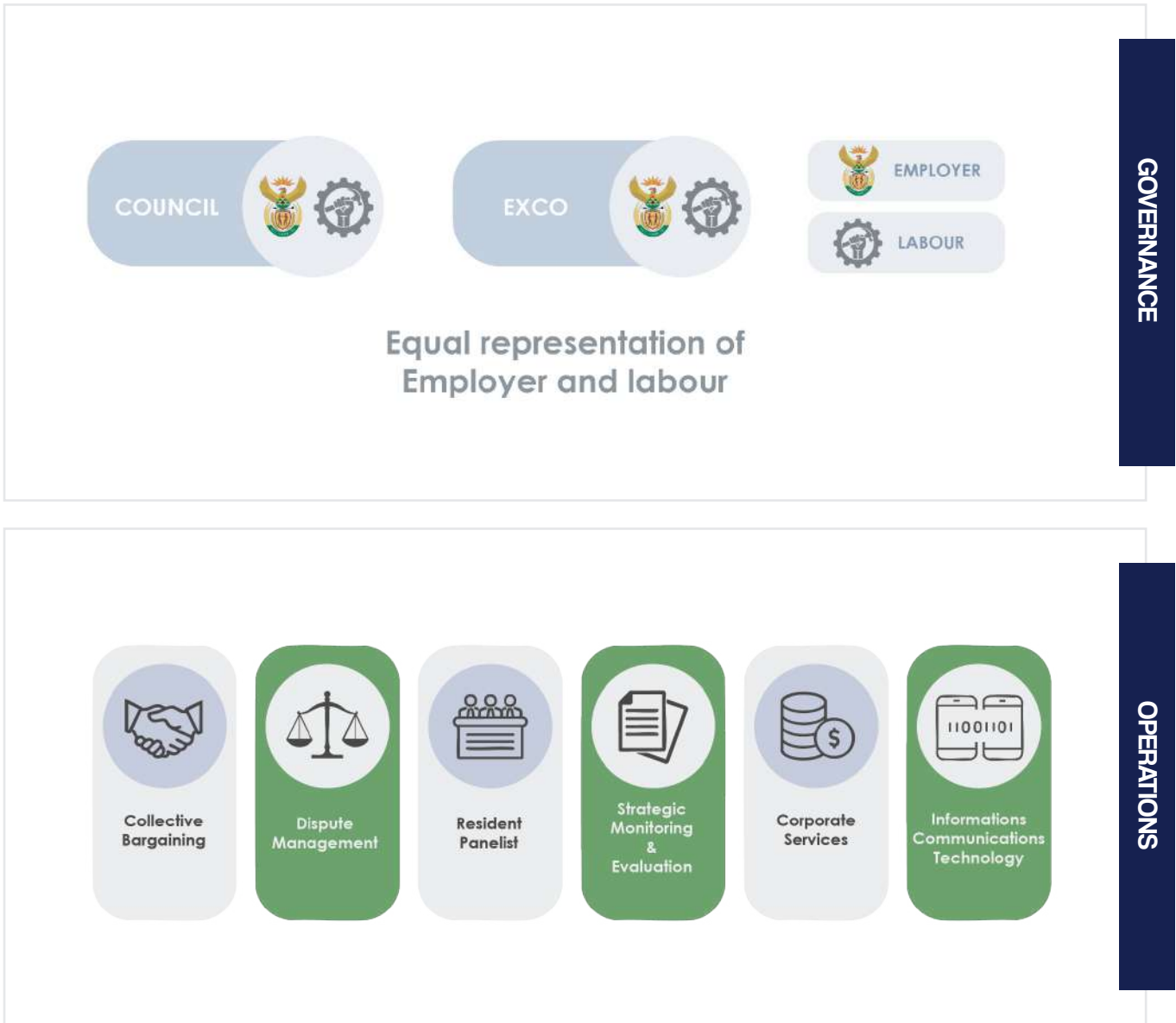
OUR STAKEHOLDER LANDSCAPE:

The parties to the PSCBC consist of 50% representation by both the employer and labour (trade unions). This ensures that the PSCBC always remains impartial. Some trade unions act together with other unions.

The main trade unions are represented below.



AN OVERVIEW OF OUR ORGANISATION:



UNIT	MANDATE
COLLECTIVE BARGAINING	To provide effective and efficient platforms through which the structures of the PSCBC (Council, Executive Committee and provincial Co-ordinating Chambers) can bargain and conclude agreements on matters of mutual interest within the public service
DISPUTE MANAGEMENT	To perform dispute resolution functions in terms of Section 127 of the LRA
RESIDENT PANELLIST	To provide in-house legal expertise in support of the dispute management unit

STRATEGIC MONITORING AND EVALUATION	To provide a technical support function through the monitoring and tracking of all activities across different structures of the council the (Council, the Executive Committee, Chambers, Committees and Units). This includes the development of implementation plans, tracking of associated timelines and reporting on these. The unit also guides research and the strategic initiatives of the organisation
CORPORATE SERVICES	To enable the PSCBC to achieve its core mandate through the provision of finance, human capital, procurement
INFORMATION COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY	To create a unified and sustainable brand image by communicating clear and concise messages using relevant communication channels. This is with the aim to craft a strong brand for the council and promote it strategically, both nationally and internationally and oversee all IT services



GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

The executive committee of the council is appointed as per clause 19 of the PSCBC constitution, elected yearly at the PSCBC Annual General Meeting, to serve on a 12 month term. Its mandate is to manage council's operations and ensure balanced representation and decision-making on collective bargaining, enforcement of agreements, and administrative duties and related powers in the constitution.



Ms Claudia Sekgoele



Mr Modise Lesley Letsatsi



Ms Mandisa Matyila



Mr Andrew Makape



Ms Louise Esterhuyse



Mr Percy Tshabane



Adv Beauty Chidi



Mr Johan Griesel



Mr Given Mabuza



Mr Sean McGladdery



Mr Gregory Masondo



Mr Basil Manuel



Mr Claude Naicker



Mr Jannie Oosthuizen



Mr David Phala



Ms Maipato Morake

FINANCIAL COMMITTEE

The Financial Committee has been established as a sub-Committee of the Council. The role of the Finance Committee is to scrutinise the financial activities of the Council and to make recommendations to the Executive Committee on these activities.

The Duties of the Financial Committee listed below are found in the Finance Policy and Procedure Manual Formulate financial policies and procedures;

- Recommend practical ways of implementing these policies;
- Review budgets and recommend to the Council;
- Review financial statements and ensure that financial policies and procedures are adhered to;
- Discuss the audited financial statements and management report with the auditors;
- Consider and recommend the acquisition of capital expenditure items within the budget;
- Discuss and manage the expenditure of special projects; and
- Cash flow management (including treasury functions).



Lindiwe Motshwane
SADTU



Herman Brynard
DPSA



Peter Sekutu
NEHAWU



Andile Mnone
DPSA



Flavia Mokoena
National Treasury



Linda Katz-Hulana
DENOSA





SECTION C



COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

As a key operational component of the PSCBC, the Collective Bargaining Unit continues to promote and encourage centralised collective bargaining in the public service. The Unit continues to deliver on the mandate to provide efficient collective bargaining platforms empowering the Council, Executive Committee, and Provincial Coordinating Chambers of the PSCBC to take up dialogue on matters pertinent in the public service.

Through these platforms the Unit has been able to ensure continuity on the issues, facilitated decision making, and the conclusion of agreements all geared towards the betterment of the public service.

The Unit has also been hard at work operationalising the Trade Union Membership Section by clarifying its core roles and responsibilities.

This report provides a summary of the Unit's activities during the reporting period, with specific focus on:

- Council and Executive Committee Activities
- 2024/2025 Resolutions
- Reports of Co-ordinating Chambers of the PSCBC
- Committees' Reports.
- Capacity Building for Parties to Council
- Trade Union Membership Management
- The Year Ahead

COUNCIL AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE ACTIVITIES:

31 March 2025 marked the conclusion of PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2023 (Agreement on the payment of a Salary Adjustment in the Public Service for the Financial Years 2023/2024 and 2024/2025) paving way for the new cycle of the salary negotiations. Despite the negotiations process, the Executive Committee and Council managed to convene to address other matters that were pertinent in the public service.

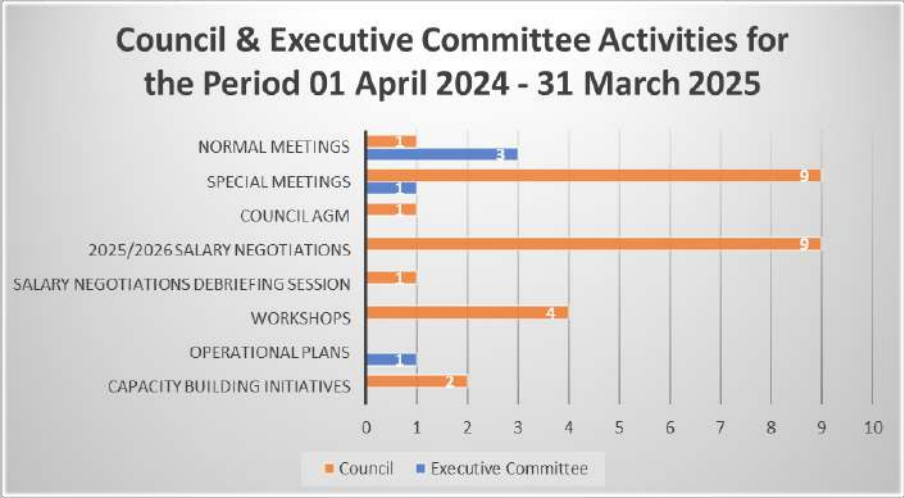
This reporting period saw several initiatives aimed at strengthening the Executive Committee and Council's functionality.

COUNCIL HOSTED WORKSHOPS ON THE FOLLOWING MATTERS:

- Two-Pot Retirement System to clarify the confusion around the initial amount that members could access and the process of accessing such an amount (24 April 2024).
- Legislation governing medical schemes to better understand the medical schemes' industry, trends and the Medical Schemes Act, to be in a position to engage GEMS from an informed position (23 July 2024).
- Implementation of the National Health Insurance (NHI) Bill, to better understand the impact on medical aid schemes and the public service healthcare system, the potential benefits, and the challenges that may arise during implementation (16 April 2024)
- Strategic Engagement with the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS), to review GEMS's compliance with its founding principles of accessibility and affordability, transformation, identify key operational hurdles, and establish a roadmap for future progress.

The Executive Committee had an operation planning session to focus on governance issues and to reflect on the operational performance of the Council in terms of the current strategic objectives of the Organisation.

These efforts positioned both the Council and Executive Committee for greater efficiency and effectiveness.



RESOLUTIONS:

2024/2025

Council concluded three (3) resolutions in the reporting period:

Resolution	Purpose	Objective	Result
2 of 2024	To amend PSCBC Resolution 3 of 2017.	To include the process framework and timetable for each identified cycle of negotiations.	The agreement obtained a 54.24% majority status on May 30, 2024, and was signed by: The Employer, HOSPERSA, NAPTOSA, PSA and SADTU.
1 of 2025	To adjust salaries and improve conditions of service of employees employed in the public service.	To provide for an agreement on the payment of salary adjustments and improvement of conditions of service of employees employed in the public service for the financial years 2025/2026, 2026/2027 and 2027/2028.	The agreement obtained a 84.34% majority status on February 17, 2025, and was signed by: The Employer, DENOSA, HOSPERSA, NAPTOSA, POPCRU, PSA, SADTU and SAPU.



2 of 2025	To refer matters to a further process for research, investigation and negotiations in the financial year 2026/2026.	To provide for an agreement on matters referred to a further process for research, investigation and negotiations in the financial year 2026/2026.	The agreement obtained a 100% majority status on February 17, 2025, and was signed by: The Employer, DENOSA, HOSPERSA, NAPTOSA, NEHAWU, POPCRU, PSA, SADTU and SAPU.
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COMMITTEES/ TASK TEAM

In their role supporting Council's collective bargaining processes, the following committees convened during the reporting period and a brief summary of their work is provided below:

Committee	Establishment/ Legislative mandate	Key Focus Areas	Key Highlights	Status as at 31 March 2025
Working Committee on GEHS.	Established in line with the PSCBC Resolution 7 of 2015 and following the decision taken in October 2020 to bring GEHS matters back to Council.	To develop and implement a roadmap on the GEHS. To approach the GEPF and PIC to conduct a feasibility study on a funding model for affordable and accessible housing products for public servants.		The PIC was preparing to go on tender for the identification and appointment of financial institutions to provide affordable housing finance to public servants. The GEPF was to undergo a procurement process to appoint the relevant market research consultants and spatial planning aspects to survey the GEPF membership and provide advice on the strategic locations to avail housing stocks.



PSCBC GEMS Working Committee.	Established in terms of Resolution 4 of 2017 to consider the performance of the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) on an ongoing basis.	To give effect to the transformation of GEMS allowing the board to reflect the demographics of the membership of the scheme. To improve the healthcare benefits of members and funding for those benefits should be prioritised from the savings incurred by the scheme.	The hosting of a workshop on legislation governing medical schemes to better understand the medical schemes' industry, trends and the Medical Schemes Act, to enable Council to engage with GEMS from an informed position. The satisfaction survey conducted by Council on GEMS. PSCBC's strategic engagement with GEMS on issues of affordability, access and transformation.	Council to consider the report from the strategic engagement with GEMS and agree on a program of action.
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PSCBC GEMS Working Committee.	Established in terms of Resolution 4 of 2017 to consider the performance of the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) on an ongoing basis.	To give effect to the transformation of GEMS allowing the board to reflect the demographics of the membership of the scheme. To improve the healthcare benefits of members and funding for those benefits should be prioritised from the savings incurred by the scheme.	The hosting of a workshop on legislation governing medical schemes to better understand the medical schemes' industry, trends and the Medical Schemes Act, to enable Council to engage with GEMS from an informed position. The satisfaction survey conducted by Council on GEMS. PSCBC's strategic engagement with GEMS on issues of affordability, access and transformation.	Council to consider the report from the strategic engagement with GEMS and agree on a program of action.
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CO-ORDINATING CHAMBERS OF THE PSCBC

The PSCBC has a co-ordinating structure (a chamber) in each province to manage provincial administration matters.

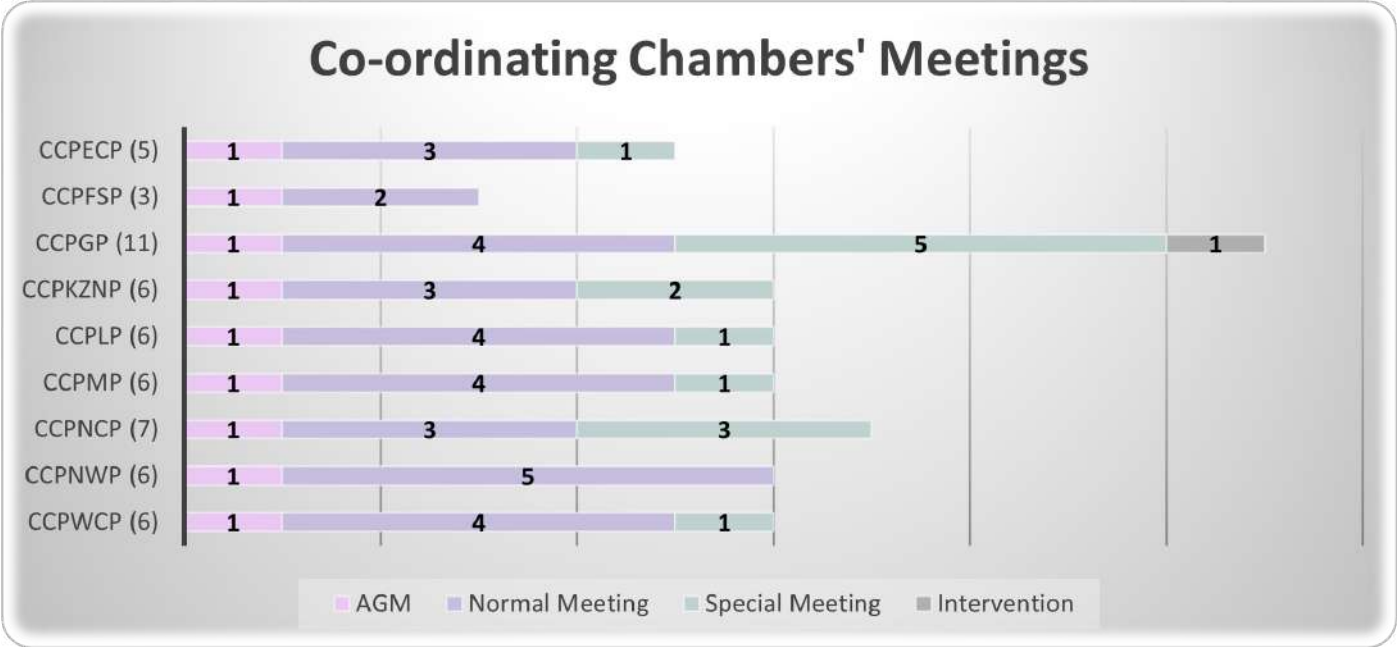
A report on the performance of the Chambers is detailed below:

Meetings

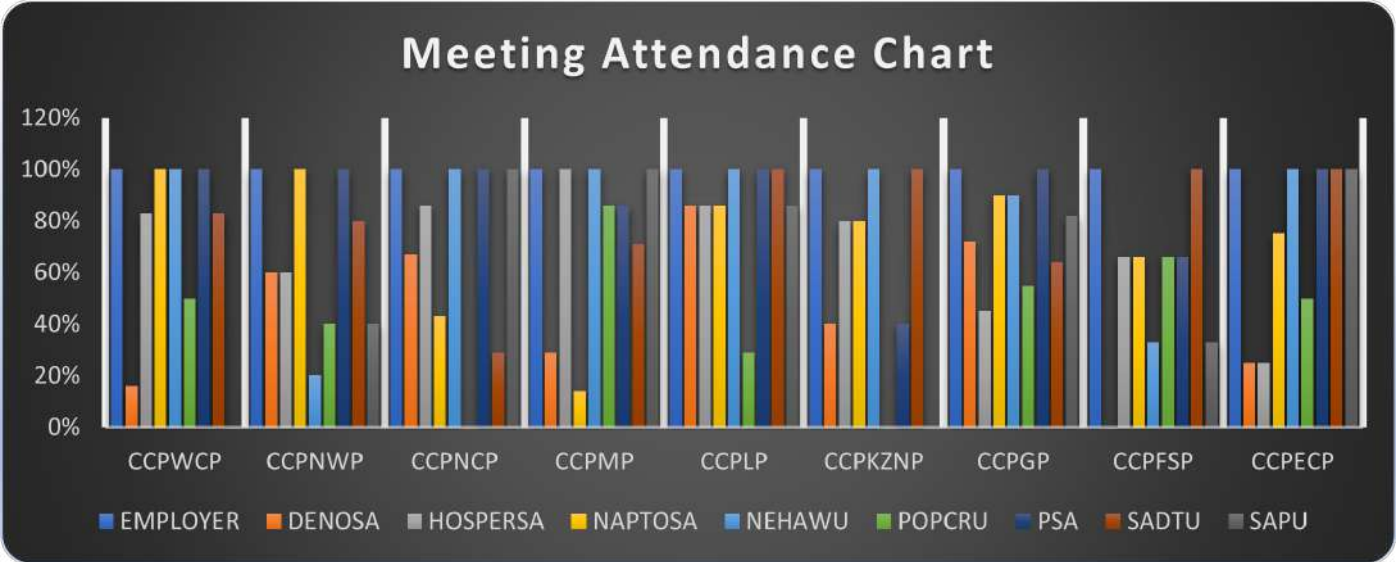
Each Chamber is mandated to meet a minimum of four times per reporting period, with additional meetings scheduled where necessary.

All Chambers met the required number of times, except for the Free State Chamber, which concluded its agenda after three meetings.

The graph below shows the number of meetings held by each Chamber during the reporting period.



Meeting Attendance by Parties



CCPECP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Provincial Human Resource Status Report.	Standing matter	All funded vacant posts in the province to be filled.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussions.
Occupational Health and Safety Report	May 2022	Buildings to comply with OHS requirements.	The Employer to present updated report for discussion in the next meeting.

CCPGP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Conditions of Buildings in Gauteng Province.	June 2017 (Standing matter)	Buildings to comply with OHS requirements.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Provincial PMDS Report on Pay Progression.	June 2021 (Standing matter)	Pay Progression payment and other related activities to be implemented in line with PMDS Policy.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Delays in E-Government Processes.	June 2023	Benefits due to employees to be addressed expeditiously.	The Employer to address challenges raised and present a progress report in the next meeting. Organised Labour to submit a list of affected employees to assist the process.
Project Nasi Ispani.	September 2023	The Employer to follow all departmental advertising, recruitment and selection processes in employment project pronounced by the Premier.	Concluded.

Appointment of Public Servant (PS) staff at the Department of Education and Update on unpaid salaries.	February 2024	The Employer to provide clarity on why some employees have not received their salaries and some were informed that their posts have been frozen.	Concluded.
Creation of Labour Forums in the workplace.	August 2024	For the Employer to stop establishing Labour Forums as consulting structures within departments.	Parties agreed to seek the intervention of the General-Secretary. The General Secretary recommended that the matter be addressed in the Gauteng Provincial Summit.
Provincial Micro-Organising of Government (PMOG).	October 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the processes to be followed.	Parties agreed that transversal matters be dealt with at the CCPGP and those that were not be referred to the GPSSBC.
Public Service Charter Pledge.	November 2024	For Labour to note that the Employer would be rolling out the Public Service Charter Pledge as committed at national level.	The Employer presented the Public Service Charter Pledge. The Employer to present close-out report in the next meeting.
GPG Reasonable Accommodation Policy.	February 2025	For the Employer to consult Organised Labour on the Policy Framework.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Conditions of Agriculture Building and Way Forward.	February 2025	For the Employer to rescind instruction of recalling employees to return to work until the building was declared safe for habitation.	The matter to be addressed under the item "Conditions of \Buildings".

CCPFSP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Request for monitoring of Enforcement of Collective Agreements in the Provincial Bargaining Chamber	September 2024	For a task team to be created to oversee compliance with collective agreements and report to the Chamber.	Labour was encouraged to engage departments regarding the interpretation and application of collective agreements before going the dispute route. The matter was concluded.
Year Calendar: CCPFSP 2025	March 2025	For Parties to note and adopt the Chamber year calendar.	The calendar was adopted.

PSCBC Workshop on the two wage negotiations agreements	March 2025	To remind Parties to submit lists of attendees.	Parties noted the reminder.
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CCPKZNP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Water Challenges at various departmental buildings/ offices in KwaZulu Natal Province.	August 2023	For the Employer to investigate and develop strategies to assist employees when there are water challenges in the workplace.	Concluded
Draft Policy on Strengthening Research and Policy Implementation Capacity in the KwaZulu Natal-Provincial Government.	February 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Concluded.
Provincial Policy Framework on Government Employees Housing Scheme.	February 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Concluded.
Job Evaluation.	August 2024	For the Employer to align all the processes of Job Evaluation across all Provincial Departments.	The Employer to circulate the Job Evaluation Policy Framework; Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs on/ or before 10 January 2025.
Gross Shortage on Nursing Personnel.	August 2024	The matter was not presented.	Parties agreed that the matter was not transversal thereof should be removed from the agenda.
Safety In Workplaces.	August 2024	The matter was not presented.	Parties agreed that the matter was not transversal thereof should be removed from the agenda.
Accommodation Policy.	August 2024	The matter was not presented.	Parties agreed that the matter was not transversal thereof should be removed from the agenda.
Grade Progression	August 2024	The matter was not presented.	Parties agreed that the matter was not transversal thereof should be removed from the agenda.

Grade Progression	August 2024	The matter was not presented.	Parties agreed that the matter was not transversal thereof should be removed from the agenda.
Policy Framework on Adult Education and Training (AET) In the Workplace	August 2024	Encourage further learning within the Provincial departments.	The Employer still finalising internal processes.
Draft Policy and Procedure on the Implementation of Recognition of Prior Learning within the Kwazulu Natal Office of the Premier.	August 2024	Recognise and assist employees that might not have formal qualifications but have requisite experience and need to further their studies so that they may be considered for upward career mobility.	The Employer still finalising internal processes.
Draft Provincial Policy on Mentorship and Coaching.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy .	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Draft Provincial Policy on Bursaries.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Draft Provincial Policy Framework on Job Rotation.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Draft Provincial Policy on Succession Planning.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Draft Provincial Policy on Change Management.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Reviewed Provincial Human Resource Strategy.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.
Nomination of the Representative from Organised Labour to sit on the Provincial Job Evaluation Panel.	November 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Organised Labour to submit consolidated inputs.

CCPLP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Progress Tracking in Shortage of Staff (Filling of Vacant Posts as Per Resolution 1 of 2018, Clause 8.2.3).	May 2016	For the Employer to continuously report statistics relating to the filling of vacant posts.	The Employer to provide updated reports.
Dilapidated Buildings causing health hazard and risk to safety in Limpopo workplaces.	August 2021	For the matter to receive urgent attention from the Employer as there were buildings with health and safety risks in the province.	The task team to present a consolidated report in the next meeting.
Application for Scheme B Vehicle Subsidy.	August 2021	For the matter to receive urgent attention from the Employer as there were buildings with health and safety risks in the province.	Concluded.
Salary Disparity of EPWP'S Employed within Departments of Limpopo Province.	August 2021	That EPWP employees who perform the same or similar duties be compensated the same.	Concluded.
Departments to establish OHS committees, train and recognise them and to ensure that they submit list of dilapidated buildings and their progress report on renovation, including any other safety risk and health hazard conditions report on a quarterly basis in chamber as well as measures taken to remedy such conditions.	February 2024	Departments to establish OHS committees, train and recognise them and to ensure that they submit list of dilapidated buildings and their progress report on renovation, including any other safety risk and health hazard conditions report on a quarterly basis in chamber as well as measures taken to remedy such conditions.	The Employer to submit a written report within seven days. The matter to be subjected to a special chamber meeting.
The draft Limpopo government motor transport handbook.	May 2024	For parties to consult on the draft Limpopo motor transport handbook.	Concluded.

Abuse of power by the employer in that the employer is appointing employees to act on higher post without compensation in the form of allowance upon employee competed six weeks acting on such higher post. some employees are not meeting the requirements, albeit the employer doing so under the pretext that s/he is transferring knowledge and experience for such post to employees who are made to rotate over the very higher post even being beyond twelve months.	August 2021	That EPWP employees who perform the same or similar duties be compensated the same.	Concluded.
Implementation of new job evaluation and grading system in the public service.	January 2025	For Parties to engage with the effectively in consultation regarding the implementation of the new job evaluation and grading system.	Labour to await implementation and monitor the process.
Review of provincial parking tariffs for implementation with effect from 1 April 2025.	January 2025	To propose review and implementation of increased tariffs with effect from 1 April 2025.	Labour to submit inputs.
Proposed amendment: rental management policy.	January 2025	For Parties to consult on the proposed amendments to the policy.	Labour to submit inputs.
Policy on remote work due to natural disasters (abnormal rainfall and flooding).	February 2025	That a policy on remote work due to natural disasters is developed and implemented and that the Disaster Management Team in the province is invited to form part of the consultation process.	The Employer to give a response in the next meeting.
Health and productivity management policy.	February 2025	For Parties to consult on the proposed amendments to the policy.	The Employer to submit a management plan for Labour to input on.

Amendments to the Provincial Human Resources and Development Policy Manual Amendments to the Provincial Human Resources and Development Policy Manual.	February 2025	For parties to consult on the Policy Manual.	Concluded.
Malfunctioning Transport Committees.	August 2023	For the Employer to address the issue of transport committees who failed to have quarterly meetings to consider applications for new subsidized vehicles (Scheme A) as well as applications to utilize private vehicles for official purposes (Scheme B).	The Employer to submit a management plan for Labour to input on.
Departments are restructuring and engaging policy related matters outside the chambers.	October 2023	For Departments to stop restructuring and engaging policy related matters outside the chambers.	Concluded.
Departments to stop forcing drivers to undergo driver-testing as this is not their mandate in terms of the law.	February 2024	Departments to stop forcing drivers to undergo driver-testing as this is not their mandate in terms of the law.	Concluded.
Policy and procedure on bereavement and hospitalisation.	February 2025	For parties to consult on the Policy.	The Employer to submit a management plan for Labour to input on.

CCPMP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
The Review of the Provincial Bursary Policy & Exceptional Decentralisation of Bursaries for the Department of Health .	July 2017	For the Employer to pay tuition, accommodation, and transportation for beneficiaries of bursaries.	The matter to be subjected to a special chamber meeting.

Establishment of District Offices for the Department of Health and the Department of Social Development in the Bohlabela Region.	July 2017	For the Department of Health and the Department of Social Development to be established in the Bohlabela region.	Labour to provide a progress report in the special.
Disposal of State Houses .	July 2017	For the Department of Public Works to halt the process of auctioning state houses and for employees who resided in those houses to be given preference when auctioning.	The matter to remain on the agenda pending the rollout of the process.
Status of Organograms of all Departments.	October 2018	For the Employer to provide a status of organograms of all departments in the provincial administration.	The Employer to report further in the next meeting.
Filling of Posts.	October 2018	For the Employer to provide information on the vacancy rate and the number of abolished posts within provincial administration.	The Employer to report progress in the next meeting.
Provincial Incentive Policy.	May 2023	For parties to consult on the review of the Provincial Incentive Policy.	The Employer to proceed with the Policy should Labour fail to submit inputs before the special chamber meeting .
Declaration of the Mpumalanga provincial labour summit held on 17 - 18 November 2022 at nutting house lodge in Mbombela.	October 2022	To track progress on the implementation of the labour summit declaration.	The Secretariat to expedite progress on the matter.
Vetting of employees in relation to NRSO and NCPR.	October 2022	For Labour to note the vetting of employees in relation to NRSO and NCPR.	Concluded.
Loadshedding.	November 2023	For the Employer to outline a plan of action for employees during loadshedding.	The Employer to report progress in the next meeting.
Referral of danger allowance for all community development workers (CDW's).	November 2023	For the Employer to outline a plan of action for employees during loadshedding.	The Employer to report progress in the next meeting.
Referral of danger allowance for all community development workers (CDW's) .	November 2023	For the Employer to outline a plan of action for employees during loadshedding.	The matter to be addressed in the special chamber meeting.

Employee health and wellness policy framework Mpumalanga provincial government.	November 2023	For parties to consult on the policy.	The Employer to proceed with the Policy should Labour fail to submit inputs before the special chamber meeting.
Policy frameworks for consultation at the provincial chamber.	February 2024	For parties to consult on the policy.	The Employer to proceed with the Policy should Labour fail to submit inputs before the special chamber meeting.
Electronic Submission System.	August 2024	For parties to consult on the policy.	Provincial Treasury to be invited to give a presentation in the next meeting.
The Constitutional values and principals, PSC grievances rules and professional ethics and framework of the PSC.	August 2024	For Information sharing purposes.	Concluded.
Establishment, abolition, and designation of Mpumalanga provincial departments.	October 2024	For Information sharing purposes.	The matter to be engaged further in the special chamber meeting.
Terms of reference (TRO) for security threat and risk assessment (STRA).	August 2024	For Parties to consult.	The Employer to proceed with the ToR should Labour fail to submit inputs before the special chamber meeting.

Implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2019 – Transfer of Early Childhood Development (ECD) Function from the Department of Social Development (DSD) to the Department of Basic Education (DBE).	October/ November 2020	For parties to consult on the transfer of the officials performing the ECD function from the DSD to the DBE	Concluded
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CCPNCP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2019 – Transfer of Early Childhood Development (ECD) Function from the Department of Social Development (DSD) to the Department of Basic Education (DBE).	October 2020	For parties to consult on the transfer of the officials performing the ECD function from the DSD to the DBE.	Concluded.
Point 14 (14.1.4) of Resolution No. 1 of 2007(PSCBC): Filling of Funded Vacant Posts.	July 2018	For the Employer to provide reports on the filling of vacant funded posts.	The Employer to present progress report in the next meeting.
Workshopping of PSCBC Resolution 14 of 2002.	August 2018	For the Employer to provide workshops to labour relations practitioners, shop stewards and human resources practitioners on the Resolution.	The Employer to come up with an intervention plan for departments with high grievances/disputes.
Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Terms of Reference.	July 2018	For parties to conclude a collective agreement on OHS.	The Employer to write to the Department of Employment and Labour and request feedback on the contravention notices issued prior the 60 days, and bring a work from home document to the Chamber for consultation in early 2025.

Current Approved Structures of each Department and Personnel Costs/ Compliance by the Provincial Departments with the 2016 Directive.	December 2019	For the Employer to provide Labour with the current approved structures of each department and personnel costs.	Parties to have a bilateral on the matter prior the next meeting.
Which Services had been outsourced and the cost of such services.	December 2019	The Employer to give a report on outsourced serviced and the cost of such services.	The matter to be discussed by Parties at the OTP meeting with Corporate Managers. The Employer to submit a report before the next meeting.
The Amount spent on Labour Related Cases, such as Litigations from January 2015 to June 2019, the Report must give yearly Breakdowns of such Amounts.	December 2019	For the Employer to provide the amount spent on labour related cases for the period January 2015 to June 2019.	The matter to be discussed by Parties at the OTP meeting with Corporate Managers. The Employer to submit a report before the next meeting.
Amounts indicated by the Auditor General to be Fruitless and Wasteful Expenditure for the Financial Year 2018/2019.	December 2019	For the Employer to provide amounts indicated by the Auditor General to be fruitless and wasteful.	The matter to be discussed by Parties at the OTP meeting with Corporate Managers. The Employer to submit a report before the next meeting.
The Roll Out of The Provincial Organisational Design (OD) Strategy.	September 2022	Parties to consult on the draft Provincial Organisational Design Strategy.	The Employer to circulate annexures C - P of the presented report to Labour within 14 days.
Continuous Use or Contracting of OHS non-Compliant and Dilapidated Offices by Departments across the Province.	August 2023	Task the HODs to ensure that rented offices are renovated and put on the necessary level of hygiene or else look for complaint offices to rent.	The Employer to write to the Department of Employment and Labour and request feedback on the contravention notices issued prior the 60 days, and bring a work from home document to the Chamber for consultation in early 2025.
Insourcing Of Security Personnel - DTSL.	January 2024	There was a process unfolding where employees from the Department of Health, currently stationed at the Northern Cape Mental Hospital, were in a process of being transferred to the Department of Transport, Safety and Liaison. They believed proper consultation should have taken place.	Concluded.

The organizational structure of DTSL (Security Function).	February 2025	For Parties to consult on the matter.	Labour to be included in the Departmental Steering Committee.
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CCPNWP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Provincial PMDS Report.	June 2018 (Standing matter)	The Employer to report on pay progression payments and other related activities in line with the PMDS Policy.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Report on Resolution 1 of 2007.	May 2016 (Standing matter)	All funded vacant posts in the province should be filled, expeditiously.	The Employer to present updated reports for discussion.
Perpetual Discriminatory Conduct of the Department of Public Works against Works Inspectors.	July 2024	For the Employer to recognise Works Inspectors as professionals who ought to benefit from the Occupational Specific Dispensation (OSD).	The Item was removed from the agenda.
Provincial Remote Working Policy.	July 2024	To consult Organised Labour on the draft Policy.	Concluded.

CCPWCP Agenda

Agenda Item	Date tabled	Remedy sought	Status to date
Policy Guideline on the Management of Immovable Assets, Including Parking Bays.	December 2018	To enquired whether such a policy was available, and do various departments manage their own parking bays.	Concluded.
Safety of Staff in all Provincial Government Departments.	December 2018	To enquired whether such a policy was available, and do various departments manage their own parking bays.	The matter to be subjected to a workshop in February 2025.

Conversions: Probationary Employees.	July 2022	The Employer to provide progress report on probationary employees' conversions to permanent employees.	The Employer to provide a response in the next Consultative Forum meeting.
Strategic Planning Session.	December 2022	For parties to discuss the way forward in the Chamber from a strategic perspective.	The matter awaits urgent feedback from the PSCBC.
Service Benefits Roadshows.	June 2023	Requested that a GEHS awareness campaign be launched in WCG, similar to the roadshow that was done when GEHS was first introduced.	Concluded.
The Western Cape Government Work Arrangement Guide.	June 2023	That the guide was incorrect to place the HOD as the overarching individual.	Removed from the agenda and to be reintroduced as a policy.
National Treasury: Cost - Containment measures.	September 2023	That no budget cuts be implemented in specific areas they regarded as critical posts, EMS, nursing and teaching, and also if they wanted effective collective bargaining to function, they should also be regarded as critical posts within a department.	Removed from the agenda, and to be reintroduced by Labour in the next Chamber meeting to provide adequate response to what was tabled by Provincial Treasury.
Grade Progression.	June 2024	Clarity on how the issue of equal work for equal pay works in the provincial government.	Concluded.
Employment Equity.	November 2023	Health and Safety Committees be established at directorate level, department level and centre level as prescribed by OHS Act 85 of 1993 where labour must be part of these committees.	Concluded.
Establishment of Occupational Health and Safety Forums.	March 2024	That OHS forums must urgently be established as prescribed by OHS ACT.	Removed from the agenda as it is tabled at the GPSSBC chamber.
Restructuring without consultation.	June 2024	Offline discussion between the Employer & POPCRU on the matter in terms of clarity on the motivation.	Removed from the agenda and referred to the GPSSBC chamber as the forum with jurisdiction on the matter.
Review of the personnel plan signed in 2019.	September 2024	For Parties to consult a draft reviewed Personnel Plan.	Deferred to the next Chamber meeting for further engagements.

CHAMBER INTERVENTIONS

CCPGP – Conditions of Buildings in the Gauteng Provincial Government.

Labour raised significant concerns regarding the non-compliance of most government buildings with Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) standards. They argued that the non-compliance created dangerous working conditions for their members.

An intervention meeting was subsequently convened with the General-Secretary of the PSCBC wherein Labour raised their frustrations. The Employer committed to revive the OHS committee within the province. The General-Secretary committed to chair the initial meetings of the committee.

By the end of the reporting period the Employer was still in the process of reviving the committee.

CAPACITY BUILDING FOR PARTIES TO COUNCIL AND CHAMBERS

CHAMBERS:

CCPECP – Two-Pot Retirement System

The Chamber requested a workshop to explain the two-pot retirement system and its impact on members. In response, the PSCBC and the GEFP successfully hosted a workshop on 26 July 2024, to address this need.

Attendees were advised to exercise caution and only access their funds when necessary, and as a last resort. This warning was issued to highlight the potential long-term implications that could arise from frequent withdrawals.

The session was well-received and appreciated.

COUNCIL:

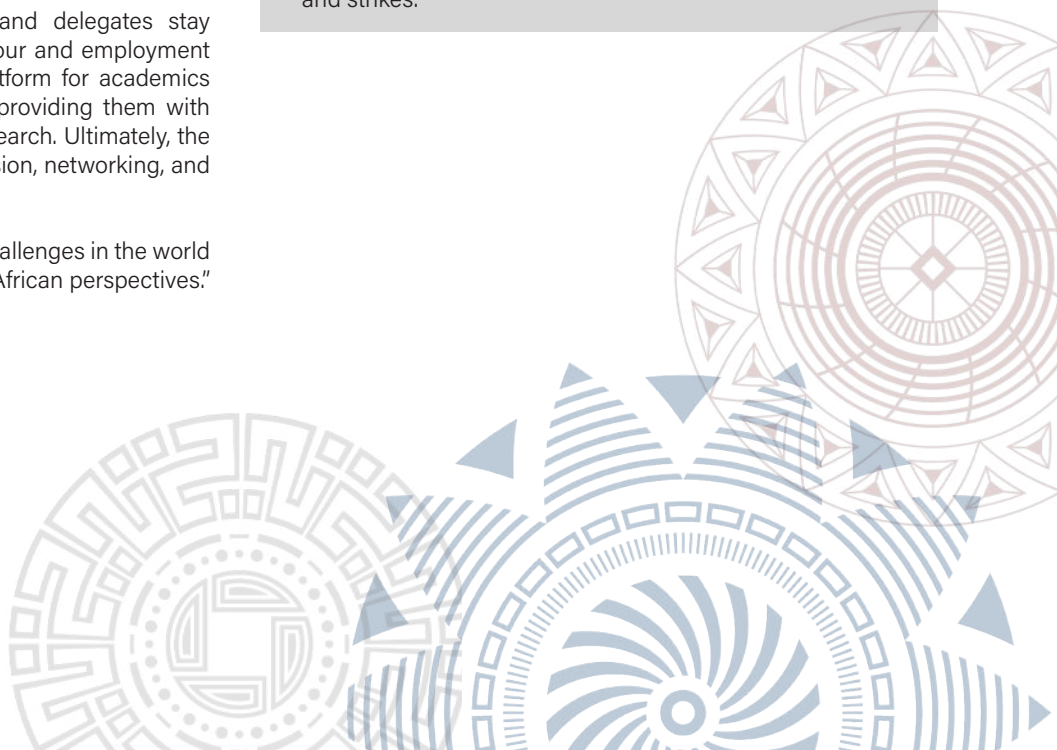
ILERA 10th African Regional Congress: 3-4 April 2024, Zambia

The Labour and Employment Relations Association of South Africa (LERASA), the South African chapter of International Labour and Employment Relations Association (ILERA) hosted the ILERA 10th Africa Congress, from 3 to 4 April 2024 at the Radisson Blu Mosi-Oa-Tunya, Livingstone Victoria Falls, Zambia.

The Congress aimed to help members and delegates stay current with the latest developments in labour and employment relations and related fields. It offered a platform for academics and practitioners to connect and engage, providing them with insights into the most recent trends and research. Ultimately, the goal was to foster an environment of discussion, networking, and interaction with leaders in the field.

The Congress was held under the theme “Challenges in the world of work in the wake of the global polycrisis: African perspectives.” It explored several sub-themes, including:

- Individual labour law: unfair dismissals, unfair discrimination and dispute prevention and resolution.
- Social protection, migrancy and the informal economy in Africa.
- The impact of technology and digitisation on the world of work.
- Collective labour law: social dialogue, collective bargaining and strikes.



The Council's delegation at the Congress included the late Chairperson of the PSCBC, both Vice Chairpersons, the General Secretary, 8 Labour representatives (one from each admitted trade union), 8 Employer representatives, and 5 members from the Secretariat.

Participants and attendees overwhelmingly praised the Congress as a great success. As a result, there's now considerable anticipation for the 11th Africa Congress, planned to take place in Port Elizabeth, South Africa, in 2027.

ILERA 20th World Congress: 27-30 June 2024, New York

ILERA convenes its World Congress every three years, where professionals interested in all aspects of labour and employment relations meet to share ideas about new developments, and practices in the field. ILERA hosted its 20th World Congress at the Hilton Hotel Midtown Manhattan, New York City, United States from 27-30 June 2024.

The Congress was held under the theme “Challenges and Choices at Work in a Time of Heightened Worker Activism”, It explored several sub-themes, including:

- Artificial Intelligence in the Workplace.
- Collective Bargaining, Industrial Democracy and Strikes.
- Individual Disputes.
- Human Resource Management and Technological Change, Challenges and Prospects.

The Council's delegation at the Congress included the late Chairperson of the PSCBC, both Vice Chairpersons, the General Secretary, 5 Labour, 5 Employer representatives, and 1 member from the Secretariat.

The Congress offered a comprehensive program packed with practical information, international updates, observations, analyses, and theories on the future of labour relations. All attendees considered it a great success.

Driving Development in the Region - Lesotho Public Service Study Visit

The PSCBC was approached by the ILO to host delegates from Lesotho Public Service for a study visit. Lesotho had ratified the ILO Labour Relations (Public Service) Convention No. 151 (1978) and sought to enhance its policies and practices to align with the convention's requirements.

The visiting delegates aimed to gain insights into South Africa's laws and practices concerning:

- Freedom of association.
- Collective bargaining.
- Dispute resolution processes and challenges.
- Enjoyment of political and civil rights within the public service.

The PSCBC hosted a two-day study visit on 8 and 9 May 2024. During the visit, the Lesotho delegation received a comprehensive overview of the PSCBC's history, its constitution and structure, dispute management, and collective bargaining processes within the South African public service.

The Vice Chairpersons shared their experiences in negotiation, their respective mandating processes, and efforts to align PSCBC wage negotiations with the government's annual budgetary processes. Furthermore, the GPSSBC presented its processes, offering the delegates a valuable perspective from a sector council.

The discussions proved highly informative for both countries, and all parties considered the visit a great success. The Lesotho delegation departed with an in-depth understanding of collective bargaining and dispute resolution management within the South African context. We wish them success as they work to improve their systems using the acquired knowledge.

MANAGEMENT OF TRADE UNION MEMBERSHIP

In the reporting period, the Collective Bargaining Unit has put processes and procedures in place to operationalise the Trade Union Membership (TUM) Section.

TUM has been participating in discussions and processes to develop and customised membership management system to, among other things:

- Streamline data management processes.
- Provide real-time access to membership information.
- Improve reporting capabilities and transparency.
- Facilitate better communication and service delivery to stakeholders.

The Section also focused on developing an educational program to highlight the value of union membership and the advantages of collective bargaining in the public service. To strengthen stakeholder relations, the Section actively engaged with the broader trade union landscape; these engagements served as vital platforms for sharing progress, gathering stakeholder feedback, and fostering long-term collaboration.

Key participation during this period included:

- SADTU 10th National Congress : 25-28 September 2024.
- POPCRU Central Executive Committee (CEC) Meeting : 5-7 November 2024.
- SAPU 8th Central Executive Committee (CEC) Meeting : 20-21 November 2024.
- DENOSA Western Cape 9th Provincial Congress : 5-17 January 2025.
- NUPSAW 2nd National General Council (NGC) : 21-22 February 2025.
- DENOSA 9th National Congress : 25-28 March 2025.

THE YEAR-AHEAD

The ratification of a three-year salary agreement, outlined in PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2025, now provides the Parties with the necessary time to concentrate on other critical Council projects. In addition to the Unit's ongoing commitments, such as meetings for the Council, EXCO, Committees/Chambers, and the AGMs, the Unit will intensify its efforts to implement the Summit Declaration. PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2025 also introduced new responsibilities for the Unit through the creation of committees to drive the provisions prescribed therein.

In light of financial challenges, the Unit has decided to host strategic planning sessions for the chambers as an alternative to the initially planned provincial summits. These sessions are designed to facilitate the collection of provincial inputs, which will then be considered during the Council's strategic planning session, scheduled for the third quarter of the upcoming reporting period. The Unit will play a central role in organising and facilitating this crucial session.

Furthermore, the Unit will re-engage with the review and finalisation of Resolution 2 of 2005. The public sector summit is the next big project of Council proposed to take place in the 2026/2027 reporting period. The preparatory phase for this summit will be undertaken during the next reporting period.

The Unit remains committed to the centralization of trade union membership administration, as decided by Council. Stakeholder engagements and capacity building will continue. The unit awaits the conclusion of Labour's consultation process and their subsequent decision regarding the official rollout of the membership management system.

With all activities meticulously planned, the Unit is fully prepared and eager to execute its strategic mandate in the upcoming reporting period.



SECTION D

DISPUTE RESOLUTION



DISPUTE RESOLUTION

The Council is accredited to perform dispute resolution functions in terms of section 127 of the Labour Relations Act 66 of 1995 as amended. The functions performed by the Council include resolving and preventing disputes; and maintaining labour peace.

The fast-paced technological innovation has led to various projects implemented within the Council. The successful launch of a user-friendly e-referral platform which is accessible from the PSCBC website and the PSCBC Portal to parties, exclusively available to parties of council.

The PSCBC Portal is an advancement to the Council’s automated business management system. The Portal extends to functions which allow panellists and parties to connect to the internal business management system and interact with processes in real-time. The Council, empowered to monitor and enforce the collective agreements, concluded and workshopped several collective agreements including but not limited to regulating the enforcement of collective agreement in the public service, namely, Resolution 3 of 2023. Furthermore, the Council has replaced Resolution 4 of 2005, 'Rules for the conduct of proceedings before the PSCBC' with the new Rules – Resolution 1 of 2024.

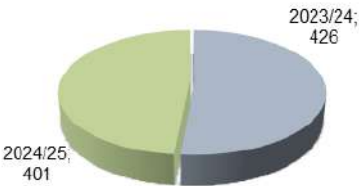
During the reporting period, 2024/25 eleven workshops were conducted for the financial year. These workshops covered all nine provinces with two additional national workshops. These workshops were aimed at educating and creating awareness among stakeholders regarding the recent signed resolutions and the technological advancements made within the Council’s processes.

Statistics

The report reflects on new referrals received by the Council from 1 April 2024 to 31 March 2025 (2024/25), comparing them with those from the previous reporting period (2023/24), the processes conducted/scheduled, and the enforcement complaints received during the current period.

1. Number of cases received and screened

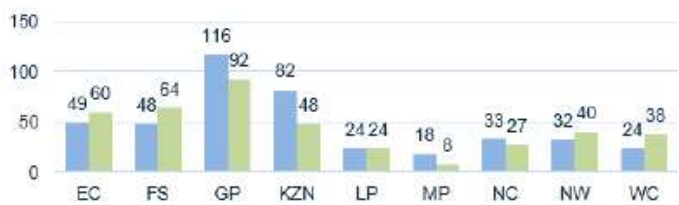
Diagram 1: Total number of referrals screened



From 1 April to 31 March 2025, 401 referrals were captured and screened compared to 426 in the same previous reporting period, resulting in a 6% decrease in the referral rate.

A breakdown of the referrals screened by provinces

Graph A: A breakdown by provinces of the total screened referrals



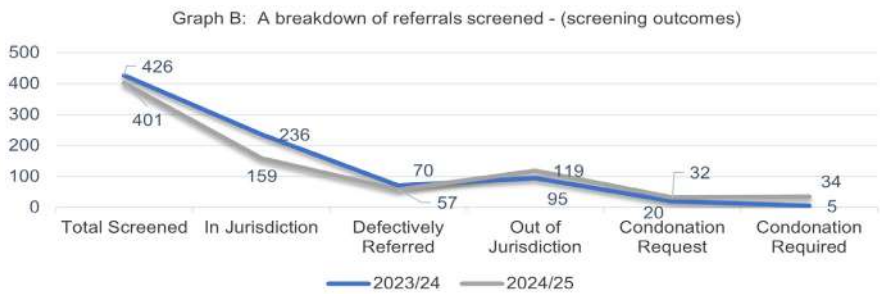
The overall referral rate has slightly declined, except in the Free State, Eastern Cape and Western Cape Provinces, which have seen a slight increase in referrals.

Gauteng Province received the highest number of referrals, accounting for 23% of the referral rate, compared to 27% in the previous reporting period.

The Free State is the second-highest referring province, representing 16% of the referral rate, compared to 11% in the previous reporting period.



A breakdown of the referral screening outcomes



Screening outcomes – 2023/24

426 – total screened

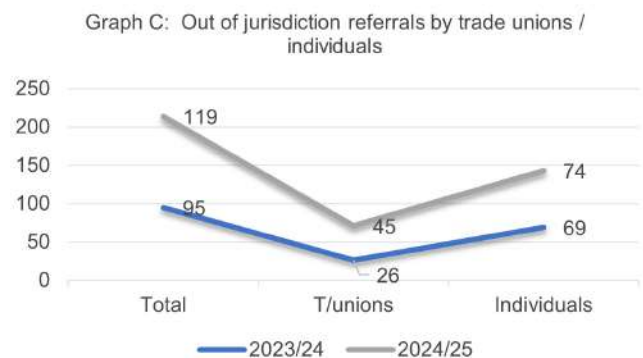
- 236 – in jurisdiction (56%)
- 70 – defectively referred (16%)
- 95 – out of jurisdiction (22%)
- 20 – pending condonation application (5%)
- 5 – required condonation (1%)

Screening outcomes – 2024/25

401 – total screened

- 159 – in jurisdiction (39%)
- 57 – defectively referred (13%)
- 119 – out of jurisdiction (31%)
- 32 – pending condonation application (7%)
- 34 – required condonation – (8%)

Referrals screened out of jurisdiction by trade unions / individuals



Out of jurisdiction referrals – trade unions

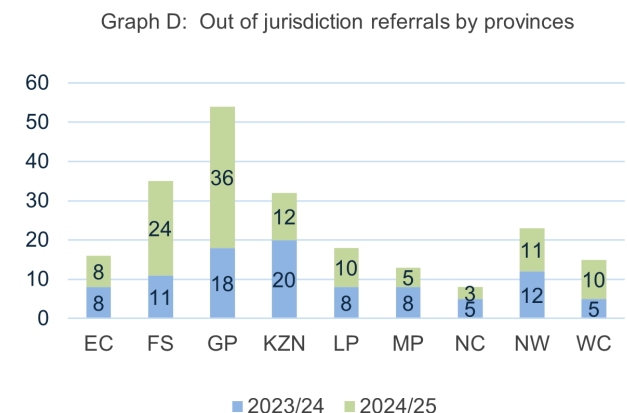
During the reporting period, 38% of the referrals screened out of jurisdiction are from the trade union parties, compared to 27% in the previous reporting period.

Out of jurisdiction referrals – individual employees

74% of the out of jurisdiction referrals are received from individual employees. In the previous reporting period, this figure was 73%.

* The stats indicate an increase where trade unions are concerned and a decrease in the individual employees.

Referrals screened out of jurisdiction by provinces



2024/25

The Gauteng province accounts for the highest number of referrals screened out of jurisdiction, followed by the Free State province.

2023/24

During the previous reporting period, the highest number of referrals outside jurisdiction was recorded in the KwaZulu-Natal province, followed by the Gauteng province.

Referrals screened defective by trade unions / individuals

Defective referrals – trade unions

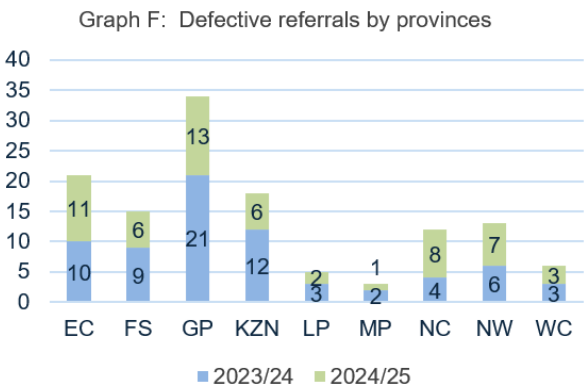
During the reporting period, 84% of referrals that are screened and found to be defectively referred came from trade union parties, compared to 76% in the previous reporting period.

Defective referrals – individual employees

In the current reporting period, 16% of referrals screened as defective are filed by individual employees, compared to 24% in the previous reporting period.

* The stats indicate an increase where trade unions are concerned and a decrease in the individual employees.

Referrals screened defective by provinces



2024/25

The highest number of defective referrals are received from Gauteng, followed by Eastern Cape province.

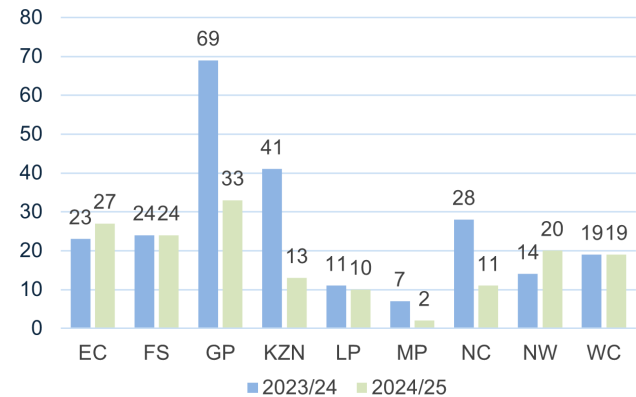
2023/24

The highest number of defective referrals were recorded in the Gauteng and the KwaZulu Natal provinces.

Referrals screened in jurisdiction

In jurisdiction referrals by provinces

Graph G: A breakdown of screened in jurisdiction referrals by provinces



2024/25

A total of 159 referrals are screened in jurisdiction.

The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals are received from the Gauteng, Free State and Eastern Cape provinces.

2023/24

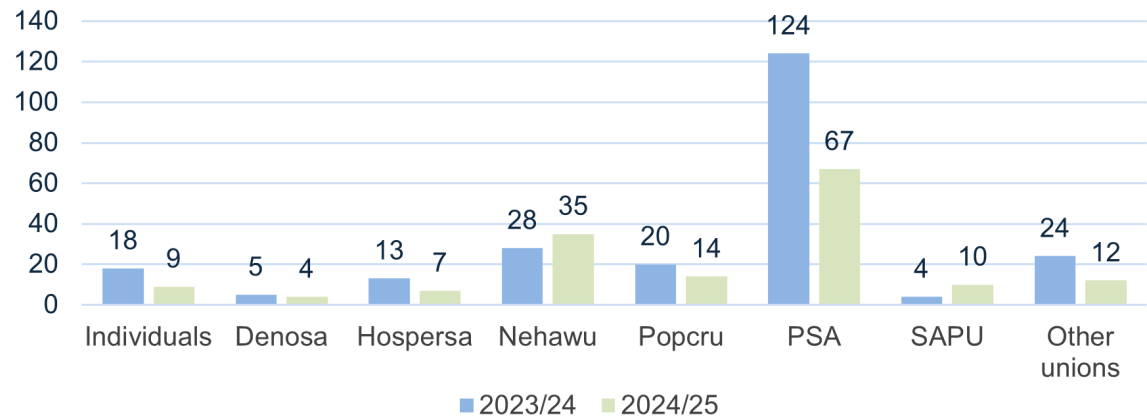
A total in 236 referrals were screened in jurisdiction.

The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals were received from the Gauteng, Kwa-Zulu Natal and Northern Cape provinces.



In jurisdiction referrals by trade unions / individuals

Graph H: A breakdown of referrals screened in jurisdiction by trade unions / individuals



2024/25

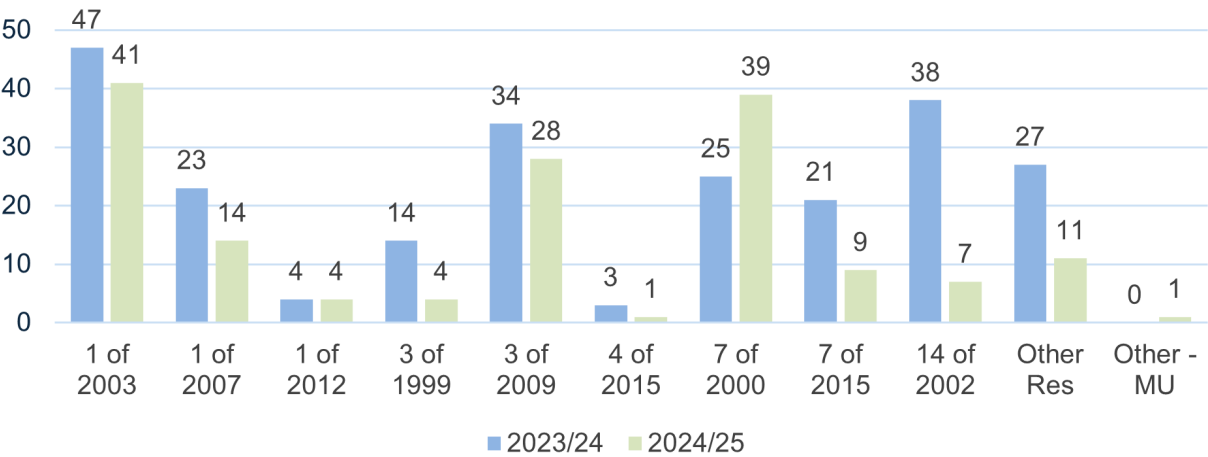
In this period, referrals from PSA account for 42% of the total referrals in the jurisdiction, while referrals by Nehawu are at 22%.

2023/24

During this period, referrals from PSA represented 53% of the total referrals, with Nehawu contributing 12%, making it the second highest source of referrals received in the jurisdiction.

In jurisdiction referrals by the nature of the dispute / issue

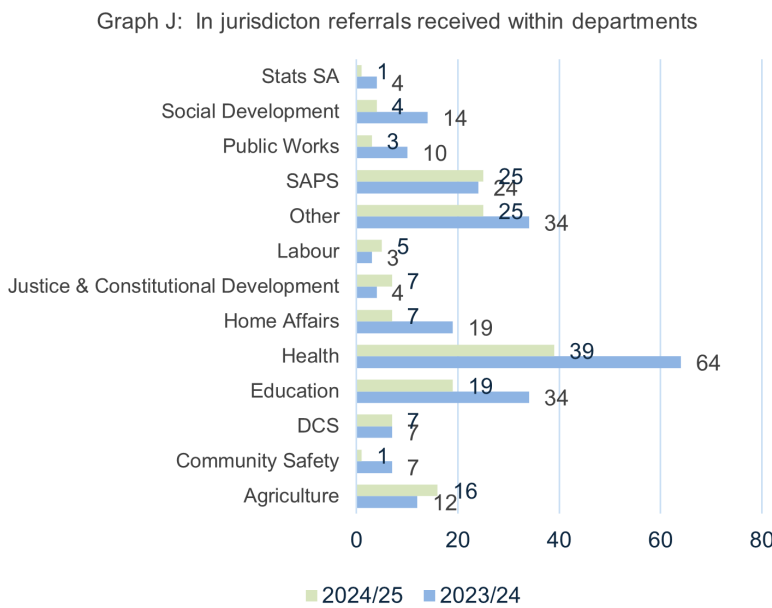
Graph I: In jurisdiction referrals by issue/nature of the dispute



The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the cases referred:

- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 20032F account for 26% and 20% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 20003F account for 25% against 11% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 3 of 20094F account for 18% and 14% in the previous reporting period.
- Disputes referred in terms of Resolution 14 of 20025F has been significantly reduced from 16% in the previous reporting period to 4% in compliance with clauses F8 & F11 of Resolution 14 of 2002.

In jurisdiction referrals within the departments



2024/25

The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals are recorded within the departments of Health and South African Police Services.

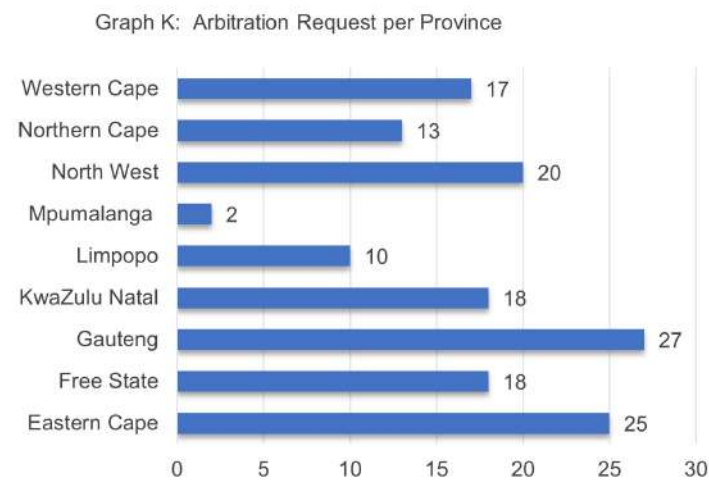
2023/24

The highest number of in jurisdiction referrals were recorded within the departments of Health and Education.

Arbitration requests received

- A total of 165 new arbitration requests were received from 1 April to 31 March 2025.
- Of the 165 requests, 150 were properly submitted, while 15 were not.

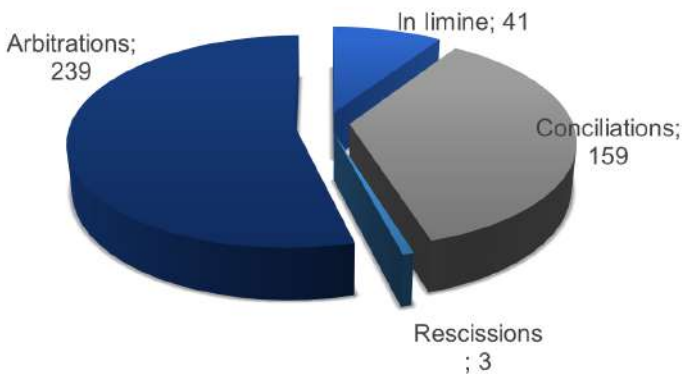
Breakdown of arbitration requests received by province



The Gauteng, Eastern Cape, and North-West provinces received the most requests for arbitration, while Mpumalanga and Limpopo had the fewest.

Processes conducted / scheduled

Diagram 2: A breakdown of the processes conducted



A total of 442 processes were scheduled/conducted in comparison to 499 in the previous reporting period resulting in a 11% decrease.

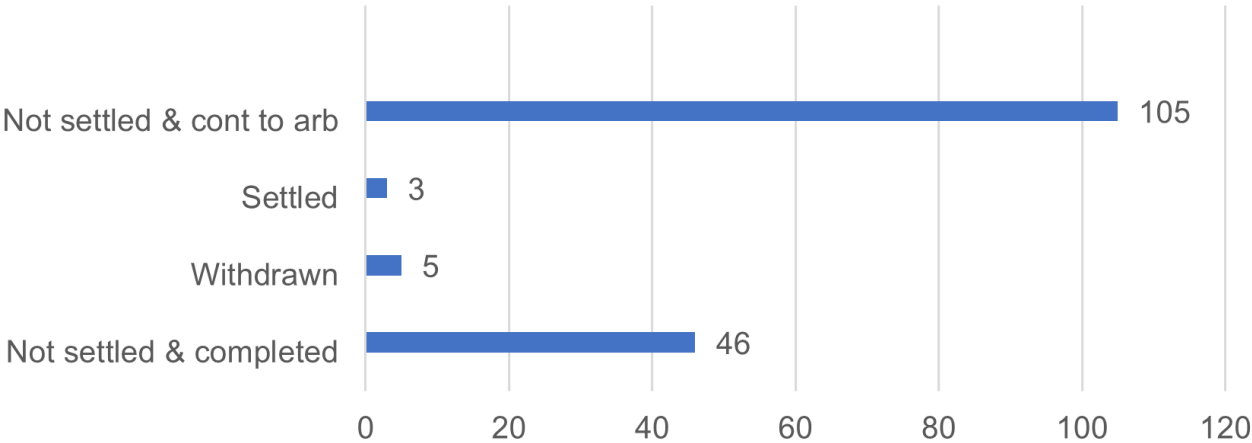
The following processes were conducted/scheduled - 3 rescissions in terms of Section 144 of the LRA, 41 in limine (a hearing on a specific legal point, which takes place before the actual case referred can be heard), 159 conciliations and 239 arbitrations.

Conducted processes outcomes

Conciliation outcomes

- At the conciliation phase, 96% of conciliations are unresolved. Of the 95% that remained unresolved, 66% have been referred to arbitration.
- The withdrawal rate of cases at conciliation level is recorded at 3%.
- The settlement rate at the conciliation level is at 2%.

Graph L: A breakdown of conciliation outcomes



Arbitration outcomes

The Council conducted 239 arbitration processes. The outcomes from these processes are as follows: 51 awards were rendered, 86 cases were postponed, 29 disputes were withdrawn, and 5 settlements were reached.

- 12% of the disputes were withdrawn at the arbitration level.
- There is a 36% rate of postponements. Various reasons contributed to the postponements by both parties and panellists, including:
 - 12% of the disputes were withdrawn at the arbitration level.
 - There is a 36% rate of postponements. Various reasons contributed to the postponements by both parties and panellists, including:
 - Limited or poor connectivity on virtual platforms.
 - Agreements made between the parties, with no reasons provided.
 - Parties attempting to reach a settlement.
 - Postponements pending further discussions between the parties.

Additionally, the pre-arbitration process outlined in the Dispute Resolution Procedure6F is rarely utilized by the parties with a usage rate of less than 1%.

Graph M: A breakdown of arbitration outcomes

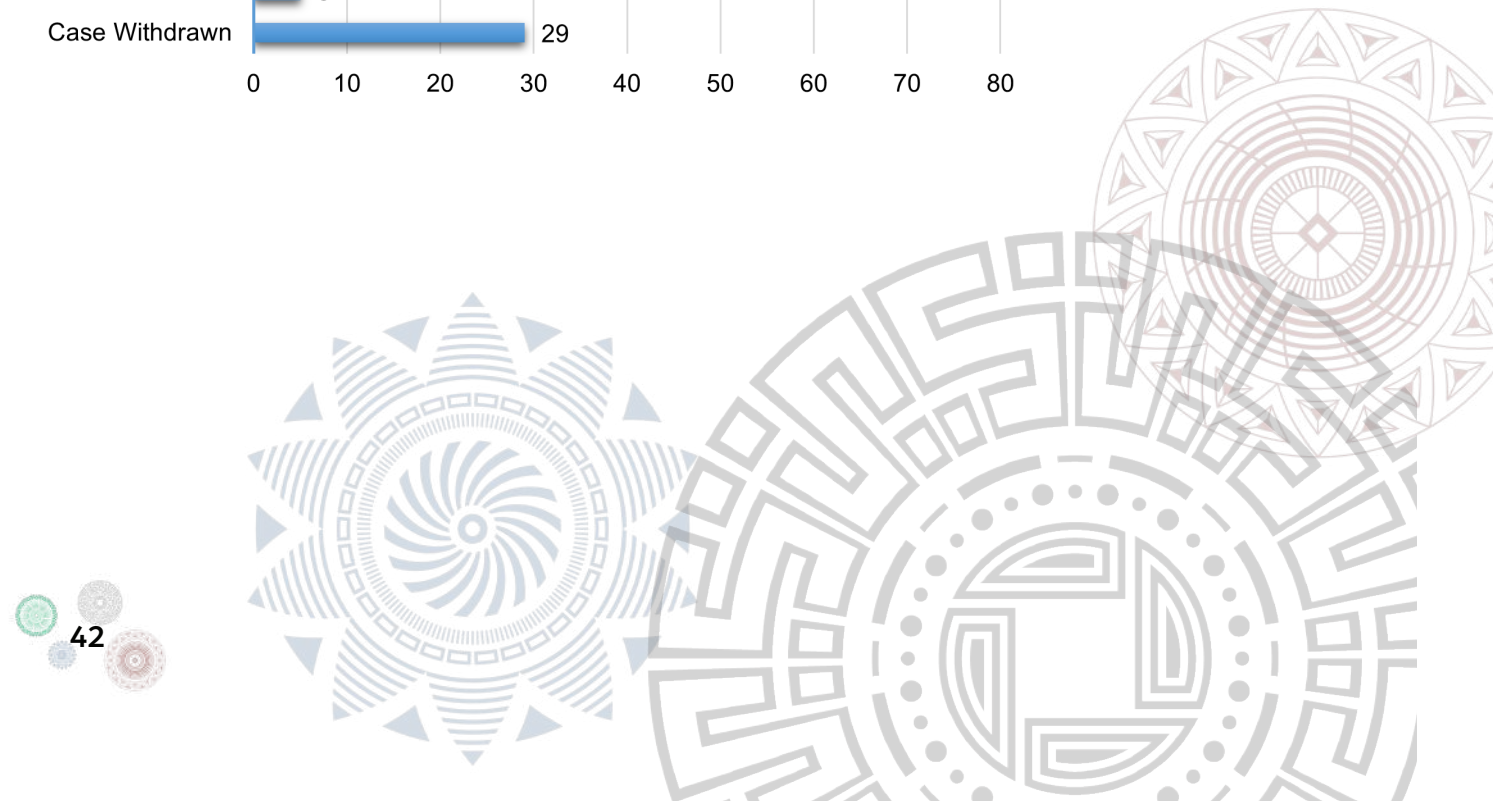
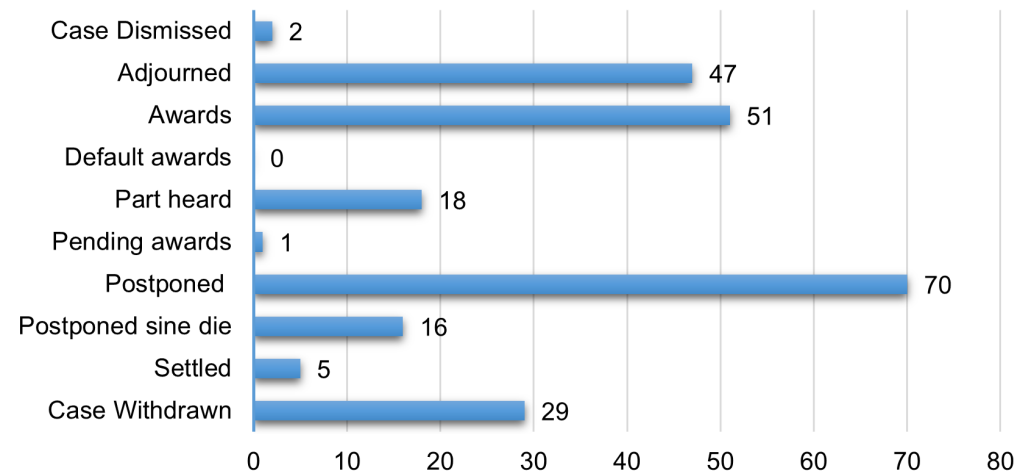
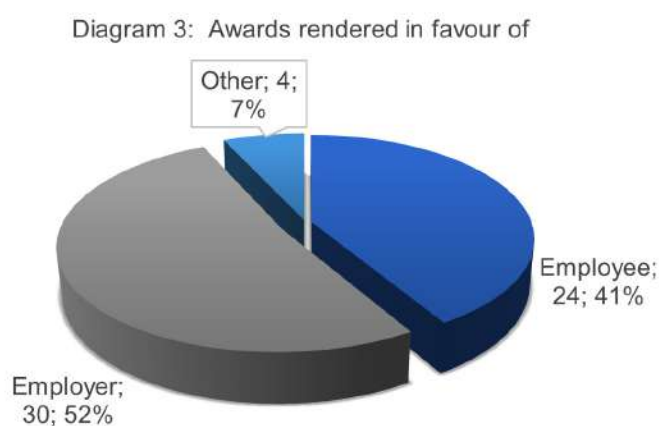


Table A: A breakdown of arbitration outcomes by provinces

OUTCOMES	EC	FS	GP	KZN	LP	MP	NC	NW	WC	Total
Adjourned	7	4	8	3	2	1	9	3	10	47
Awards	8	6	17	5	3	0	2	3	7	51
Default award	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Part heard	2	6	3	4	0	0	1	2	0	18
Pending awards	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1
Postponed	10	7	10	7	4	0	6	14	12	70
Postponed sine die	5	1	3	2	0	1	1	2	1	16
Settled	1	1	0	1	2	0	0	0	0	5
Case Withdrawn	4	4	6	6	3	1	3	1	1	29
Case Dismissed	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	2
Total	37	29	47	29	14	3	22	27	31	239

Arbitration awards in favour of employee, employer and out of jurisdiction

- From 1 April to 31 March 2025, a total of 58 arbitration awards were issued, regardless of when the arbitrations were heard and finalized.
- 24 awards were found in favour of the union/employee party, accounting for 41%.
- 30 awards were ruled in favour of the employer party, representing 52% of the awards issued.
- 4 awards were neither in favour of the union/employee party nor the employer party, making up 7% of the awards rendered.



A highlighted breakdown of the awards rendered by issue

- 16 awards were issued concerning Resolution 3 of 2009 – revised salary structure of employees not covered by the OSD on level 1 to 12 – grade progression; 14 awards were in favour of the employer and 2 awards were found in favour of the employee.
- 14 awards were issued in relation to Resolution 7 of 2000 – improvement in the conditions of service – leave provisions; 9 awards were in favour of the employee; 3 awards were found in favour of the employer and 2 awards were found neither in favour of the employee nor in favour of the employer “other”.
- 5 awards were issued in relation to Resolution 07 of 2015 – housing allowance, 3 awards were found in favour of the employer, 1 award was found in favour of the employee and 1 award was found neither in favour of the employee nor in favour of the employer “other”.
- 11 awards were issued in relation to Resolution 1 of 2003 – disciplinary procedure; 7 awards were found in favour of the employee party and 4 awards were found in favour of the employer party.
- 2 awards were issued concerning Resolution 03 of 1999 – remunerative allowances and benefits, and 1 award was found in favour of the employee party while the other 1 award was found neither in favour of the employee nor in favour of the employer “other”.

Outcomes of in limine processes

A total of forty-one (41) in limine processes were conducted during this reporting period, with nine (9) ruled in the jurisdiction of the PSCBC and thirty-two (32) ruled out of jurisdiction.

Outcomes of rescission processes

Three (3) rescission applications were made under Section 144 of the LRA; one application was rescinded, while two were not.

Cases on review

In this reporting period, a total of eight (8) cases are pending the Labour Court. Of these, four (4) cases were initiated by the applicant party, while the other four (4) were initiated by the respondent party.

Table B: Matters taken on review at the Labour Court from 1 April to 31 March 2025

Case Number	Outcome	LC Number	PSCBC Resolution/Issue	Reviewed By
PSCBC705-23/24	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR1603/24	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Applicant party
PSCBC739-23/24	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR2019/2024	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Applicant party
PSCBC014-22/23	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR1927/24	Res 07 of 2000 (leave provisions)	Respondent party
PSCBC35-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	C260/2024	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Applicant party
PSCBC68-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR2130/24	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Respondent party
PSCBC15&16-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR2191/24	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Respondent party
PSCBC23-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	JR2209/24	Res 07 of 2000 (leave provisions)	Applicant party
PSCBC192-24/25	Pending Labour Court Appeal	2025-035520	Res 01 of 2003 (disciplinary code and procedures)	Respondent party

Enforcement complaints

Following the conclusion of Resolution 03 of 2023, the enforcement of Collective Agreements in the public service, a total of twenty-three (23) enforcement complaints were received during this reporting period. Out of these 23 complaints, two (2) were not correctly filed, nine (9) were determined to be outside of jurisdiction, and 10 are currently under investigation and pending resolution while two (2) have been concluded.

PSCBC Online Platforms

The Council has in this period launched two online platforms - the Portal to Parties and the e-Referral form to enhance access to the Council's dispute resolution processes and to align with technological advancements.

- Portal to Parties activated in July 2024. This Portal is exclusively available to the parties to Council, (trade unions who are parties to Council and the State as the employer).
- The e-Referral platform introduced in April 2024. This form is available to all to refer matters. While the online e-referral system is accessible to all users, parties to Council are encouraged to register on the Portal to benefit from its additional exclusive features.

While the online e-referral system is accessible to all users, parties to Council are encouraged to register on the Portal to benefit from its additional exclusive features. In this period Council had a total of 589 referrals that was received from its technological advancement platforms. Of these, 499 were submitted using the manual referral form, 73 were submitted via the e-referral form, and 17 were done through the portal.

Table C: Referrals from the different PSCBC platforms

PROCESS	PORTAL	EREFERRAL	MANUAL	TOTAL
New Referrals	9	49	343	401
Arbitration Requests	5	13	147	165
Enforcement Complaints	13	11	9	23
TOTAL	17	73	499	589

**The data collected indicates that matters referred via digital platforms tend to be less defective compared to those referred manually. This trend will be closely monitored and reported on as the platforms continue to be utilised.

The year ahead

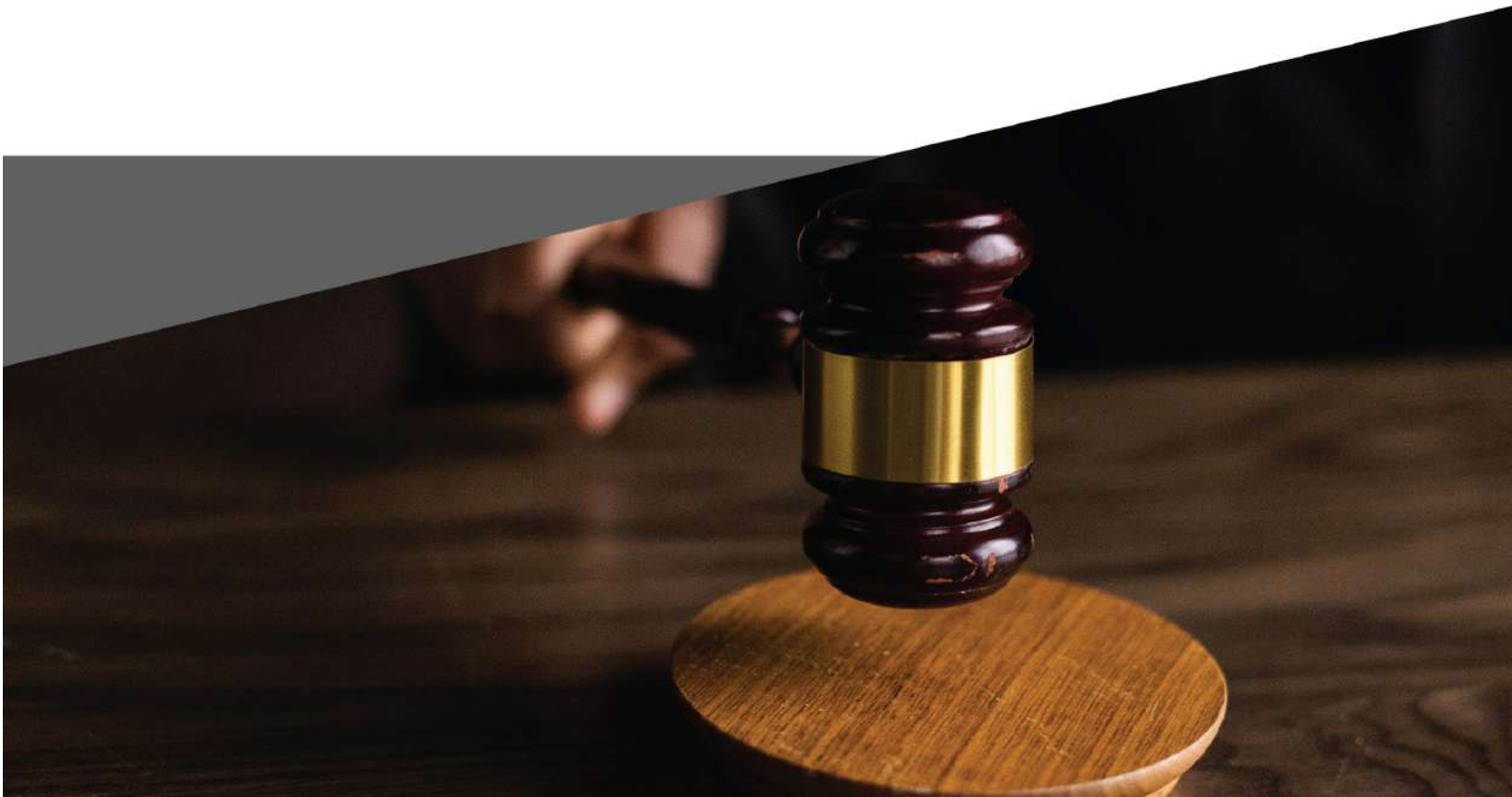
- Efforts are underway to educate and train parties on the use and benefits of the portal. While the parties are gradually gaining confidence in the introduced online platforms, interaction numbers remain relatively low.
- The Council is aware of the high rate of referrals that fall outside its jurisdiction, primarily due to a lack of understanding regarding the roles of the PSCBC and the sector councils. To address this issue, initiatives focused on educating employees and referring parties are crucial, particularly concerning the categorization of disputes.
- It is essential to develop a comprehensive training program that encompasses both theoretical knowledge and practical skills, incorporating case studies and role-playing exercises.
- The Council is committed to launching vigorous initiatives to educate parties and provide clear guidelines on the types of disputes that fall under the jurisdiction of the PSCBC and the sector councils.
- It is important to note that referrals from individual employees are high, and an increasing number of employees are opting for legal representation rather than trade union representation.





SECTION E

RESIDENT PANELLIST



RESIDENT PANELLIST

Background

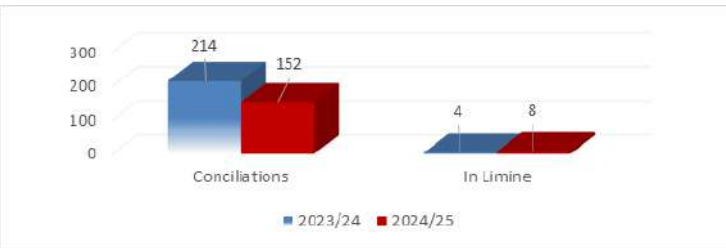
Dispute resolution and prevention are core functions to attaining labour peace. The Resident Panellist Unit provides essential support to the Council towards achieving its strategic objectives. This report reflects on the conciliations and arbitrations conducted by the Resident Panellists from 01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025 with a comparison of the processes conducted in the previous reporting period.

It should be noted that the cases referred to in this report and the subsequent statistics are solely based on the cases that sat before the Resident Panellists, meaning that if a case was withdrawn before the hearing date it would not form part of this report. Therefore, the number of conciliations and arbitrations conducted in this report and the number of conciliations and arbitrations conducted in the Dispute Resolution Unit's report will not always be similar.

Number of Conciliations and In Limine Processes Conducted

A total number of 160 conciliations - of which 8 were in limine processes - were set down and conducted from 01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025 in comparison to 218 conciliations – of which 4 were in limine processes - conducted in the previous reporting period (01 April 2023 to 31 March 2024), resulting in a 27% decrease in the conciliations and in limine processes conducted.

Graph One: Comparison of the number of conciliations & in limine processes conducted



There were 8 in limine processes - where jurisdictional points were raised during the hearing - conducted between 01 April 2024 and 31 March 2025. This represents a 50% increase compared to the 4 in limine processes recorded during the previous reporting period (01 April 2023 to 31 March 2024).



Nature of Dispute

In both the reporting periods, all the conciliations that were conducted were interpretation and/or application disputes.

Cases Attended by Representatives of Unions

There is an overall increase in attendance by Unions at the conciliations conducted from 86% to 89%, with a slight attendance increase from NEHAWU (22% increase from the previous reporting period) and HOSPERSA (12% increase from the previous reporting period).

Table A: A breakdown of attendance of representatives of the Applicant

Applicant	Current Reporting Period				Previous Reporting Period			
	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage
INDIVIDUAL	9	8	1	89%	14	14	0	100%
DENOSA	3	3	0	100%	5	5	0	100%
HOSPERSA	8	8	0	100%	11	9	2	82%
NAPTOSA	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
NPSWU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NUPSAW	4	4	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
NEHAWU	34	33	1	97%	24	18	6	75%
POPCRU	14	12	2	86%	16	14	2	88%
PSA	69	58	11	84%	138	117	21	85%
SADTU	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	11	9	2	82%	3	3	0	100%
SOLIDARITY	4	4	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
SAOU	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
SAEPU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	160	143	17	89%	218	187	31	86%

Cases Attended by Representatives of Unions per Province

There were significant increases in attendance in Gauteng (12%), North West (15%), and Western Cape (36%). However, there were significant decreases in attendance in Eastern Cape (11%) and Mpumalanga (50%).



Table B: Number of conciliations attended by representatives of the Applicant per province

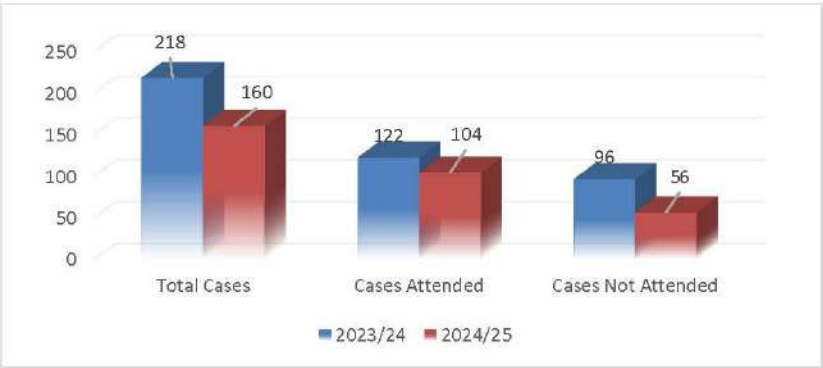
Trade Union	Current Reporting Period				Previous Reporting Period			
	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage	Total Cases	Cases Attended	Cases Not Attended	Attendance Percentage
Eastern Cape								
DENOSA	2	2	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
HOSPERSA	1	1	0	100%	2	1	1	50%
INDIVIDUAL	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NAPTOSA	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
NEHAWU	5	5	0	100%	6	5	1	83%
PSA	15	10	5	67%	8	8	0	100%
SAPU	3	2	1	67%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	27	21	6	78%	19	17	2	89%
Free State								
INDIVIDUAL	1	0	1	0%	3	3	0	100%
NEHAWU	4	4	0	100%	8	6	2	75%
NUPSAW	2	2	0	100%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	3	2	1	67%	1	1	0	100%
PSA	10	9	1	90%	9	9	0	100%
SAEPU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
SAPU	4	3	1	75%	2	2	0	100%
SOLIDARITY	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	26	22	4	85%	24	22	2	92%
Gauteng								
HOSPERSA	3	3	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	-	-	-	-	3	3	0	100%
NEHAWU	7	7	0	100%	6	5	1	83%
NUPSAW	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	2	2	0	100%	5	5	0	100%
PSA	15	13	2	87%	45	35	10	78%
SADTU	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
SAPU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
SOLIDARITY	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	31	29	2	94%	62	51	11	82%
KwaZulu-Natal								
HOSPERSA	3	3	0	100%	4	3	1	75%
INDIVIDUAL	3	3	0	100%	3	3	0	100%
NEHAWU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
NUPSAW	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
POPCRU	1	0	1	0%	2	2	0	100%

PSA	6	6	0	100%	29	27	2	93%
TOTAL	14	13	1	93%	39	36	3	92%
Limpopo								
HOSPERSA	1	1	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	2	2	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
NEHAWU	1	0	1	0%	-	-	-	-
NPSWU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
PSA	5	5	0	100%	5	5	0	100%
SAPU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
TOTAL	10	9	1	90%	9	9	0	100%
Mpumalanga								
INDIVIDUAL	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
PSA	1	0	1	0%	7	7	0	100%
TOTAL	2	1	1	50%	7	7	0	100%
North West								
DENOSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
HOSPERSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
NEHAWU	7	7	0	100%	3	1	2	33%
POPCRU	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
PSA	10	9	1	90%	8	7	1	88%
SAOU	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	19	18	1	95%	15	12	3	80%
Northern Cape								
DENOSA	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
INDIVIDUAL	2	2	0	100%	2	2	0	100%
NEHAWU	-	-	-	-	1	1	0	100%
POPCRU	2	2	0	100%	-	-	-	-
PSA	6	5	1	83%	23	18	5	78%
SOLIDARITY	2	2	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	12	11	1	92%	28	23	5	82%
Western Cape								
DENOSA	1	1	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
NEHAWU	9	9	0	100%	-	-	-	-
NUPSAW	1	1	0	100%	-	-	-	-
POPCRU	5	5	0	100%	8	6	2	75%
PSA	1	1	0	100%	4	1	3	25%
SAPU	2	2	0	100%	1	1	0	100%
TOTAL	19	19	0	100%	14	9	5	64%

Cases Attended by Representatives of Departments

There is an overall increase in attendance of the conciliations conducted from 56% to 65%, with a significant attendance increase from COGTA (100% increase from the previous reporting period), Home Affairs (66% increase from the previous reporting period) and Forestry, Fisheries & Environment (50% increase from the previous reporting period). However, there were significant attendance decreases from Community Safety (75% decrease from the previous reporting period) and Human Settlements (50% decrease from the previous reporting period).

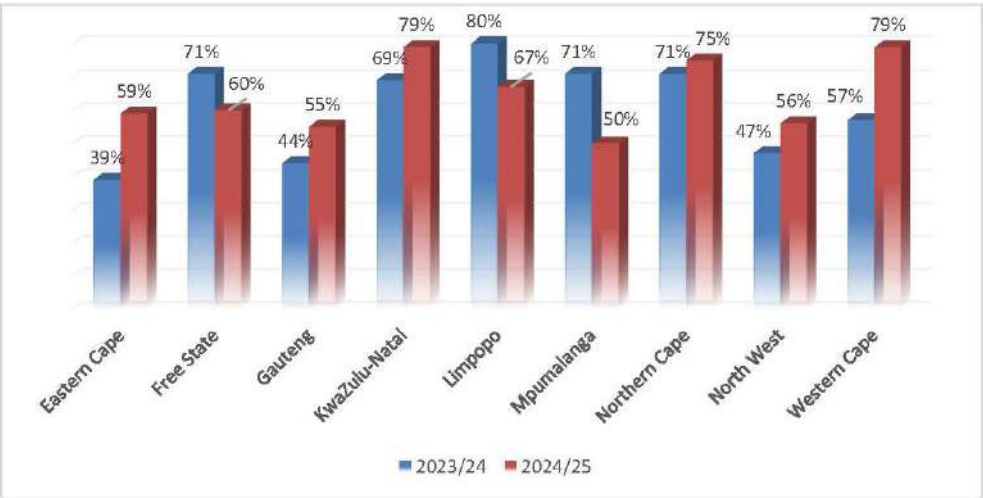
Graph Two: A breakdown of attendance of representatives of Departments



Cases Attended by Representatives of Departments per Province

There were significant increases in attendance in Eastern Cape (20%), KwaZulu-Natal (10%), and Western Cape (22%). However, there were significant decreases in attendance in Free State (11%), Limpopo (13%) and Mpumalanga (21%).

Graph Three: Percentage of conciliations attended by departments per province



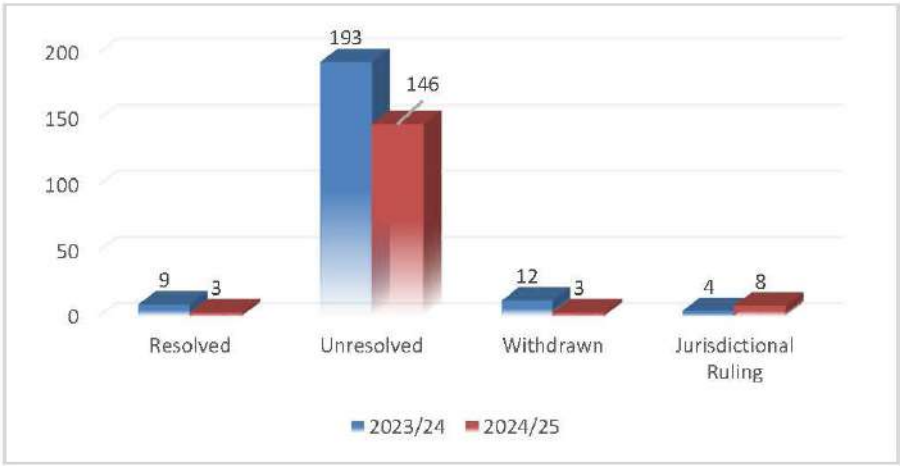
Outcomes of the Conciliations Conducted

There has been a decrease of 2% in the number of matters that have been resolved at conciliation. Unfortunately, there is still mistrust between parties. In some cases, there are settlements between parties, but the Applicant will opt to receive a certificate stating that the matter remains unresolved. This affords the Applicant the opportunity to refer the matter to arbitration in the event of the Respondent not complying with the proposed settlement.

There has been a decrease of 4% in the number of matters that have been withdrawn at conciliations. There has also been an increase of 3% in jurisdictional rulings (in limine processes) that have been made at conciliation, this is due to an increase in parties raising jurisdictional issues at conciliation.

Naturally the decrease in settlements and withdrawn matters has led to an increase of 2% in matters that remain unresolved.

Graph Four: Outcomes of the conciliations conducted



Key PSCBC Resolutions Driving Conciliation Outcomes

The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the conciliations conducted but remained unresolved:

- Disputes relating to Resolution 01 of 2003 (Disciplinary Code and Procedures) - 5% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 39 cases to 37 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 7 of 2000 (Improvement in the conditions of service) - 54% increase from the previous reporting period (from 24 cases to 37 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 14 of 2002 (Grievance Rules) - 79% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 29 cases to 6 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 1 of 2007 (Improvement of salaries and other conditions of service) - 19% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 16 cases to 13 cases).
- Disputes relating to Resolution 3 of 2009 (Revised salary structure) - 10% decrease from the previous reporting period (from 31 cases to 28 cases).

The following PSCBC Resolutions are major contributors in the conciliations conducted that have been resolved:

- Disputes relating to Resolution 01 of 2007 (Improvement of salaries and other conditions of service) - has stayed unchanged from the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 07 of 2000 (Improvement in the conditions of service) - 100% increase from the previous reporting period.
- Disputes relating to Resolution 03 of 2009 (Revised salary structure) - 100% increase from the previous reporting period.

Costs of Conducting Conciliations & In Limine processes

Below is a breakdown of the costs of conducting conciliations and in limine processes from 01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025 totaling R 9 690.82 in comparison to R 13 203.74 in the same period in the previous year which accounts for a 27% decrease in the costs due to the decrease in the number of cases conducted.

The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the conciliations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings that have been made because the conciliations were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

Table C: A breakdown of the cost savings in conducting conciliations

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED COST*
2024/25 – 152	R 1 850.00	R 281 200.00	R 9 206.28	R 271 993.72
2023/24 – 214	R 1 850.00	R 395 900.00	R 12 961.47	R 382 938.53

* Estimated cost: Number of cases x cost per case.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

Table D: A breakdown of the cost savings in conducting in limine processes

NUMBER OF CASES	COST PER CASE	DOCUMENT FEE	ESTIMATED COST*	ACTUAL COST^	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
2024/25 – 8	R 1 850.00	(8 x 500) R 4 000.00	R 18 800.00	R 484.54	R 18 315.46
2023/24 – 4	R 1 850.00	(4 x 500) R 2 000.00	R 9 400.00	R 242.27	R 9 157.73

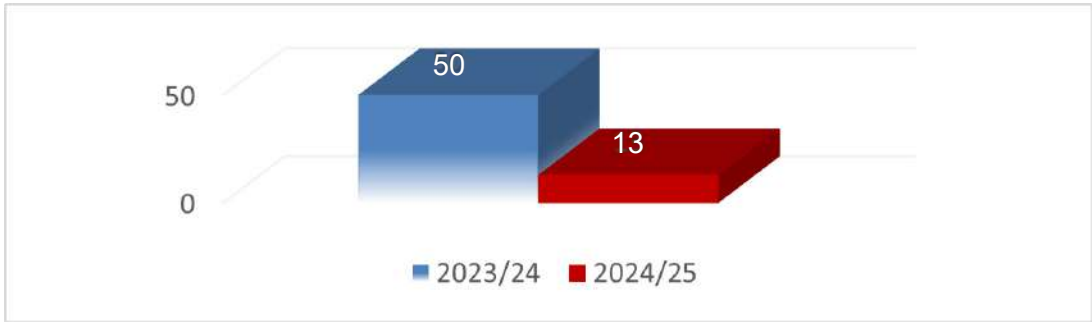
* Estimated cost: Number of cases x cost per case.

^ Actual cost: Amount of conciliations / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries for Panellists for the reporting.

Number of Arbitrations Conducted

A total number of 13 arbitrations were conducted from 01 April 2024 to 31 March 2025 in comparison to 50 arbitrations conducted in the previous reporting period (01 April 2023 to 31 March 2024), resulting in an 74% decrease in the arbitrations conducted.

Graph Five: Comparison of the number of arbitrations conducted



The following is the outcomes for the arbitrations conducted by the Resident Panellist Unit:

- Awards – 100% decrease from the previous reporting period.
- Adjournments – has stayed unchanged from the previous reporting period.
- Postponements – 49% increase from the previous reporting period.
- Jurisdictional Rulings – 1% increase from the previous reporting period.
- Withdrawals – 4% decrease from the previous reporting period.

Cost Savings in Conducting Arbitrations

The table below also indicates the estimated costs for the reporting period if the arbitrations were to be done by our external panel of commissioners. It also indicates the estimated savings that have been made because the arbitrations were done by the Resident Panellist Unit.

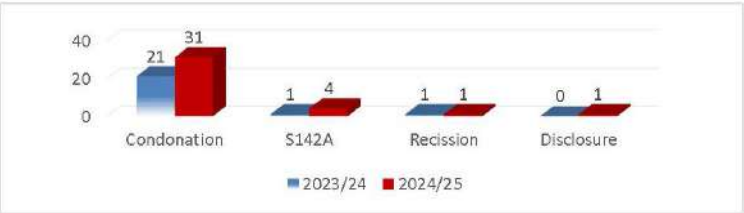
Table F: A breakdown of the costs of conducting arbitrations

NUMBER OF CASES	DOCUMENT FEE	DAILY FEE	ESTIMATED COST *	ACTUAL COST >	ESTIMATED SAVINGS
Adjournment Ruling – 1	(1 x 500.00) R 500.00	(1 x 3 500.00) R 3 500.00	R 4 000.00	R 484.54	R 3 515.46
Jurisdictional Ruling – 2	(2 x 500.00) R 1 000.00	(2 x 3 500.00) R 7 000.00	R 8 000.00	R 969.08	R 7 030.92
Postponement – 9	(9 x 1 500.00) R 13 500.00	(10 x 3 500.00) R 31 500.00	R 45 000.00	R 4 360.87	R 40 639.13
Withdrawals – 1	-	(1 x 3 500.00) R 3 500.00	R 3 500.00	R 484.54	R 3 015.46
* Estimated cost: (Number of cases x document fee) + (number of cases x daily fee)			R 60 500.00	R 6 299.03	R 54 200.97
^ Actual cost: Number of cases x estimated hours the Panellist would have spent / Working hours in reporting period x Salaries of Resident Panellists during reporting period.					

Applications

The Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with dealing with some of the applications received by the Council. These applications include condonation applications, S142A applications and recission applications, to name a few. During the current reporting period a total of 37 applications were received in comparison to the 25 received in the previous reporting period – an increase of 32%.

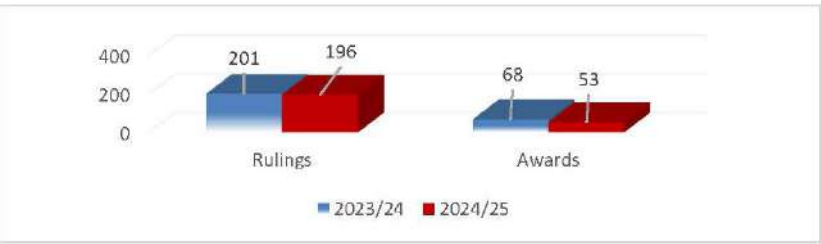
Graph Six: Number of applications dealt with by the Resident Panelist Unit



Quality Control

All the awards and rulings that are issued by the Council's panel of commissioners go through a strict quality assurance process as part of said process the Resident Panellist Unit is tasked with perusing awards and rulings. Below is a breakdown of the outcomes of the perusal process.

Graph Six: Number of Rulings and Awards Perused



There has been a decrease in the number of awards that have been perused by the Resident Panellist Unit during the quality checking process – a 22% decrease. The change is due to a decrease in awards that have been submitted by our external commissioners.

The decrease in the number of awards perused has led to a decrease of 18% in the number of awards that have been qualified (found that the award was in order). The number of awards that had to be updated (an external panellist was requested to make changes) has decreased by 75% (from 4 to 1) between the two reporting periods.

There has been a decrease in the number of rulings that have been perused by the Resident Panellist Unit during the quality checking process – a 2% decrease from the previous reporting period to the current reporting period. This is due to a decrease in the number of rulings that have been submitted by our external commissioners.

The decrease in the number of rulings perused has led to a decrease of 3% (from 200 to 194) in the number of rulings that have been qualified (found that the award was in order). The number of rulings that had to be updated (an external panellist was requested to make changes) has increased by 100% (from 1 to 2) between the two reporting periods.



SECTION F



Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research



Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research

The unit is a technical support function that enables the strategic objectives of the PSCBC to be met across units and council. This was achieved through catalytic support to units and the office of the GS.

Strategic objectives

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation and Research (SMER) Unit within the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) plays an important role by providing the organisation with strategic direction, planning, monitoring performance, evaluation of programmes, and research oversight. The SMER unit is responsible for coordinating the development and implementation of the PSCBC Strategic Plan, Operational plan, and Annual Performance Plan to ensure alignment of PSCBC mandate and objectives.

The SMER unit also promotes organisational coherence, supports Council informed decision-making, through research improving the ability of the Council to respond proactively to emerging labour relations trends within the public service. Furthermore, the SMER unit is also responsible for continuous monitoring and evaluation of all PSCBC programmes, projects, and public sectoral activities to assess performance, impact, and value for money.

The unit supported the development of Council performance indicators; conduct monthly monitoring and periodic evaluation of projects; and produced research reports in alignment with the council's needs. The research and evaluation reports and outputs further contributed to policy development within public sector, improved collective bargaining, and dispute management initiatives thereby reinforcing the mandate of PSCBC to promote sound labour relations through collective bargaining, improve dispute management across public service; advancing and influencing change in the public service labour market environment.

PSCBC STRATEGY 2020-2025 IMPLEMENTATION

The implementation of the PSCBC Strategy (2020–2025) focused on translating the strategic objectives of the Council into actionable programmes and operational plans that support effective collective bargaining, dispute management, and labour relations stability within the public service. This is achieved through aligning annual performance plans, public sectoral work programmes, and organisational resources with the strategic priorities of the Council. The emphasis has been on improving collective bargaining, dispute prevention, and improving stakeholder engagement to ensure the effective execution of strategic interventions.

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS

The PSCBC actively pursued strategic partnerships with key institutions and stakeholders operating within labour and public service sector to advance research, policy development, collective bargaining, and dispute management during the implementation period.

The Council engaged with organisations such as the International Labour Organization (ILO), and the Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA), as well as participating in various national and international labour relations forums.

The engagements included participation in conferences such as the South African Labour Law Conference and the African Labour Law Society Conference in South Africa, as well as the ILERA Africa Conferences hosted in, Zambia. As part of these initiatives, the Council developed and presented conference papers including the National Association of Bargaining Councils, the African Labour Law Conference Mauritius thereby contributing to thought leadership and knowledge sharing within the labour relations and public service environment.

Efforts were made to formalise a strategic partnership with NEDLAC in line with the implementation of PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022. This objective was not fully achieved. Partnership with PSETA proved effective and yielded tangible outcomes, including the implementation of joint research projects that supported the post-training evaluation of the public administration.

Further engagement with PSETA also resulted in the development of a policy and planning curriculum, strengthening skills development and institutional capacity within the public service. These strategic partnerships led to the improvement of research profile of the PSCBC, supported evidence-based decision-making that benefited public service, and reinforced the role of the council in promoting effective labour relations and continuous learning in the public service.

SMER SUPPORT PROVISION Policy Development Support

The unit provided policy development support to other PSCBC units to ensure that the organisational policies are aligned with legislative requirements, governance standards, and best practice within the public service. Through collaborative engagement internal controls, there has been improved operational efficiency, and enhancing accountability and risk management within the PSCBC.

Support to Provincial Chambers

The unit provided support to the Mpumalanga Provincial Chamber in the development of its operational plans and the coordination of skills audit. The support aimed at improving the planning and organisational capacity to identify skills gaps and to inform targeted interventions. Through this support, there was improved operational effectiveness in the implementation of Provincial Chamber's activities aligned with the broader PSCBC strategic objectives and governance frameworks of the PSCBC.

Monitoring the implementation of Collective Agreements

The unit actively monitored the implementation of collective agreements in collaboration with Collective Bargaining Unit, thus agreements concluded between 2010 and 2026 on a quarterly basis to assess progress and compliance across the public service. The monitoring process enabled the Council to track implementation, identification of challenges, and ensure the employer implement the signed agreements. While the majority of collective agreements were fully implemented, some were only partially implemented due to outstanding clauses, and a limited number of agreements remained unimplemented. The monitoring outcomes provide valuable insights to support accountability, inform engagements with stakeholders, and strengthen the overall effectiveness of collective bargaining processes.

Automation of the PSCBC Monitoring System

The automation of the PSCBC Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system on the Collab has been initiated and yet to be completed. The development and implementation of the automation system is at an advanced stage. The system is critical because it is intended to improve efficiency, accuracy, and timeliness of monitoring and evaluation processes by enabling systematic data capture, tracking, and reporting of performance information.

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATION PROJECTS

Development of research projects

In advancing both the current and future research within the areas of labour relations, collective bargaining, dispute management, and overall operation within the public service, the unit undertook and supported a range of research initiatives that informed strategic planning, and evidence-based decision-making within the Council. The research function played a critical role in generating knowledge to support policy formulation, improve collective bargaining processes, and advance dispute resolution management, thereby improving the contribution of PSCBC to a stable and effective public service labour relations environment. The unit successfully undertook and completed several research projects during the period in 2025. These research projects’ deliverables included the compilation of concept notes and research proposals; the execution of empirical research, data collection and analysis; and the producing research reports. These research outputs provided valuable insights into emerging trends and challenges within the public service and labour sector which enabled the council to make informed decisions that contributed to the well-being and effectiveness of the public service.

List of completed research projects	
1. Council Gender mainstreaming assessment report	14. Pay gap research.
2. African Labour law conference report 2023	15. Dispute management.
3. Multiple union membership report 2023	16. Trade union membership
4. Decent work and challenges in the South African public service	17. Development of concept notes and research proposals
5. Collective bargaining in the public service: unveiling lessons for the future.	18. Public administration graduates' longitudinal study
6. Agency payers report	19. Dispute management Referral system
7. Levy payers report.	20. Quarterly reports on Analysis of Mpumalanga Grievances and Misconduct
8. Implementation Evaluation of Public Summit Declaration concept	21. Assessment of Public Administration Procurement Program Learner's withdrawal
9. Dispute management research concept.	22. Evaluating the Implementation of BMA conditions of service
10. Public administration graduates' longitudinal study	23. Analysis of Trade union membership trends 2024'
11. Analysis of the high court ruling on parental leave	24. BMA survey
12. Assessing the City of Tshwane Strike and its implications	25. Mpumalanga Chambers skills gap
13. Assessment of Arbitration/Conciliation Referral Systems in PSCBC and Sector Councils: An In-depth Exploration of Trade Union Perspectives and Empowerment Strategies	26. Evaluation of the PSCBC CSR projects

Book publication

The unit made a significant contribution to the publication of the book titled *From Struggle to Structure: One Agreement at a Time-30 Years of Labour Relations*. The book provides a synopsis of how labour relations in South Africa were affected by the apartheid laws pre 1994, where only the white minority enjoyed labour relations while the majority of the African workers were denied the rights. It then looks at the strides made to promote labour peace, better working conditions of public servants and the freedom of association. The book, also outlines the struggle the workers in the public service faced and how the South African constitution and Labour Relations Act transformed how workers were viewed at the work place and the improvement of policies and collective bargaining processes that led to 30 years of improved social dialogue, labour peace and the signing of various agreements in the public service. The various lessons learnt through the PSCBC provide best practices across the globe and in Africa of how public service can be a tower of hope for public servants. The unit played a critical role in the publication of the book through research inputs, content, analysis, data verification, and editorial support.

PARLIAMENTARY GROUP AND BILLS MONITORING

Parliamentary monitoring group

PSCBC actively monitors submissions made to Parliament each financial year on bills related to public service labour relations. The unit assists in the submissions tracking whether they were duly considered before the final amendment, approval by Parliament, and signing into law by the President. The aim of the monitoring group initiative is to ensure that the council actively engages with legislative processes, and that the interests of public service employees and employer were effectively represented in the formulation and enactment of labour-related legislations.

SMER STAFF CAPACITY BUILDING

The Strategic Monitoring, Evaluation, and Research team participated in a series of targeted capacity-building trainings for M and E skills development, knowledge empowerment and professional competence purposes. SMER staff members participated in Monitoring and Evaluation conferences, attended different trainings, internal capacity-building workshops, and weekly M&E sessions, which provided ongoing opportunities for learning, knowledge sharing, and skills development. Examples include Afrea and SAMEA.

CONFERENCE PAPERS PRESENTATION (5 YEARS)

The PSCBC contributed to knowledge sharing through conducting research, compiling, and delivering presentation of conference papers on key labour and socio-economic issues. Topics presented included Collective Bargaining in South Africa: Maturing Stakeholder Engagements, The Impact of Labour Relations on Socio-Economic Transformation, Labour Relations, National Health Insurance, and Youth Unemployment in South Africa. Abstracts and conference papers were accepted and presented at ILERA Europe conference in the UK, SAAPAM conference in Limpopo and other national conferences.



A background graphic featuring a network of white person icons connected by glowing blue lines on a dark blue background, suggesting a global or digital network.

SECTION G



CORPORATE SERVICES



CORPORATE SERVICES

Overview

The Constitution of the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council provides for the functions and powers of the Council in relation to the finances, which are as follows:

- Establish and administer a fund to be utilized for resolving disputes, collective bargaining and general administration of the Council.
- Raise, borrow, lend, levy and invest funds.

Finance

The Constitution of the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) provides for the functions and powers of the Council in relation to financial management, which as follows:

- The establishment and administration of a fund to be utilised for resolving dispute, collective bargaining and the general administration of the Council.
- Raise, borrow, lend, levy, and invest funds in support of its mandate.

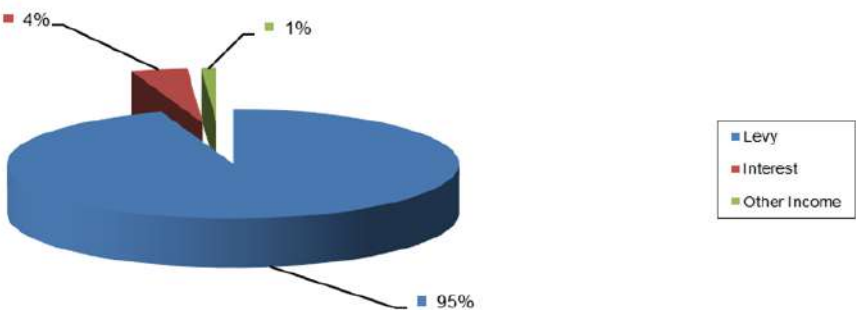
Total Income – Levy Account

The overall income for the Council during the 2024/2025 financial year was R 53 425 630,64 of which:

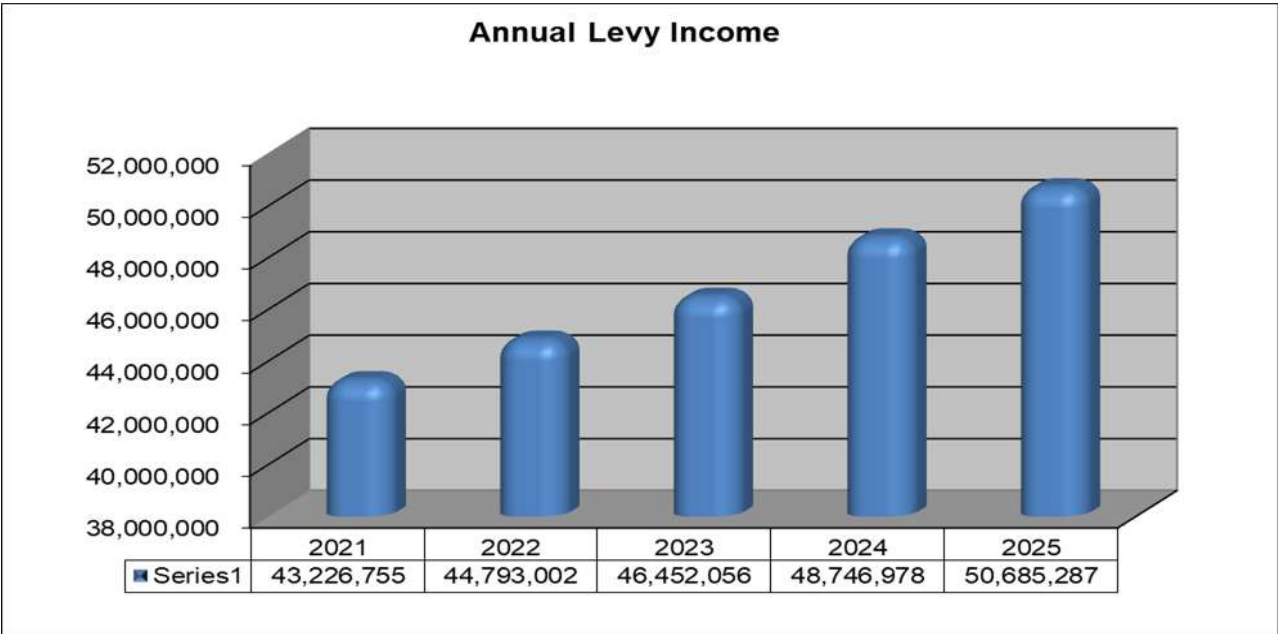
- 95% was generated out of the levies from the public service as per Resolution 2 of 2013,
- 4% was generated from interest earned on levies and reserves,
- 1% was generated from other income.

The levies received of R 50 685 287.00 were higher than the projected income of R 48 746 978.00. Other income total of R 567 747.00 was higher than the projected of R322 100.00 due to the PSETA income received in the current year. Interest income received is also higher than budget due to the negotiated higher investment rate in the current year.

Total Income for the period 1 April 2024 to 31 March 2025



The graph below illustrates annual increases to the PSCBC Levy, based on National Treasury's year-on-year projected Consumer Price Index (CPI) as per Resolution 2 of 2013.

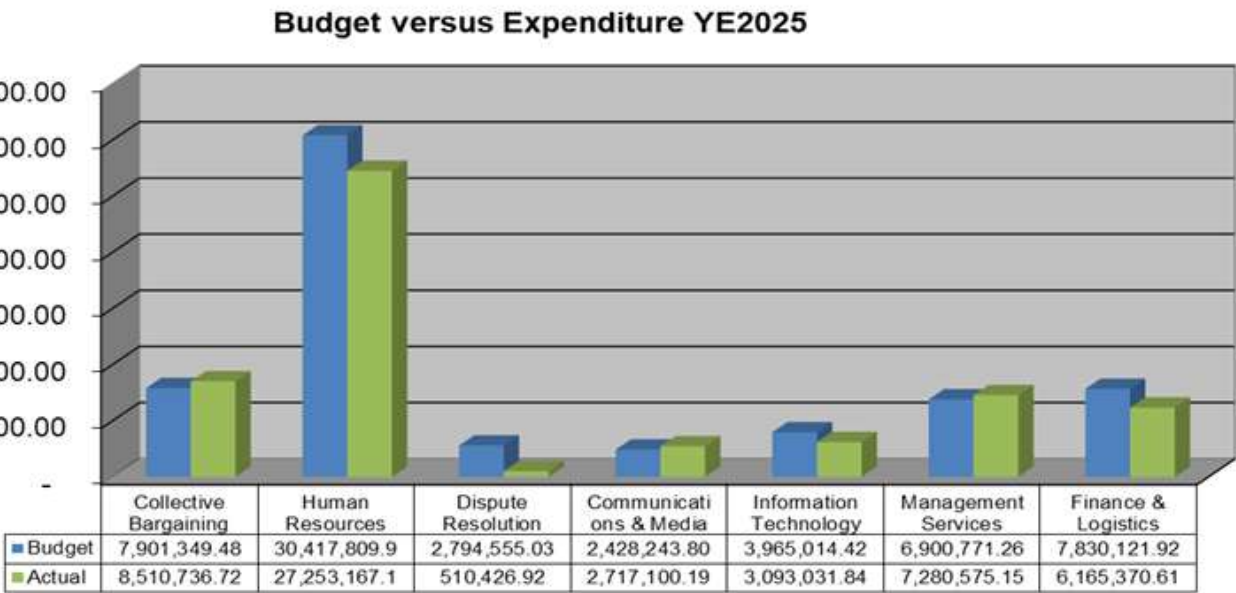


Total Expenditure – Levy Account

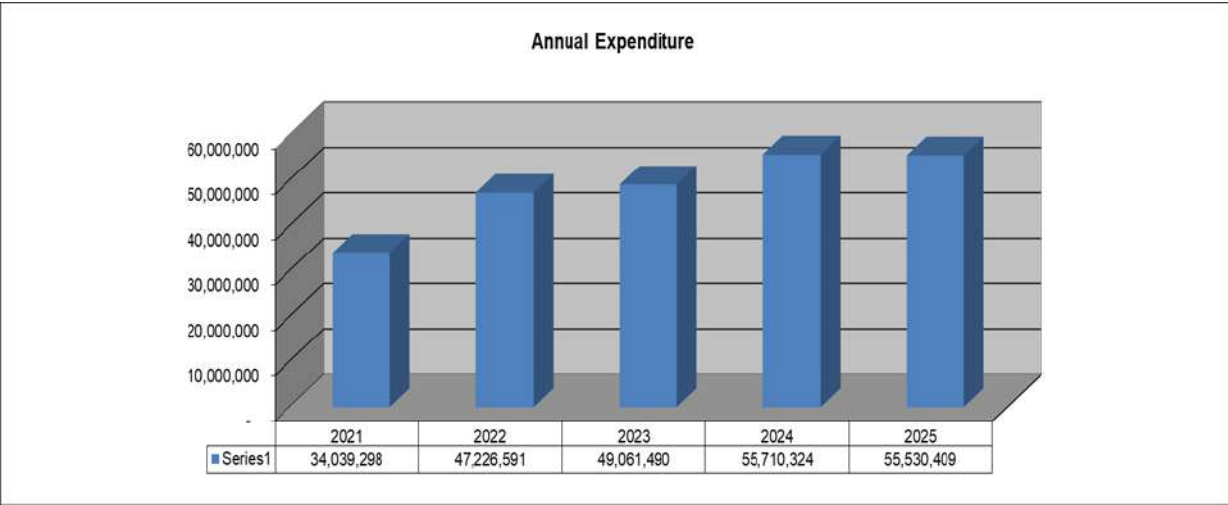
The overall expenditure for the Council during the 2024/2025 financial year amounts to R55 530 409.00 which was lower than the projected expenditure of R 62 237 859.00.

The graph below depicts the departmental expenditures:

Actual expenses per department were lower than budget, except for Collective Bargaining, as well as Management Services. Included in the Collective Bargaining expenditure are the following Council approved events, Public Sector Wage Negotiations and the Workshops on Implementation of Resolutions. Management Services actual expenditure includes the ILERA World Congress and the PSETA National Certificate in Procurement, PSETA Skills Programme in Applying Labour Dispute Prevention Approaches. Human Resources actual expenditure is lower due to vacant positions. Corporate Services budget understated by the non-inclusion of depreciation amount of R 1 791 339.00 being a non-cash item.



The graph below indicates the annual expenditure over the last five years. A decrease in the expenditure graph in 2020/2021 is expected, due to the COVID19 pandemic and the Government's regulation protocol thereon.



Summary of key financial indicators

The below is summary of key financial indicators extracted from the Annual Financial Statements which shows decline in the total assets which has led to the decline in Council's accumulated reserves.

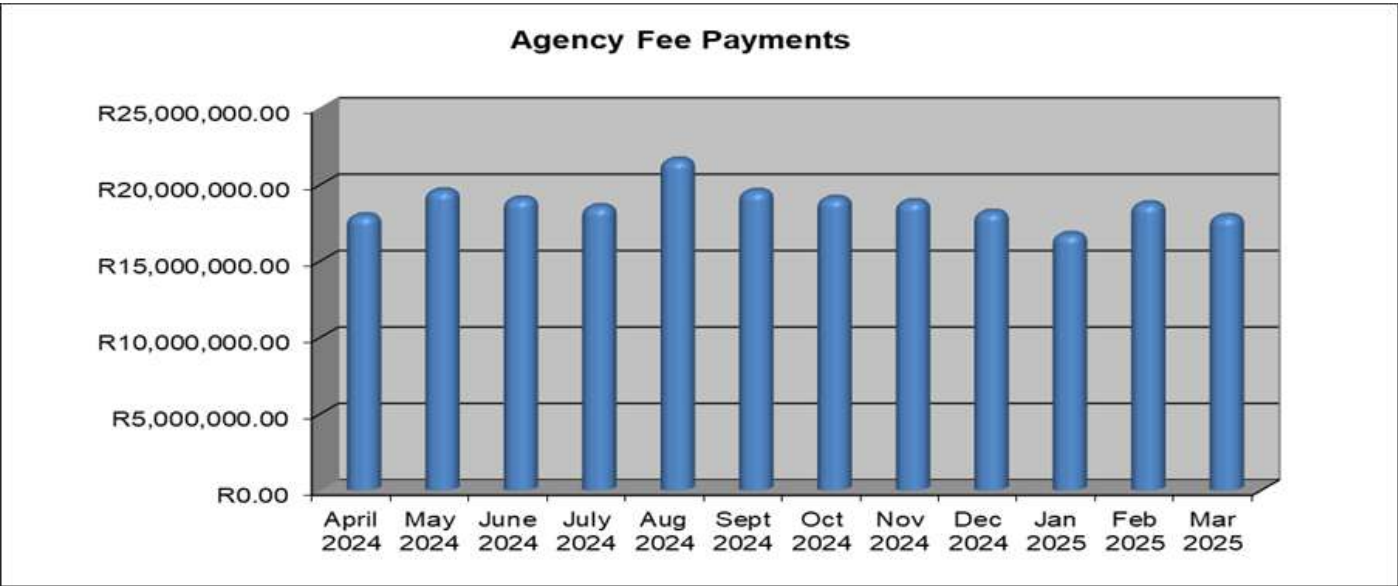
5 Year Financial Performance						
Key Financial Indicators	FY 2024 Actual	FY 2023 Actual	FY 2022 Actual	FY 2021 Actual	FY 2020 Actual	Accumulated Reserves
Levy Income	48,746,978	46,452,056	44,793,002	43,226,755	41,256,024	2016
Investment and Other income	2,715,789	2,195,629	2,738,993	1,314,160	2,348,974	R46.9 Million
Operating Expenses	(55,952,736)	(49,025,634)	(47,226,591)	(34,039,298)	(45,874,033)	2017
Net Surplus/(Deficit)	(4,489,969)	(377,949)	305,404	10,501,616	(2,269,036)	R53.0 Million
Accumulated Surplus Reserves	52,224,718	56,714,687	57,092,637	56,787,233	46,285,617	2018
Total Assets	75,466,314	80,632,226	152,522,250	124,896,870	81,230,096	R52.8 Million
Total Liabilities	23,241,596	23,917,539	95,429,613	68,109,637	34,944,480	2019
Reserve Ratio: March 2019 FY 26,84%						R48.5 Million

Agency Shop Fee Account – Disbursements to Admitted Trade Unions

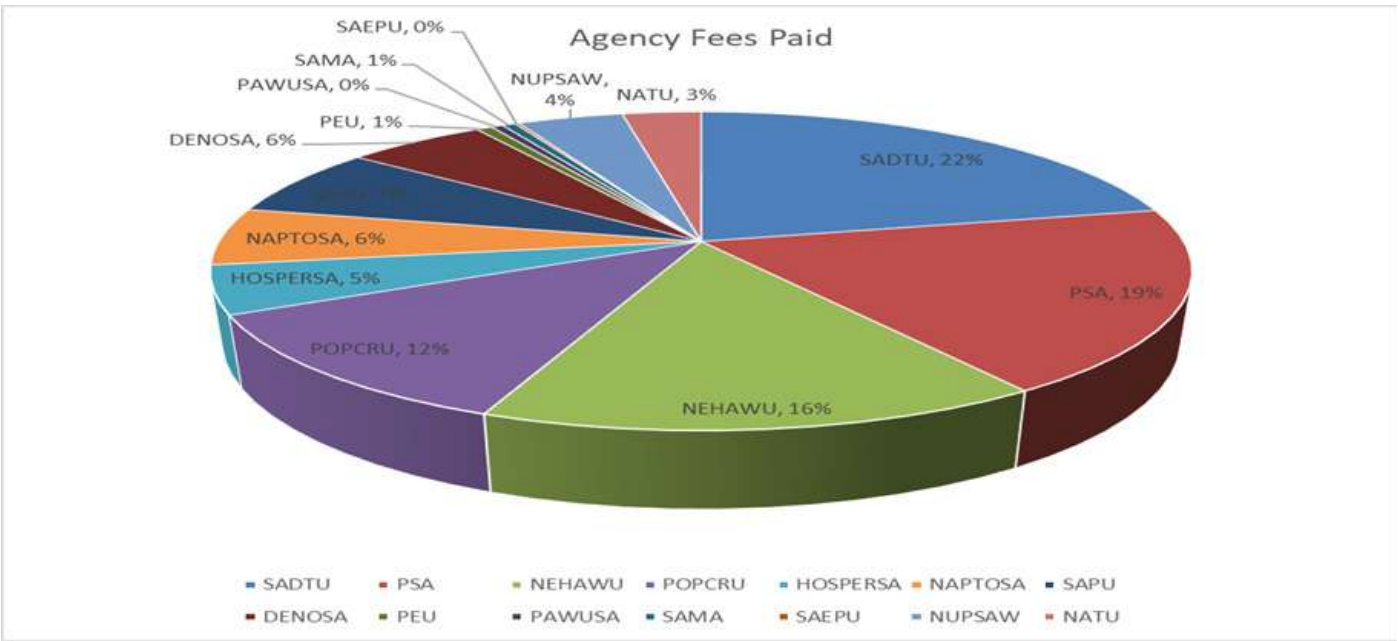
An amount of R226 131 236.52 was received for the 2025 financial year for distributions to the unions. The following legislation and collective agreements, regulate the payment of agency fees.

- Provisions of section 25 of the Labour Relations Act (66 of 1995) as amended.
- Agency Shop Agreement- PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2005
- Agency Fee Agreement- PSCBC Resolution 2 of 2010
- Agency Fee Agreement PSCBC Resolution 1of 2011

The graph below illustrates the total amount distributed to unions per month in terms of Resolution 1 of 2011.



The graph below depict the agency fees paid in accordance to the vote weights:



The PSCBC requires Trade Unions to submit audited financial statements of the separate agency fee accounts by June of each year. Those Unions which do not meet the deadline are entitled to request an extension until the end of September. Should Unions not submit such statements, agency fee payments are withheld until such statements are submitted to the Council.

The Trade Unions audited financial statements are submitted to the Council's auditors. Council auditors report on the usage of funds, to ensure compliance with Section 25 (3) (d) of the Labour Relations Act and PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2005 agency fee accounts by June of each year.



Procurement, Logistics and Facilities

During the 2024/2025 reporting period, the Procurement, Logistics and Facilities function focused on strengthening governance, compliance, and operational support to enable the effective delivery of the Council's mandate. Key priorities included improving asset and facilities management controls and providing efficient logistical support for Council and operational activities. In addition, the unit was tasked with coordinating the development of a new office property building project for the PSCBC, following Council approval. As part of this initiative, the unit also oversaw the planning and development of a new security guardhouse at the entrance of the vacant land earmarked for the office development, aimed at enhancing access control and safeguarding Council property.

Property Development - Die Hoewes Ext 213

During the 2025 financial period, progress was made in the development of the new PSCBC building. This included the completion of bulk service contributions, and the connection and installation of electricity and water meters. Additionally, the rezoning and consolidation rights were approved by the City of Tshwane, following a series of complex town planning processes that the PSCBC successfully navigated.

Architectural Concept Design and Space Planning Needs on the new PSCBC Office Park Development

During the 2025 financial period, progress was made in the development of the new PSCBC building. This included the completion of bulk service contributions, and the connection and installation of electricity and water meters. Additionally, the rezoning and consolidation rights were approved by the City of Tshwane, following a series of complex town planning processes that the PSCBC successfully navigated.

Property Development Project Funding

Council had previously approved that the project would be financed through investment savings. Any requirement for additional funding will be submitted by the Accounting Authority to the Executive Committee for consideration and approval.

Property Development Project Commencement Date

The project is expected to commence in the third quarter of the 2025/2026 fiscal year. The Council is currently in the process of finalizing the bill of project costs and appointing the building contractor.



HUMAN RESOURCES

Overview

As outlined in the 2023/2024 report, Council committed to aligning internal work processes to ensure an accurate fit with the outcomes of the Organisational Work Study and the subsequent Job Evaluation exercise. The 2024/2025 financial year therefore focused on the implementation of these approved outcomes, with an emphasis on strengthening organisational structure, and operational efficiency.

Summary of Staff Statistics

Human Resources Statistics



Staff retention

As an employer of choice, the PSCBC celebrated 15 years' service milestone for four staff members, these service milestones are in addition to the over five staff members that were celebrated in the 2023 – 2024 financial year. This not only impacts on the individuals themselves but also the joint institutional knowledge held by the PSCBC staff complement. Over 40% of our staff complement hold over a decade of service with the council.

Appointments

For the period under review the following appointments were made in a phased approach and in line with the operational requirements of the Council. There was a high vacancy rate in the Monitoring, Evaluation and Research Unit due to the lateral transfer of Ms. Mmathapelo Mongwe from the unit to the Information, Communication and Technology Unit hence the below appointments.

For the period under review, Council continued in its overall commitment to provide opportunities for young graduates to enter and experience the work environment. The PSCBC entered a two months' Work Integrated Learning (WIL) programme with the learner as per the qualification requirements of the Richfield Graduate Institute. The below appointment was made under this programme.

Name	Position	From
Melusi Dube	Officer: Monitoring, Evaluation and Research	01 October 2024
Sonny Motlanthe	Officer: Monitoring, Evaluation and Research	01 January 2025
Contractual appointments		
Shriya Budhram	Assistant Administrator: Collective Bargaining	05 August 2024
Lerato Dimo	Internship programme ICT: Graphic Design	01 September 2024

Name	Work Integrated Learning programme	Duration
Madibuseng Tladi	WIL: Bachelor of Social Sciences in Information Technology	01 October – 30 November 2024

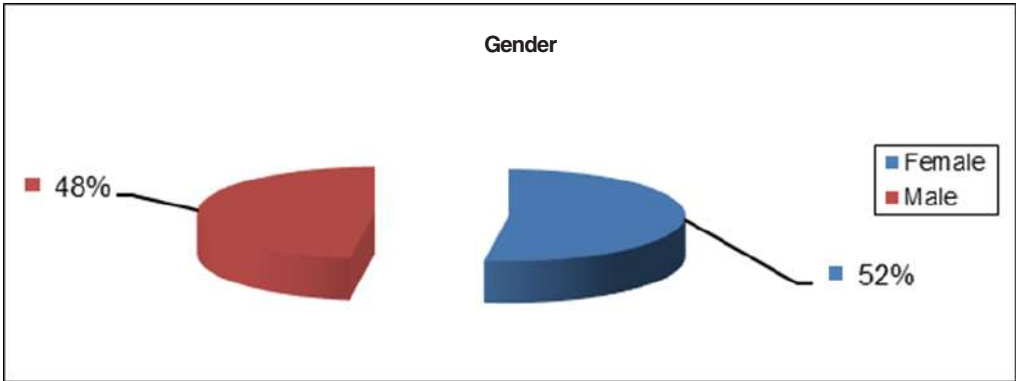
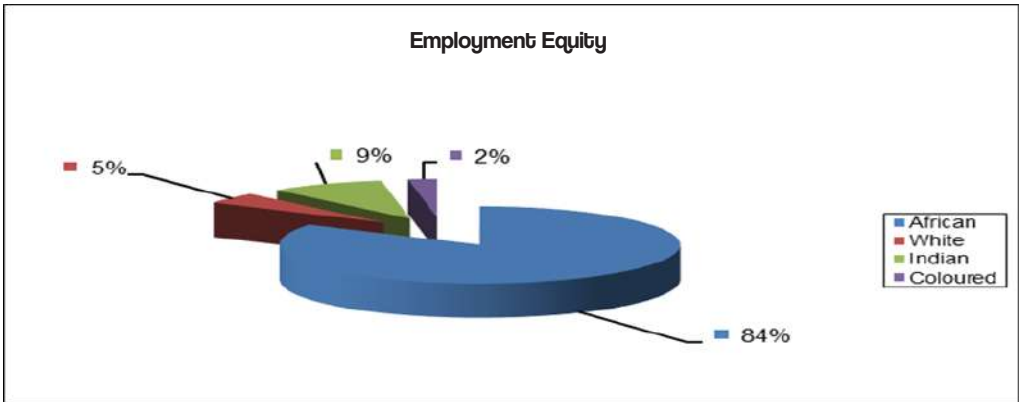
Terminations

The Council prides itself with providing a stepping stone for staff members intending to grow and explore other industries and environments. During the period under review, we bid farewell to the below listed colleagues as per the resignations received.

Name	Reason	Termination Date
Refilwe Msiza	Resignation	07 July 2024
Kwena Manamela	Resignation	30 September 2024
Petunia Bhengani	Resignation	01 January 2025

Profile representation

For the period under review, PSCBC had an overall staff complement of 47 and below are the demographics in terms of race and gender.



Skills Development

The Council continued to focus on training and development of staff through provision of and exposure to training programmes, bursaries, and the provision of National Qualifications Framework (NQF) aligned programmes.

Bursaries Awarded

Bursaries were awarded to 6 staff members in the following disciplines, with 1 completed qualification

- Master of Arts in English Studies, University of Limpopo (UL)
- Diploma in Public Administration and Management, University of South Africa (UNISA)
- Master of Arts in Strategic Communication, University of Johannesburg (UJ)
- Postgraduate Diploma in Labour Law, University of Western Cape (UWC)
- Doctor of Business Leadership, University of South Africa (UNISA)
- Bachelor of Laws, University of South Africa (UNISA)

PSETA Collaboration

Council collaborated with Public Service Education Training Authority for NQF 5 & 6 aligned programmed and 18 staff members were enrolled for the programmes. The disciplines of study included

- National Certificate in Public Administration – Procurement (NQF level 5)
- Skills Programme: Apply Labour and Dispute Prevention Approaches (NQF level 6)

Short Courses, Workshops & Seminars

The coucil capacitated staff members through short courses,workshops and seminars in the following disciplines

- Sage Pastel Essential of Leave and Absenteeism Seminar
- POPIA Act Regulatory short courses (ENS Africa)
- Result Driven Monitoring- and Evaluation Training (Prospen Africa)
- Advanced Executive Secretaries and PA's Master Class (Global Business Events and Training)
- Employee Health, Wellness and HIV/AIDS Conference
- Biennial SAMEA Conference
 - Rapid evaluation for adaptive management: South African insights and practical evaluation approaches
 - Using AI-based approaches (LLMs and NLP) and digital audience segmentation for design and MERL of social and behavior change (SBC) interventions

- CCMA/SALLR Legislation Update (Van Zyl, Rudd and Associates)
- Skills Programme in Advance Accounting (Milpark Education)
- National School of Governance training programmes
 - Basic Writing for Government
 - Advance Writing for Government
 - Know and Live our Constitution
- Introduction to Strategic Planning and Management

The Council has maintained positive feedback from the PSETA with an approved Workplace Skill Plan (WSP) for the 2024/2025 financial year and approved Annual Training Report (ATR) for 2023/2024 financial year. We continue to strive towards training and development of our staff members. Our strategic partnership with the PSETA has yielded positive results with two National Certificates opportunities afforded to staff members.

Employee wellness

For the year under review, Council explored a different approach to employee wellness, with an introduction of wellness boards facilitated through the Office of the General Secretary and re-introduction of Wellness Wednesdays facilitated through the Information, Communication and Technology unit. For the staff year-end a hybrid approach was explored with the formal gift handover taking place in the PSCBC boardroom and a braai function taking place at the office park. The event was a success and was attended by the Chairperson of the PSCBC who assisted in the handing over of gifts to staff members. Staff members also engaged in the Council's traditional exchange of gifts. This is aimed at breaking any barriers amongst staff members, increasing team cohesion and the appreciation of one another as valuable members of the PSCBC team.

The above activities were a further build up to a three-day staff operational planning session. The session was a success with presentation of the reviewed Human Resource policies and engagement with staff on implementation thereof. The event further included Yoga activity, board games and other relaxation activities.

The year ahead

The year ahead will be focused on further implementation of the 2023/2024 targets in implementation of the automation of work processes, to ensure staff members are enabled to perform some Human Resource functions. The process is at an advanced stage and testing has commenced on the system. This includes employee attendance and productivity reporting as well as leave administration. We remain compliant with all statutory provisions and seek to maintain a good standing with regards to Skills Development and Health and Safety of the PSCBC's staff complement.



SECTION H



INFORMATION COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY



INFORMATION COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY

OVERVIEW:

The objective of the Information Communications and Technology (ICT) section is to cultivate a unified and sustainable brand image for the Council by conveying clear and concise messages through relevant communication channels. This initiative aims to forge a robust brand presence for the Council, bolstering its visibility both nationally and internationally.

For the reporting period of 2024/25, the ICT section is subdivided into two key components: Communications and Information Technology.

The communications aspect encompasses a diverse range of components essential for achieving our set objectives; communication, branding, media relations, advertising, strategic brand communication, social media, corporate social responsibility (CSR), the resource centre, events management, stakeholder relations and strategic partnerships.

The technology aspect focuses on two primary areas; Maintenance of information technology and equipment (hardware and software components) and technological innovation by addressing technological gaps while fostering a culture of innovation to propel the Council forward.

This report will provide a comprehensive overview of the activities undertaken within the communications section, followed by an in-depth exploration of the information technology section. By delineating these components separately, we aim to offer clarity and transparency regarding our efforts and achievements in both communication and technology domains.

Through strategic communication initiatives and technological advancements, we endeavour to strengthen the Council's brand presence, foster stakeholder engagement, and drive sustainable growth and impact in the communities we serve. The Information Communication Technology (ICT) unit was formed by combining the Communication and Information Technology units as part of the PSCBC's structural design. This report evaluates the unit's impact on the Council's overall objectives, reach, and visibility.

This section of the report will outline the key activities that were achieved by the Information Communication and Technology Unit.

COMMUNICATIONS:

During the fiscal year 2024/2025, the sub-unit achieved the following amongst others; designed and produced quarterly newsletters, compiled weekly social media plans, designed, and implemented monthly e-mail banners, re-branded the PSCBC buildings, procured PSCBC branded promotional materials, procured the container for on-site storage, printed information brochures.

The sub-unit attended and exhibited at various trade union events to maintain and build quality stakeholder relationships. These events include NEHAWU International Nurses Day, Naptosa Youth Conference, PSA 2024 Annual General Meeting, SADTU 10th National Congress, POPCRU 2024 Central Executive Committee, SAPU 8th Central Executive Committee Meeting, DENOSA Western Cape Provincial 9th Congress, NUPSAW's 2 National General Council and DENOSA 9th National Congress. Due to the collaboration with media houses, the PSCBC was featured in several newspapers and TV following the announcement of the 2024/25 salary increment. The coverage included Radio 702, Radio 786, Power FM, SABC, Newsroom Africa, Business Day, City Press, SABC News, Eyewitness, News24, IOL, Business Insider Africa and Daily Maverick.

The sub-unit successfully held several events to promote and showcase council's mandate advance and influence change in the labour market environment, as well as its Corporate Social Responsibility program-an initiative designed to give back to local communities.

WEBSITE:

During the financial reporting period, the website stood as the central hub and repository for all online visitors in search of information concerning the PSCBC. Its significance was paramount in the dispersion of all PSCBC-related data and materials. An intentional and unified endeavour was made to uphold uniformity across all communication channels employed, including social media platforms and the website.

The tables and graphs below provide statistics on website usage and highlight the importance of the website. These include the number of visitors, number of new visitors, and pages viewed. A visitor is a term used in web analytics to refer to a person who visits a site at least once within the reporting period. Each visitor to the site is only counted once during the reporting period, so if the same IP address accesses the site many times, it still only counts as one visitor.

New Visitors refer to people who have accessed the website for the first time. Pages refer to the number of pages opened within the website, including links that are contained within pages.



2024/25	Visitors (K)	New Visitors (K)
April - 2024	12 258	9737
May - 2024	5412	4509
June - 2024	7510	6506
July - 2024	7685	6530
August - 2024	9398	8077
September - 2024	6535	5429
October - 2024	8661	7546
November - 2024	6701	5500
December - 2024	5002	4024
January - 2025	9956	8365
February - 2025	10769	8506
March - 2025	8772	7204
Total	98 659	81933



Comparison of Visitors

The graph below shows a comparison of the number of visitors to the website for the 2023/2024 and 2024/25 Financial Years.



Visitors to the PSCBC website decreased from an average of 8 942 visitors in 2023/2024 to an average of 8 222 visitors in 2024/2025. This drop could be due to factors like changes in content relevance or user engagement strategies. This shift could be due to various factors, such as changes in online engagement strategies or updates to the website's content and user experience.

Summary of New Users

The graph below shows a comparison of the number of new visitors to the website for the 2023/2024 and 2024/25 Financial Years.



New visitor numbers to the PSCBC website dropped from an average of 7 458 new visitors in 2023/2024 to an average of 6 828 new visitors in 2024/2025. This decline might be attributed to factors like reduced outreach efforts or less impactful content targeting new users. This decline might be attributed to factors like reduced outreach efforts or less impactful content targeting new users.

Social Media

Social media is a powerful, efficient and effective communication tool that is used to disseminate information to a multitude of people, and in the 2024/25 financial year, it was used strategically to promote, educate and maintain brand visibility. Its power and influence were evident during this financial year as it played an indispensable role to solicit discussions on our social media pages, especially on Facebook and Twitter.

A weekly social media plan was carefully crafted, scheduled and implemented on a weekly basis, which is the contributing factor to why we have seen an exponential growth on all our social media platforms.

The plan includes topical posters/ messages on various issues affecting stakeholder, commemorative and PSCBC events. The posts generated huge interest, implored discussions from followers, and gave them a platform to air their views and concerns. Their opinions gave us an opportunity to evaluate and tactically institute posts according to feedback received. We are pleased to report that in this financial year, we added three social media platforms (Instagram, LinkedIn and YouTube), which brings the social media pages to five. While Facebook was used predominantly in this financial year, we have also seen growth in engagements on Twitter.



Listed below are statistics and information on our Social Media platforms:

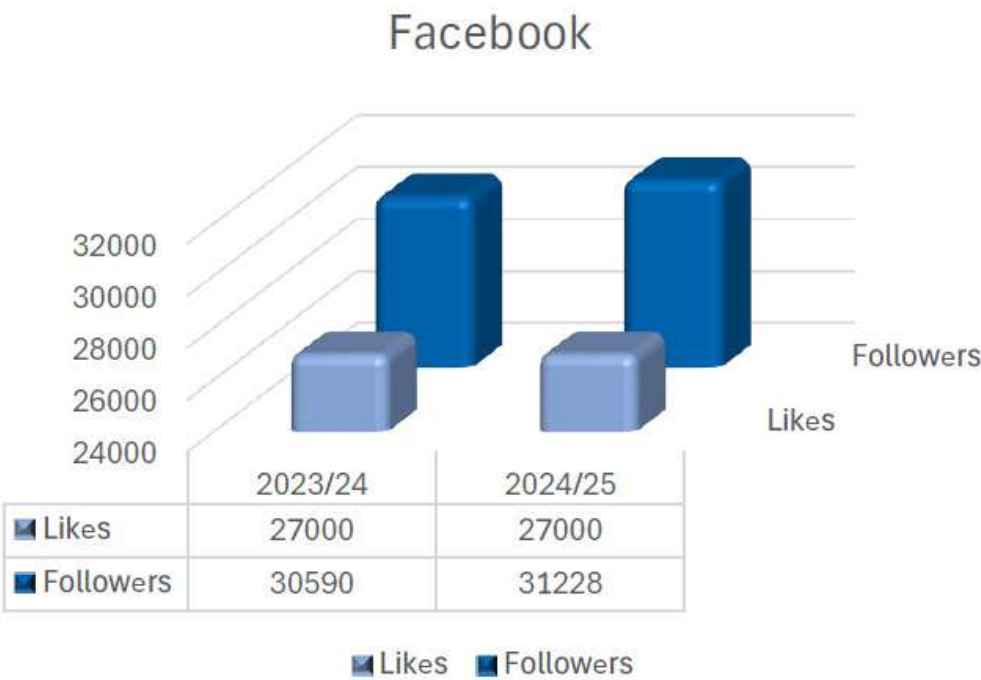
Facebook



PSCBC Bargaining Council

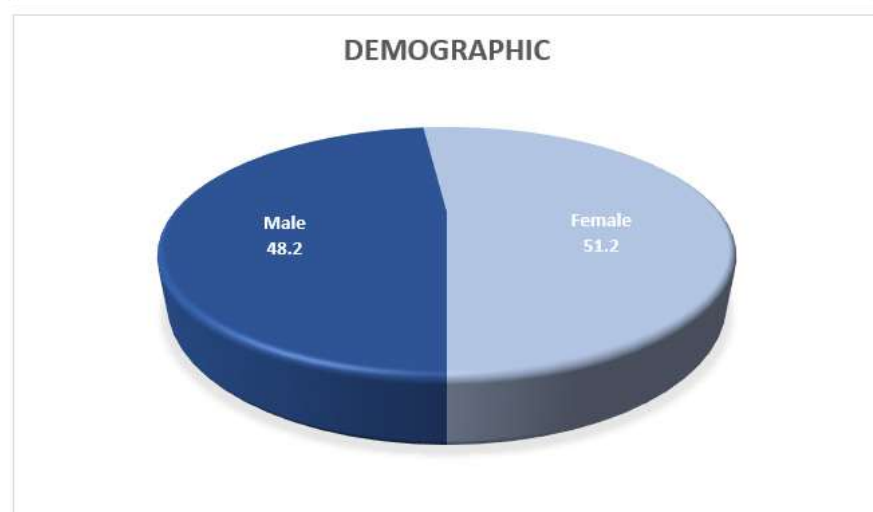
<https://www.facebook.com/pscabc.council?fref=ts>

The graph below illustrates the comparison between likes and followers for the 2023/2024 and 2024/2025 financial years:



Summarised below is the aggregate demographic data of people who like the PSCBC Facebook page. Countries of origin and cities within South Africa are also included. This is based on the age and gender information that subscribers to social media provide in their user profiles:

Ages	Male	Female	Total
18-24	0,6%	0,5%	1,1%
25-34	8,8%	7,1%	15,9%
35-44	19,5%	17,0%	36,5%
45-54	11,4%	10,8%	22,2%
55-64	3,9%	4,4%	8,3%
65+	7,6%	8,4%	16,0%
Total	51,8%	48,2%	100,0%



Top Countries	PSCBC Followers
South Africa	94.4%
Botswana	0.7%
India	0.2%
Nigeria	0.2%
Lesotho	0.1%
Saudi Arabia	0.1%
United Arab Emirates	0.1%
United Kingdom	0.1%
United States	0.1%
Vietnam	0.1%

Top Cities	PSCBC Followers
Pretoria, South Africa	8.1%
Cape Town, South Africa	8%
Durban, South Africa	4.7%
Soweto, South Africa	3%
Johannesburg, South Africa	2.7%
Bloemfontein, South Africa	2.4%
Port Elizabeth, South Africa	2.3%
East London, South Africa	2.2%
Polokwane, South Africa	2%
Pietermaritzburg, South Africa	1.7%

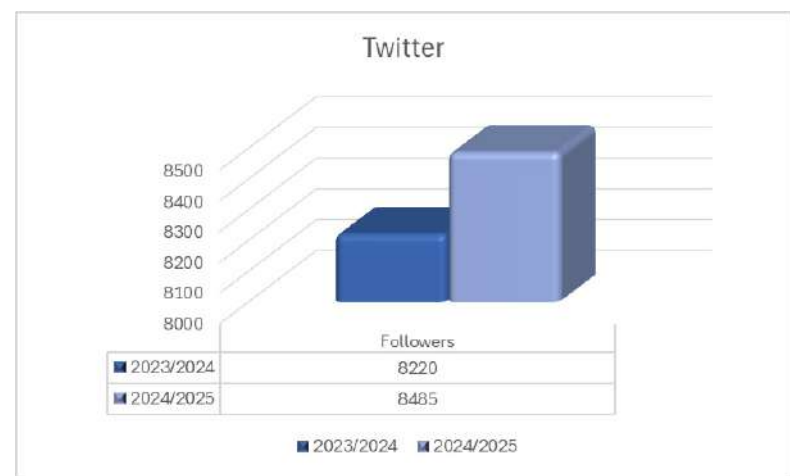
X



@pscabcnews

<https://twitter.com/pscabcnews>

Listed below are the number of followers on our X page for the 2023/2024 and 2024/2025 financial years:

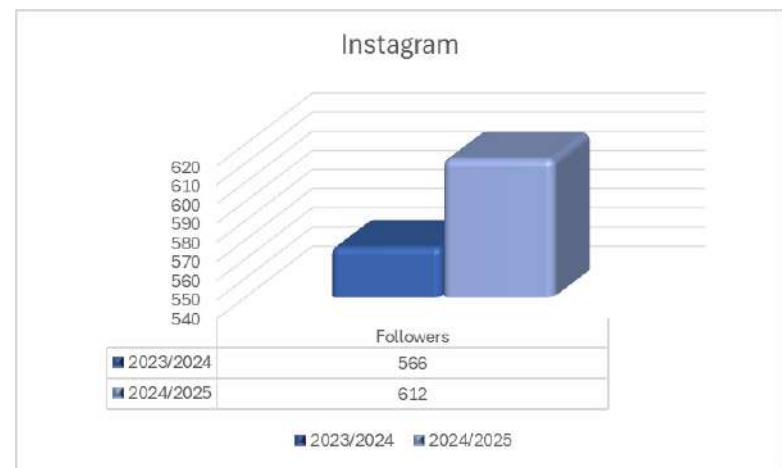


Instagram



@pscabc_sa

https://www.instagram.com/pscabc_sa/



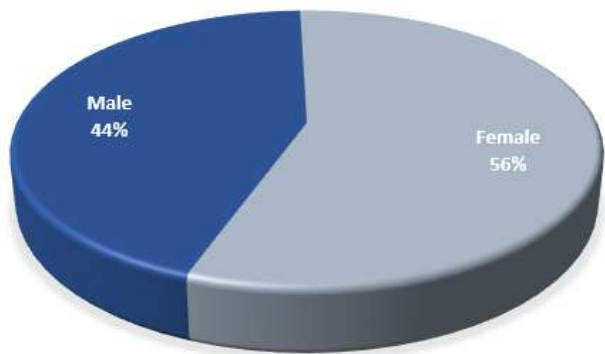
The PSCBC created an Instagram Account on 18 May 2021.

The PSCBC has in total of acquired a total amount of 312 followers for the period 18 May 2021 – 31 March 2025.

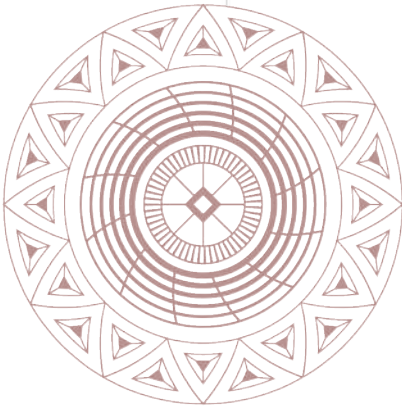
Summarised below is the aggregate demographic data of people who follow the PSCBC Instagram page. Countries of origin and cities within South Africa are also included. This is based on the age and gender information that subscribers to social media provide in their user profiles:

Ages	Male	Female	Total
18-24	1.1%	1.9%	3%
24-34	11.8%	8.2%	20%
35-44	16.2%	15.4%	31.6%
45-54	13.8%	11.0%	24.8%
55-64	7.1%	3.4%	10.5%
65+	6.0%	4.1%	10.1%
Total	56%	44%	100%

DEMOGRAPHIC



Top Countries	PSCBC Followers
South Africa	89.9%
Nigeria	4.2%
Zimbabwe	0.7%
Kenya	0.5%
United States of America	0.3%
Myanmar	0.2%
Namibia	0.2%
Pakistan	0.2%
Algeria	0.2%
Botswana	0.2%



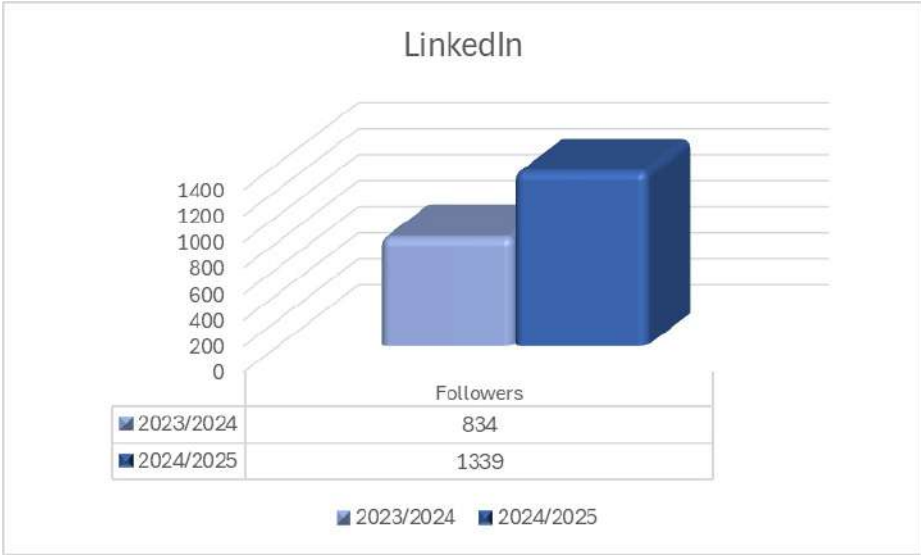
Top Cities	PSCBC Followers
Cape Town, South Africa	25%
Pretoria, South Africa	10,80%
Johannesburg, South Africa	6,40%
Centurion, South Africa	6%
Bloemfontein, South Africa	3,10%
Durban, South Africa	2,50%
Polokwane, South Africa	1,80%
Sandton, South Africa	1,60%
Soweto, South Africa	1,50%
Kimberley, South Africa	1,30%

LinkedIn



Public Service Co-Ordinating Bargaining Council

<https://za.linkedin.com/company/public-service-co-ordinating-bargaining-council>



The PSCBC has acquired 1 339 followers for the period 23 May 2021 – 31 March 2025.

Summarised below is the aggregate demographic data of people who follow the PSCBC LinkedIn page. Countries of origin and cities within South Africa are also included. This is based on the age and gender information that subscribers to social media provide in their user profiles:

Industry	Total
Government Administration	15.5%
Legal Services	7.5%
Law Practice	5.8%
Law Enforcement	3.4%
Human Resources Services	3.3%
Higher Education	2.9%
Government Relations Services	2.8%
Transportation, Logistics, Supply Chain and Storage	2.4%
Financial Services	2.2%
Business Consulting and Services	1.7%
Motor Vehicle Manufacturing	1.5%
Alternative Dispute Resolution	1.4%
Retail	1.4%
Education Administrative Programs	1.3%
IT Services and IT Consulting	1.3%
Hospitals and Health care	1.3%
Construction	1.2%
Non-profit Organizations	1.1%
Mining	1%
Other	41%
Total	100%

Location	PSCBC Followers
Johannesburg, South Africa	36.5%
Pretoria, South Africa	16.1%
Durban, South Africa	6.8%
City of Cape Town, South Africa	6.7%
Port Elizabeth, South Africa	2.5%
Polokwane, South Africa	2.5%
Bloemfontein, South Africa	2.1%
East London, South Africa	1.8%
Germiston Metropolitan Area, South Africa	1.6%
Sol Plaatjie, South Africa	1.3%
Other	24.6%
Total	102.5%

YouTube

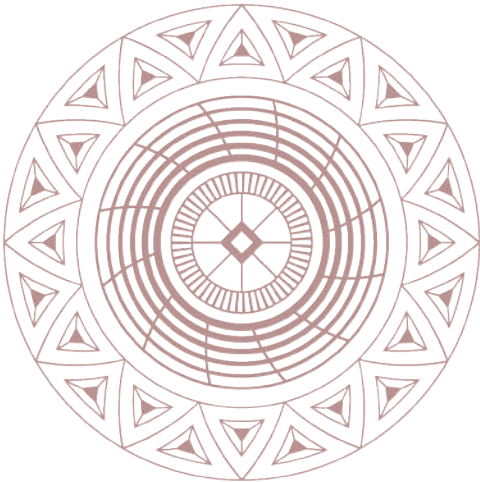


PSCBC Channel

<https://za.linkedin.com/company/public-service-co-ordinating-bargaining-council>

The PSCBC uses YouTube as a social media channel to upload our videos. The channel has a total of 112 subscribers, and we have uploaded 34 videos since the creation of the channel in 2020. Below is an illustration of the various videos and the number of views:

 CASE LAW HIGHLIGHT-SEXUAL HARRASSMENT 1 view • 9 days ago	 PSCBC Women's Month feature 57 views • 5 months ago	 01 September Case law Highlights 106 views • 5 months ago	 PSCBC Women's Month 23 views • 6 months ago
 Mandela Day Project 7 views • 6 months ago	 PSCBC Case Law Highlights 50 views • 6 months ago	 PSCBC Case Law ~Updates DCS vs Kutu 81 views • 8 months ago	 PSCBC Case Law Review: Labour Appeal Court Case: City of... 257 views • 10 months ago



INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Throughout the reporting period, the ICT Unit remained focused on reducing downtime, optimizing system performance, and proactively maintaining IT assets to support the Council's operational productivity. As part of efforts to strengthen governance and align IT operations with industry best practices, the unit also drafted an updated and comprehensive IT Policy.

This revised policy builds on the existing framework and is designed to guide the responsible use of IT resources, clearly define user responsibilities, and establish up-to-date standards for data security, and acceptable use. Once finalized and adopted, it will serve as a critical tool for promoting compliance, accountability, and consistency in the management of the Council's ICT environment.

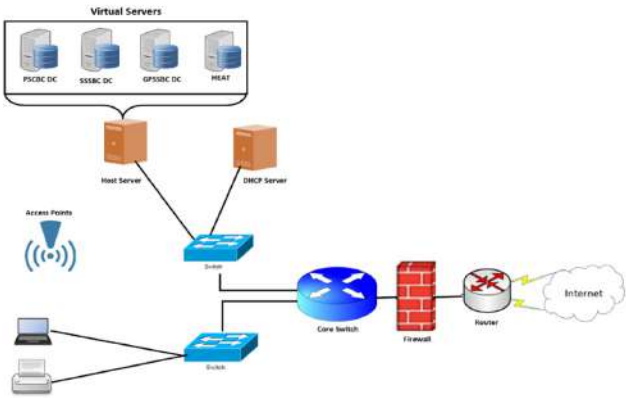
In line with its commitment to improving infrastructure, the ICT Unit successfully completed a major upgrade of the Council's Boardroom B Audio-Visual (AV) System. This enhancement significantly improved the quality and effectiveness of meetings, presentations, and virtual engagements, particularly in response to the growing demand for seamless hybrid communication capabilities that support both in-person and remote participation.

Additionally, the ICT Unit facilitated the upgrade of a select number of user laptops, targeting devices that were approaching end-of-life or no longer met the organization's performance requirements. These upgrades were aimed at enhancing device performance, strengthening security, and ensuring compatibility with modern productivity tools, particularly in support of the Council's Microsoft 365 environment and evolving hybrid work needs.



Network

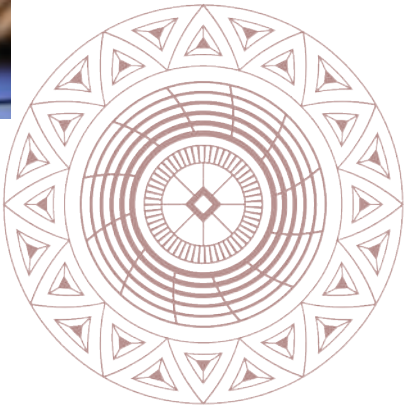
The ICT Unit continually monitors and maintains the network to ensure high availability, optimal performance, and protection against cyber threats. The PSCBC network integrates both wired and wireless connectivity, ensuring flexibility and mobility for users while maintaining performance and security. Below is the visual representation of the PSCBC network topology, illustrating the placement and interconnection of routers, switches, wireless access points, and the firewall.

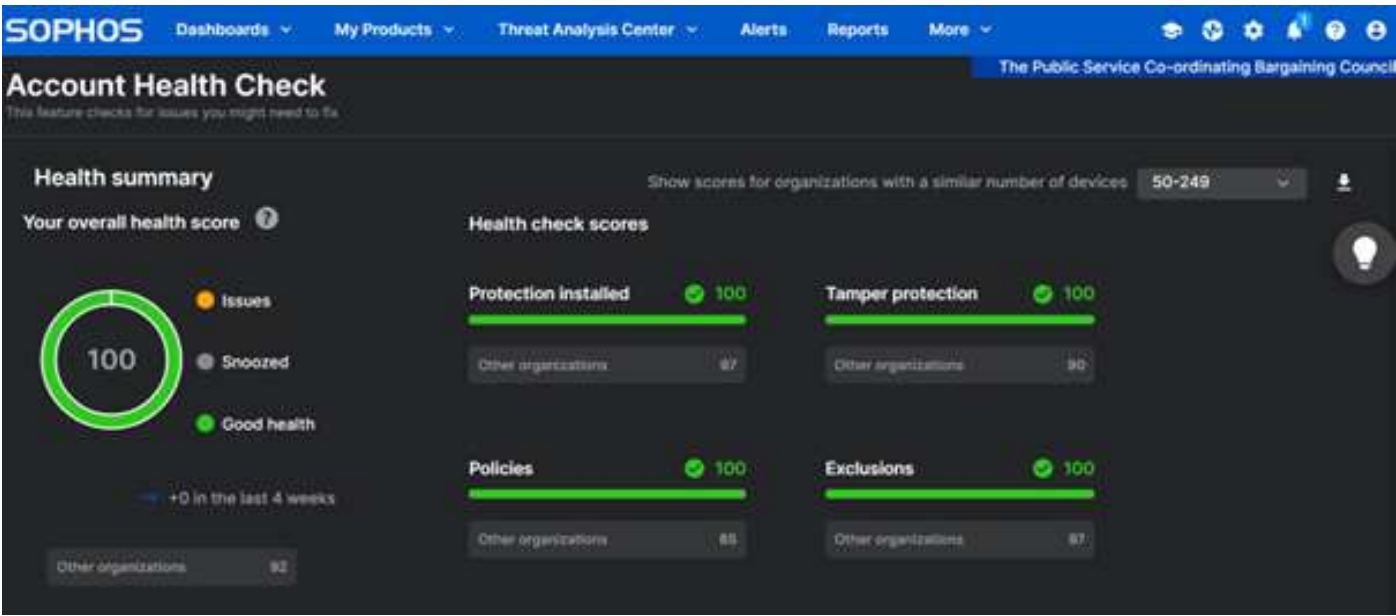


Endpoint Security

As part of its ongoing commitment to cybersecurity, the PSCBC utilizes Sophos Antivirus as its primary endpoint protection solution. Sophos provides advanced, real-time threat detection and response capabilities, ensuring that all organizational devices are safeguarded against viruses, malware, ransomware, and other cyber threats.

The Sophos platform offers a centralized security management dashboard, allowing the ICT Unit to monitor and manage the security status of all endpoints across the organization. This enables rapid response to any incidents, application of timely updates, and consistent enforcement of security policies. Throughout the reporting period, Sophos has played a critical role in maintaining the security and integrity of PSCBC's IT environment.

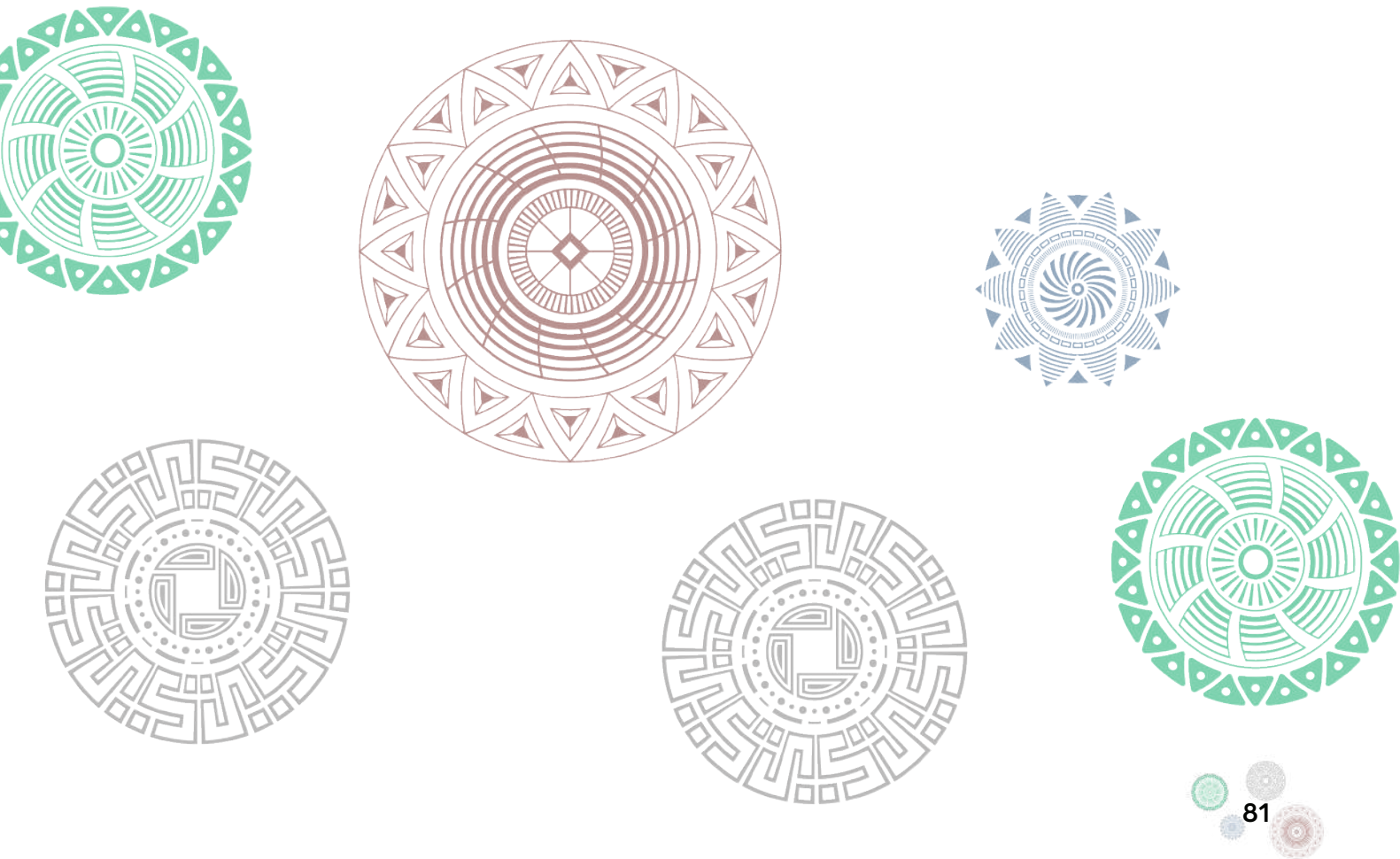




Backup and Disaster Recovery

Ensuring the resilience and continuity of the Council's critical systems and data remained a key priority for the ICT Unit during the reporting period. Backups are performed regularly, with offsite storage in place to reduce the risk of data loss due to system failure, cyber incidents, or other disruptions. The unit is actively monitoring and overseeing the process to ensure that data is securely backed up and readily recoverable when needed.

In alignment with best practices, the ICT Unit also developed a draft Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP) to update the existing framework. The revised DRP outlines the processes, responsibilities, and infrastructure required to restore critical systems and services in the event of a major disruption, ensuring minimal downtime and business continuity. Once finalized and approved, this updated plan will strengthen the Council's overall ICT risk management posture and provide clear guidance for timely, coordinated recovery efforts.



EVENTS & CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

As a unit, we continue to engage and promote the services of PSCBC through various communication vehicles such as events, CSR initiatives and attending and exhibiting at stakeholder events. Below are the activities engaged in this year:

Finalisation of the PSCBC Dispute Resolution Workshops



On May 8th, 15th, 18th, and 20th of 2024, the PSCBC successfully concluded its recent four provincial Dispute Resolution workshops in North West, Northern Cape, Free State, and KwaZulu-Natal. The primary objective of these workshops was to enlighten stakeholders on various resolutions, including the Enforcement of Collective Agreements (Resolution 3 of 2023), Grievance Procedure (Resolution 2 of 2002), and the unveiling of the latest tools - the e-referral and portal platforms.

This initiative is designed to collectively shape the future of dispute resolution. The workshops garnered participation from labour unions, government labour relations officers, and PSCBC chamber leadership.

Ms. Dimo, the Chairperson, and Mr. De Bruin, the General Secretary, played prominent roles in presiding over and facilitating the workshops.

Mr. De Bruin presented Resolution 3 of 2023, and Resolution 2 of 2002, and introduced the newly developed e-referral and portal platforms. Moreover, the workshops provided an opportunity to conduct presentations to Mr. Mbulayeni Netshifhefhe, the Resident Panellist Manager, Ms. Bhengani, the Dispute Resolution Senior Manager, together with Ms. Macheko, the Senior Officer, and Ms. Kok, the Senior Officer Resident Panellist, as part of the greater goal to empower young leaders in the council.

Throughout these workshops we received positive feedback from the delegates. They commended the General Secretary for organising and educating them on the new developments within the PSCBC. Notably, over 700 delegates attended these ten workshops, exemplifying the wide distribution and impact of PSCBC-branded promotional materials.



Lesotho Study Visit

On the 8th and 9th of May 2024, the PSCBC hosted a delegation from the Lesotho Ministry of Public Service and their labour counterparts. This 2-day event was dedicated to a benchmarking exercise centred around the practice of collective bargaining within the public service sector. The delegation sought to acquire comprehensive insights into various critical aspects of collective bargaining, including funding models, constitutional formation, dispute resolution mechanisms, the scope of the public service, institutionalisation measures, and the identification of both successes and challenges.

The event commenced with Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, the General Secretary of the PSCBC, extending a sincere welcome to the Lesotho delegates on the first day. This was followed by an address from Mr. Alexio Musindi, the International Labour Organization (ILO) Director for the Country Office, and Mr. Limpho Mandoro, ILO's Social Dialogue and Labor Administration Specialist. They provided an overview of Lesotho's ratification of Convention 151: Labor Relations (Public Service), highlighting key areas such as freedom of association and the process of conducting collective bargaining in the public service.

A detailed historical account of the PSCBC's development, the establishment of the PSCBC, the amendment of the Labour Relations Act of 1995, and the relevance of the Bill of Rights section 3 on labour relations was presented by the GS, Mr De Bruin. Subsequently, Ms. Valencia Kola, the PSCBC's Senior Manager of Collective Bargaining, provided a comprehensive overview of the PSCBC's constitution.

Mr. Joseph Mahlalela then presented on behalf of Ms. Sharlaine Oodit, General Secretary of the GPSSBC, focusing on sectoral-level collective bargaining, dispute resolution, and operational structure.

Following the conclusion of the first day's proceedings, a dinner was hosted in Centurion for the delegates, council members, and EXCO members.

The second day commenced with a welcome address from Ms. Ingrid Dimo, the PSCBC Chairperson, and brought forth in-depth discussions on public service bargaining councils. Insightful presentations were made by PSCBC Vice-chairperson Labour, Mr





Aubrey Zungu, Vice-chairperson Employer, Mr Mompoti Galorale, Ms. Petunia Bhengani, Senior Manager of Dispute Resolutions, and Mr. Wandile Mgobhozi, Senior Manager of Finance and Support Services, stimulating further discussions. The ILO and the Lesotho delegates expressed their appreciation to the PSCBC leadership for hosting the informative sessions. The PSCBC extended its best wishes to the Lesotho delegation and expressed hope that the insights gained during the benchmarking exercise will contribute to the effective implementation of collective bargaining within the public service of Lesotho.



NEHAWU International Nurses Day



The PSCBC participated in the NEHAWU International Nurses Day event on the 10th of May 2024, at Thelle Mogoerane Hospital, as per the invitation. The event, themed “NHI now to free nurses of the psychosocial traumas of the two-tier healthcare system,” was attended by NEHAWU NOBs and dignitaries from SANC, PSCBC, and PHSDSBC, with Cde Kgomotso Makhuphula leading the programme.

During the event, the PSCBC General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, delivered a moving tribute, acknowledging the invaluable contribution of nurses to the public service. He expressed the PSCBC’s commitment to collaborating with NEHAWU to ensure equitable working conditions, adequate compensation, and professional development opportunities for all nurses. Mr De Bruin emphasised the significance of the National Health Insurance (NHI) bill in alleviating the psychological trauma associated with the two-tier healthcare system and hailed it as a monumental victory for nurses in South Africa.

Subsequently, Mr Mike Shingange, President of NEHAWU, commended the nurses for their dedication and highlighted the pivotal role of the NHI in the healthcare system of South Africa, acknowledging the historical challenges faced by nurses in advocating for fair labour practices.

The PSCBC’s exhibition stand garnered significant interest, enabling the distribution of over 180 promotional materials. The nurses appreciated the gifts and the PSCBC’s presence at the event.



27th Annual General Meeting



The Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) convened its 27th Annual General Meeting on the 13th of June 2024 in Magaliesburg. This event held particular significance as it followed the successful hosting of the 2024 General National Elections by the Independent Electoral Commission (IEC) on the 29th of May 2024, coinciding with the country's commemoration of 30 years of democracy. The AGM was organised under the theme "30 years of democracy - towards labour peace, social justice & economic development."

The meeting saw attendance from trade union leadership, the Director General and Deputy Director General of the Department of Public Service and Administration (DPSA), Sector Bargaining leadership, and Council members. Notably, this event entailed the election of the Chairperson, Vice-chairperson Employer, and nominations of Executive Committee members.

Ms. Dimo presided over the meeting, extending an official welcome to all members present. Before proceeding, a moment of remembrance was observed for the late PSCBC vice-labour, Cde KC Matome, who passed away in December 2023. Following this, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, the General Secretary of PSCBC, delivered a comprehensive annual report outlining the council's performance. Subsequently, the recently appointed external auditors presented the financials, during which they announced the council's attainment of an unqualified audit report, indicating the fair and transparent nature of its financial statements. After the presentation, the annual report, financial statements, and vote weights were adopted. In addition, the AGM served as an occasion to bid farewell to a longstanding council member, Ms. Suzan Ntlatleng, who was going on retirement. The council members engaged in the election process for the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson Employer and nomination of Executive Committee members, ending in the re-election of Ms. Dimo as the chairperson and Mr. Galorale as the Vice-Chairperson Employer for the ensuing two years. Ms Dimo officially concluded the meeting.



Later in the day, an evening function was organised to honour and acknowledge the dedicated service of PSCBC staff members with over 10 years of tenure. The following staff members were recognised:

- Ms. Makgaretsa (10yrs)
- Ms. Molaudzi (10yrs)
- Mr. Mgobhozi (10yrs)
- Mr. Parag (25yrs)
- Ms. Bhengani (10yrs)
- Ms. Singh (15yrs)

Throughout the day, employer and labour representatives expressed appreciation and commendation for Mr. De Bruin's exceptional leadership as the General Secretary of PSCBC, heralding his continual stewardship of the secretariat.

NAPTOSA Youth Conference



On June 27th, 2024, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) was present at the inauguration of the NAPTOSA youth conference and the launch of their youth desk at the OR Tambo Garden Courts. This occasion marked Youth Month and focused on key issues such as mental health, gender-based violence awareness, school safety, marginalised groups, and teacher professionalism.

Mr. Thabo Manne, president of NAPTOSA, underscored the significance of engaging and diversifying the youth. He emphasised the youth desk's role in promoting honesty, integrity, and the personal and professional development of NAPTOSA youth, particularly in addressing mental health challenges in schools.

Representing the PSCBC, Senior Officer Dispute Management Ms Koketso Mocheke and Officer Chambers Mr Tseke Mphahlele attended the event on behalf of the General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin. Mr De Bruin expressed the council's support for the NAPTOSA Youth Desk, aligning with the council's mission for youth inclusivity.

The PSCBC's efforts in advancing youth development were highlighted, particularly the development and empowerment program at Stanza Bopape School and the employment of 8 young interns.

Additionally, Mr Basil Manuel, the Executive Director of NAPTOSA, discussed the organisation's significant contributions to the curriculum and labour relations, emphasising their positive involvement in the BELA bill.

The event was attended by prospective teachers from various provinces, expressing the need for more advanced digital teaching administration and procedures. The PSCBC commended the leadership of NAPTOSA and its youth desk leadership on a successful inaugural youth conference, further indicating our support by sponsoring the event with branded materials.



PSCBC Attends The South African Police Service Women’s Day Celebration

The PSCBC attended a celebratory Women's Month event hosted by the South African Police Service (SAPS) on 8th August 2024 at the Arcadia Hotel. The event, held under the theme "Division Visible Policing and Operations," was aimed at honouring women police officers for their significant contributions to law enforcement and crime prevention. PSCBC Senior Manager- Dispute Resolution, Ms. Petunia Bhengani delivered a message of support on behalf of General Secretary Mr. Frikkie De Bruin.

She highlighted the significant presence of women within SAPS, emphasizing that it is breaking down gender stereotypes. She also referenced the PSCBC Resolution 01 of 2022 Summit Declaration, which calls for recognising the roles of women, youth, and people with disabilities in the workplace, advocating for equal opportunities, and the eradication of discriminatory practices, harassment, and victimisation.

Several speakers addressed critical issues at the event, including gender-based violence, women were encouraged to speak out when facing challenges both professionally and personally.

Among the prominent attendees were high-ranking women police officers, including the Deputy National Commissioner Policing, Lieutenant General TC Mosikisiki. She praised the SAPS Generals for initiating the event, recognising the vital role that women play in combating crime and maintaining order within the SAPS.



Lieutenant General Mosikisiki emphasised the need to address the loss of experienced women in the SAPS and urged senior managers to change the narrative by preserving and sharing their knowledge. Colonel Monyebudi echoed this sentiment, calling for greater investment in women, highlighting them as the pillars of society. She stressed the importance of implementing SAPS' succession plan to allow younger generations to ascend to leadership roles.

The event was a powerful reminder of the need to continuously support, uplift, and recognise the women in the South African Police Service, ensuring that their voices, contributions, and leadership are central to the fight against crime and the advancement of gender equality within the Police service.



PSCBC Provincial Chambers Mental Health Workshops



As part of an initiative programme to capacitate provincial chambers, the Collective Bargaining Unit in the PSCBC facilitated a series of mental health workshops entitled 'Well-being Voices' during August and September 2024.

These workshops, that were conducted across the PSCBC provincial chambers, aimed to address mental health and psychosocial issues that are often overlooked in the workplace. The initiative was part of the implementation of PSCBC Resolution 01 of 2022, specifically Clause 5.5, which stemmed from the Public Service Summit.

This clause highlighted parties to council's commitment in developing, training, and creating capacity building programmes aimed addressing how matters related to mental health and psychosocial issues are to be dealt with in the workplace. The workshops were facilitated by mental health experts and focused on raising awareness about mental well-being, building self-awareness, peer support, and group counselling.

The workshops were highly interactive, with a strong emphasis on group participation and practical application. They demonstrated a holistic approach to mental well-being in the workplace, providing participants with both theoretical knowledge and practical tools for improving their mental health and supporting others. The initiative saw strong attendance across all nine provinces, further strengthening the need for mental health awareness and the required action in public service workplaces.



PSETA Skills Training Workshop



The PSCBC and GPSSBC (General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council), in partnership with the Public Service Sector Education & Training Authority (PSETA), launched a highly impactful hybrid skills programme on labour and dispute prevention approaches across all nine provinces.

This two-month-long initiative was aimed at enhancing the skills of public servants and union representatives by equipping them with practical tools for preventing and managing disputes in the workplace. The programme attracted over 600 public servants from both national and provincial government departments, as well as representatives from trade unions admitted in the PSCBC.

Through comprehensive learning modules, participants were guided in dispute resolution mechanisms, negotiation strategies, and conflict management skills, enabling them to handle workplace issues more effectively. This initiative was a key effort in improving the overall efficiency and professionalism of public servants, contributing to better governance and service delivery in various government departments. The collaboration between PSCBC, GPSSBC, and PSETA ensured that participants received high-quality training tailored to the specific needs of the public service sector.





PSCBC Hosts Workshop On Medical Aid Board Composition

On the 23rd July 2024, the PSCBC convened a workshop at the Royal Elephant Hotel and Conference Centre to address the critical issue of board composition rules for medical aid schemes. The workshop focused on understanding the legal framework governing medical aid schemes and the role of the PSCBC in ensuring compliance with board composition requirements.

The day started with General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin providing delegates with a warm welcome, and Chairperson Mrs. Ingrid Dimo there after provided an overview of the session. The workshop covered a range of topics, including an overview of the medical schemes industry, emerging trends, and relevant legislation. The implementation of PSCBC Resolution 04 of 2017, which outlines specific guidelines for the composition of governance and transparency of medical aid schemes in South Africa. The workshop delved into the implications and implementation of PSCBC Resolution 04 of 2017, which provides specific guidelines for the composition of GEMS boards. As one of the Council's mandates providing clarity on board composition rules and ensuring adherence to resolutions signed within the PSCBC, it aims to enhance the governance and transparency of medical aid schemes. This includes promoting inclusivity in board membership and establishing clear guidelines for the decision- making processes.



PSCBC Attends PSA 2024 Annual General Meeting



The Public Servants Association Of South Africa (PSA) hosted its highly anticipated Annual General Meeting (AGM) in Cape Town, where a week of insightful addresses, strategic discussions, and forward- thinking commissions took place. The gathering set the stage for a powerful vision for the future of South Africa's public service.



On Day 1, the Honourable Minister for Public Service and Administration, Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi, delivered an impactful keynote address. Minister Buthelezi emphasized the importance of public service excellence, setting an inspiring and productive tone for the week. His address highlighted the need for a united public service workforce to tackle the challenges facing the country. Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, General Secretary of the PSCBC, addressed the audience, offering a message of support. Mr. De Bruin reminded delegates that unity was key to success, stressing how collaboration within the sector could lead to meaningful change.

The PSCBC showcased its commitment to public service excellence through its exhibition stand, highlighting its ongoing work.

Day 2 continued with a strong momentum. The session began with an inspiring address from Riefdah Ajam, representing the Federation of Unions of South Africa (FEDUSA).

Ajam's speech energized delegates, focusing on the strength of collective action and the importance of strategic foresight. Following the address, delegates broke into commissions, engaging in discussions that shaped new strategies to enhance the PSA's influence on the workforce and public service.

On Day 3, Mrs. Sharlaine Oodit, General Secretary of the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC), and Mr. Mpumelelo Sibiyi, General Secretary of the Public Health and Social Development Sectoral Bargaining Council (PHSDSBC), addressed the attendees. Both leaders spoke about the future of public service, emphasizing the importance of leadership in building a stronger, more resilient workforce. Their insights added valuable perspectives as the AGM continued to foster dialogue aimed at shaping the future of South Africa's public sector.

As the PSA AGM progressed, the focus remained on developing strategies that would drive transformation, unity, and progress in the public sector. The AGM also reinforced the vital role of the PSCBC in advancing and influencing the labour market.

As an organization committed to providing sound labour relations within the public service, the PSCBC stands at the forefront of fostering unity and cooperation between government and public sector employees.



PSCBC Exhibits At The SADTU 10th National Congress



The South African Democratic Teachers Union (SADTU) successfully hosted its 10th National Congress from 25-28 September 2024 at the Birchwood Hotel & OR Tambo Conference Centre in Kempton Park. The congress brought together education leaders, union members, and key stakeholders under the theme: "Mobilizing the consciousness of revolutionary professionals in strengthening foundational and functional learning and advancing inclusive and sustainable economic growth in pursuance of a socialist society." The congress provided a platform to address the critical issues facing South Africa's education system and to forge strategies to strengthen the sector in line with the country's broader socio-economic goals. SADTU's focus on promoting a free and democratic education system remained at the heart of the discussions.

A significant highlight of the event was the address that was delivered by both the Honourable Deputy President of South Africa, Mr. Paul Mashatile and Honourable Deputy Minister of Basic Education, Ms. Reginah Mhaule. Both speakers echoed the importance of transforming the education sector to ensure quality learning for all.

They also highlighted the recent signing of the Basic Education Laws Amendment (BELA) Bill into law by Honourable President Cyril Ramaphosa, commending this as a revolutionary step towards improving the quality and accessibility of education in South Africa. The BELA Bill is seen as a significant and commendable change, aligning with the principles of the Bill of Rights, as it enshrines every child's right to learn.

The PSCBC exhibited at the congress, with representation from senior manager for collective bargaining Ms Valencia Kola and Senior Manager for ICT Mr Oomang Parag. The PSCBC provided promotional branded gifts to delegates attending the congress to demonstrate its support as a council at the forefront in labour matters.





PSCBC Attends The DPSA Webinar On Implementation Of The Public Service Charter

On the 25th September 2024 the PSCBC had the honour to attend a webinar hosted by the Department of Public Service and Administration. The webinar focused on the Implementation of The Public Service Charter under the theme #The Government that works for you. The Senior Manager for ICT Mr Oomang Parag representing the PSCBC, had the opportunity to deliver an overview, trends and developments regarding the Public Service Charter (PSCBC Resolution 01 of 2013) His discourse delved on upgrading service excellence, explaining the role of the PSCBC in advancing the Public Service Charter. Mr Parag then went on to moderate the second session which focused on Experiences on the implementation of the African Union Charter, a Zambian perspective.

The webinar provided an insightful and enlightening information covering additional key topics such as the Employee Health and Wellness Program as a Mechanism to improving working environment for public servant, Gender equality and equity and Experiences related to the implementation of the African Union Charter.

The event proved to be a great success, providing valuable informative sessions with engaging discussions that sparked meaningful engagements among delegates. Mr. Poloko Segale, Director OFA, delivered a vote of thanks to all delegates attending the webinar bringing the session to closure

PSCBC And Sector Councils Wellness Wednesdays

The PSCBC together with the sector councils, GPSSBC, PHSDSBC, SSSBC, to advocate and champion issues surrounding the overall wellbeing of employees introduced an initiative to host fitness Wednesday. This was also a way of creating awareness amongst staff members on mental & physical health and highlight the importance of physical activity as a way to achieve a healthy mind and body. In the recent years, the importance of mental health has gained significant attention, and one of the most effective ways to enhance mental well-being is through physical fitness.

The initiative also yielded an opportunity to motivate all bargaining councils to participate in group fitness activities or team sports to foster social connections, which are essential for mental health. Building relationships with other sectors through shared fitness goals can provide support, encouragement, and a sense of community. We have held 4 successful sessions over the past 6 weeks which included aerobics with a personal trainer and 3KM fun walk. These were fun and challenging sessions, however staff members were dedicated, and the turnout was commendable.

The program is a build up to the very much anticipated Bargaining Councils Sports Day event, which is set to be held in October during mental health awareness month. The PSCBC is proud to be part of this tremendous initiatives and constantly positioning itself at the forefront of employee wellness programs.

PSCBC Heritage Day Celebration

In celebrating Heritage month the PSCBC hosted a significant Heritage Day event on the 27th September 2024, for staff members. The primary purpose of this gathering was to promote social cohesion and celebrate the rich and diverse cultural history of South Africa.

One of the key objectives of the event was to highlight the importance of learning and understanding our different South African languages. Activities included vibrant cultural performances, as well as reciting of poetry/ idioms, figures of speech, and proverbs in various home languages. Staff members also had the opportunity to share the meanings of their names, enhancing their understanding of colleagues' names. Staff members thoroughly enjoyed the event, expressing their appreciation for the opportunity to engage and learn more about the diverse cultures within the organisation. By embracing our cultural heritage, we continue to foster stronger relationships and a more inclusive environment.



Joint PSCBC And Sector Bargaining Councils Sports Day Promotes Mental Wellness

On 11 October 2024, the PSCBC, in collaboration with the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC), Safety and Security Sectoral Bargaining Council (SSSBC), and Public Health and Social Development Sectoral Bargaining Council (PHSDSBC), hosted a Joint Sports Day at Lyttleton Sport Park.

The event was held in honor of Mental Health Awareness Month, with the primary objective of promoting mental well-being, physical activity, and social engagement among staff members. Designed to foster a sense of community and encourage healthy lifestyles, the day brought together staff from the participating councils in a spirit of camaraderie and collaboration.



A variety of sporting activities, including netball, soccer, and tennis, took center stage as council staff members competed energetically for trophies in their respective sporting codes. The day's activities served not only as a platform for friendly rivalry but also as a celebration of solidarity, teamwork, and shared goals among colleagues.

The Sports Day was a resounding success, providing an opportunity for staff to connect, unwind, and reflect on the importance of maintaining a healthy work-life balance. It also underscored the critical role of physical activity in supporting overall mental health and wellness.

By combining fun, fitness, and a strong message of unity, the event reinforced the value of prioritizing mental well-being in the workplace, leaving participants motivated and inspired to pursue healthier lifestyles



PSCBC & GPSSBC Celebrate PSETA Graduation Ceremony



The PSCBC and the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC), in partnership with the Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA) and VB Skills, proudly hosted a memorable graduation ceremony on 28 November 2024 at the Premier Hotel in Midrand.

This special occasion celebrated learners who successfully completed the National Certificate in Public Administration – Procurement Skills Programme. The event was graced by distinguished guests, including the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, the Chairperson of the PSCBC, Ms. Ingrid Dimo, and the Vice Chairpersons of both the PSCBC and GPSSBC, Mr. Mompoti Galorale and Mr. Modise Letsatsi.

In his address, Mr. De Bruin highlighted the critical role of skills development in enhancing service delivery within the public sector. He shared remarkable findings from research conducted on the programme, revealing that 80% of participants actively apply the skills they acquired in their daily work, while 87% reported an improvement in their job performance and understanding of their roles and responsibilities. These results underscore the programme's significant impact since its inception. Ms. Bontle Lerumo, CEO of PSETA, also spoke at the ceremony, addressing the pressing need for improved customer service skills in the public sector. She encouraged public servants to adopt and embody the Batho Pele Principles (Consultation, Service standards, Courtesy, Access, Information, Openness and transparency, Dealing with complaints, Giving best value for money) to enhance service delivery and better meet the needs of citizens.



PSCBC Showcases Commitment at POPCRU 2024 Central Executive Committee

Police and Prisons Civil Rights Union (POPCRU) hosted its Central Executive Committee (CEC) from 5–7 November 2024 at the Birchwood Hotel in Boksburg. The PSCBC proudly participated in this significant event which marked POPCRU's 35 years of championing the rights and struggles of workers and brought together key stakeholders under the theme: "Building a Sustainable Organization in Defense of Collective Bargaining."

The proceedings began with a powerful keynote address by Mr. Thulani Ngwenya, President of POPCRU, who reflected on the union's journey and the challenges it faces within an ever-changing political landscape. Mr. Ngwenya reaffirmed POPCRU's unwavering commitment to its theme, emphasizing the need to build sustainable organizational structures as a unifying force during the current term of office.

He underscored the pivotal role of collective bargaining in ensuring fair treatment, addressing workplace injustices, and fostering democracy. In the context of South Africa's criminal justice cluster, Mr. Ngwenya stressed that without collective bargaining, workers remain vulnerable to exploitation and poor working conditions.

As the event progressed, Mr. Ngwenya advocated for greater collaboration among stakeholders in the safety and security sector to combat crime and better support police officers. He proposed long-term strategies for crime prevention and policy development, urging the SAPS Secretariat to craft policies informed by the vision of the Minister of Police.

The CEC was further enriched by the presence of Honourable Thembi Simelane, former Minister of Justice, who highlighted the importance of effective policy implementation. She encouraged collaboration in enforcing criminal procedures, better budget management to improve workers' salaries, and the adoption of digital systems for financial reconciliation.

The PSCBC took pride in hosting an exhibition stand at the event, where it actively engaged with attendees and reaffirmed its dedication to strengthening labour relations. The platform allowed the PSCBC to share insights into its work and explore potential solutions to the challenges highlighted during the CEC. The event proved to be an invaluable opportunity for fostering dialogue, understanding the evolving dynamics of the labour sector, and reaffirming the shared commitment to improving the working conditions and lives of workers across South Africa.





General Masemola, National Commissioner of the South African Police Service (SAPS), echoed this sentiment, extending his support to SAPU. He assured delegates: "SAPS wishes you well, and as management of SAPS, we want you to know that you have our unreserved support in all your endeavors. We appreciate that SAPU has our members' best interests at heart."

The PSCBC actively participated in the event, hosting an exhibition stand that provided SAPU members with a platform to engage directly with the council. This interaction facilitated meaningful dialogue on workers' rights and welfare, underscoring the importance of collaboration between unions and stakeholders.

SAPU's 8th CEC was a resounding success, marking yet another milestone in the union's journey to advocate for servant leadership and champion the interests of its members. By embracing the PEELIA principles, SAPU continues to demonstrate its dedication to fostering a professional, accountable, and integrity-driven police service in South Africa.



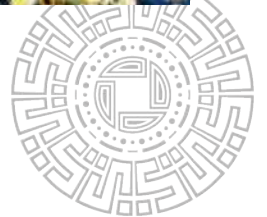
SAPU: 8th Central Executive Committee Meeting



The South African Policing Union (SAPU) successfully hosted its 8th Central Executive Committee (CEC) meeting from 20–21 November 2024 at the Sun City Convention Centre in the North West. Themed "Advocating for Servant Leadership: Collaborating with Stakeholders to Promote PEELIA (Professionalism, Education, Efficiency, Loyalty, Integrity, and Accountability) in Serving Our Members," the gathering brought together approximately 200 delegates to address critical issues impacting its members.

The agenda was guided by eight commissions, each focused on vital topics such as constitutional amendments, member benefits, and the promotion of the PEELIA principles. These discussions reaffirmed SAPU's unwavering commitment to servant leadership and its mission to enhance professionalism, efficiency, and integrity within the police service.

The event featured powerful messages from key stakeholders. Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, General Secretary of the PSCBC, emphasized the value of unity, stating; "Together, we are more than the sum of our parts. Together, we can achieve what may seem impossible alone. As we move forward, let us carry this spirit of unity, knowing that in solidarity, we can and will make a difference."



Provincial Chambers Annual General Meetings (AGM's)

The Provincial Chambers of the PSCBC serve as a as vital platforms for dialogue, consultation, and negotiation between public service departments and trade unions at the provincial level. The PSCBC convened its Provincial Chambers' Annual General Meeting's (AGM's) across all nine provinces in November 2024. These meetings provided a platform for council parties to reflect on the year's achievements, address challenges, and strategize for the future. The proceedings were led by the PSCBC's Collective Bargaining Unit and Dispute Management Unit, emphasizing the critical relationship between collective bargaining and dispute resolution in promoting labour peace and workplace stability within the public sector.

The sessions commenced with the Collective Bargaining team presenting a comprehensive overview of the 2023/24 financial year, including chamber management reports. Following this, the Dispute Management team underscored the importance of successfully enforcing key collective agreements. They specifically referenced; Resolution 03 of 2023, which ensures strict adherence to council-negotiated agreements and Resolution 01 of 2024, introducing updated rules for dispute resolution proceedings.

The team reported an increase in dispute referrals in the 2023/24 financial year compared to the previous period. Notably, 77% of these cases focused on the interpretation and application of collective agreements. This trend highlights the essential role of dispute management in fostering fairness and compliance. A significant highlight of the AGMs was the introduction of the new e-Referral System and the PSCBC Portal, both of which have modernized case management. These platforms offer real-time updates, access to case documents, and prompt rulings. By improving transparency and efficiency, they empower both employers and labour representatives to resolve matters effectively. The PSCBC team further emphasized the synergy between dispute management and collective bargaining. Together, these collaborative approaches ensure that agreements signed at the council are upheld, creating a stable and equitable work environment for all stakeholders.

Looking ahead, the PSCBC shared future plans, including; implementation of the Public Service Summit Declaration, preparations for the next salary negotiations and the expansion of training initiatives for council and chamber members.



The AGMs reaffirmed the power of collaboration and innovation in advancing the PSCBC's mandate. By embracing these principles, the public service is well-positioned to thrive in an ever-evolving labour environment.

Farewell to PEU General Secretary Ben Machipi

The Professional Educators' Union (PEU) recently bid farewell to its long-serving General Secretary, Ben Machipi, who retired after a distinguished career dedicated to advancing education and labour relations in public service. Mr. Machipi leaves behind a legacy of unwavering commitment to educators, learners, and the broader education sector, with contributions spanning decades of impactful service.

Mr. Machipi began his illustrious career in education in 1988 as a science teacher, where his passion for learning and leadership quickly became evident. He progressed through various key leadership roles, including Acting Head of Department and Principal of Pipa Primary School. In 2010, he joined the PEU full-time, marking the beginning of a new chapter as an advocate for educators' rights and a pioneer of innovative union management practices. During his tenure, Mr. Machipi led the PEU through critical national conversations on education policy. Notably, he played a significant role in addressing the challenges brought on by the COVID-19 pandemic, ensuring schools implemented safety measures while balancing the needs of learners and educators. He was equally vocal about systemic issues such as overcrowding in classrooms, advocating tirelessly for fairness, quality, and excellence in education delivery.



Batho Pele Excellence Awards: Celebrating Innovation and Service Excellence

The Department of Public Service and Administration (DPSA) hosted its prestigious Batho Pele Excellence Awards on 27th November 2024 in Ekurhuleni. For the first time, this grand celebration combined the Batho Pele Excellence Awards with the Public Sector Innovation Awards, showcasing the achievements of individuals and teams dedicated to exceptional public service and innovation.

The event brought together distinguished officials, including Honourable Minister for the Public Service and Administration (MPSA) Inkosi Mzamo Buthelezi, Deputy Minister Pinky Kekana, and Director-General Yoliswa Makhasi. Leading the ceremony, Minister Buthelezi emphasized the transformative role of innovation in enhancing public service delivery. He urged attendees to continue embracing creative approaches to build a more responsive and efficient public sector.

The evening's success was underscored by the Chairperson of the Batho Pele Adjudication Committee, Mr. Oomang Parag, Senior Manager for ICT at the PSCBC, who ensured a rigorous and fair selection process. Through extensive evaluations, field visits, and comprehensive reviews, the adjudication process highlighted the dedication and resilience of South Africa's public servants.

Mr. Parag shared inspiring stories of selflessness from officials patrolling communities at night to those using personal funds for critical supplies embodying the Batho Pele ethos of "Putting People First."

Ms. Ntshadi Mothusi, Chairperson of the CPSI Innovation Awards, further reinforced the importance of continuous improvement and digital transformation to address service delivery challenges. Both speakers reminded attendees of the collective responsibility to promote inclusive growth and bridge gaps within the public sector.



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The Batho Pele Excellence Awards not only celebrated remarkable achievements but also served as a powerful call to action. Public servants were encouraged to innovate, serve with dedication, and uphold the highest standards of integrity. The event was a poignant reminder that excellence in public service remains the cornerstone of building a stronger, more resilient South Africa.



PSCBC Case Law Webinar: Exploring Labour Court Judgement on Section 24 of the LRA

An engaging and informative webinar was hosted by the PSCBC on 25 November 2024, shedding light on a significant Labour Court judgement in *Skulpad and Another v Department of Health (EC) & Others* PR139/21. Delivered on 30 October 2024, the judgment addressed a pivotal question: Does Section 24 of the Labour Relations Act (LRA) strip employees of the right to independently refer a dispute outside of a trade union party to the collective agreement?

The event featured two interactive sessions morning and afternoon welcoming public servants, trade union officials, bargaining council representatives, commissioners, and members of the public. This platform provided attendees with an opportunity to unpack the judgment's implications for public sector labour relations and dispute resolution mechanisms.

The PSCBC General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, and Resident Panellist, Advocate Manus Netshifhefhe, delivered an in-depth overview of the case, examining the Labour Court's interpretation of Section 24 of the LRA. The session emphasized how the ruling impacts collective agreements and the rights of employees, balancing individual and collective interests within the labour framework.

Participants actively engaged through a dynamic chat-based Q&A session, posing thought-provoking questions on the interplay between individual disputes and collective agreements. The discussion provided much-needed clarity on Section 24's limits and protections while underscoring its role in maintaining the integrity of collective bargaining.

The webinar highlighted this judgment as a milestone in defining the rights of employees and unions within the collective bargaining structure. It reinforced the PSCBC's commitment to fostering workplace democracy and labour peace by empowering stakeholders with valuable insights and tools to navigate evolving challenges in modern labour relations.

By hosting such platforms, the PSCBC continues to solidify its role as a thought leader in public sector labour relations, equipping stakeholders to address complex legal and practical challenges in the workplace.



PSCBC Debriefing Session

The 2025/2026 Public Service wage negotiations commenced in August 2024, incorporating a facilitated process from 8-10 October 2024. These negotiations culminated in two collective agreements signed on 20 January 2025. The first agreement outlined salary adjustments and improved conditions of service for the next three financial years (2025/2026, 2026/2027, and 2027/2028), while the second agreement focused on matters requiring further research and negotiation in the 2025/2026 financial year.

As mandated by PSCBC Resolution 02 of 2024, a debriefing session was held to evaluate the negotiation process and identify areas for improvement. The session took place from 11 to 14 March 2025, bringing together Organised Labour and the State as the Employer in the negotiation process.

The session was aimed at highlight strengths and identify areas requiring refinement. After a plenary session opening, the facilitator Mr Livhu Nengovhela, provided insights into debriefing methodologies and their benefits. He highlighted the importance of structured debriefing in enhancing collective bargaining processes. Various debriefing models were explored, all underscoring the necessity for ongoing improvement in wage negotiations.

Subsequently the PSCBC General Secretary, Mr Frikkie De Bruin, outlined key negotiation objectives and areas warranting further attention. He focused on four key areas; the negotiations cycle, the issue of information sharing pre-negotiations, the negotiations and post negotiations stages. Parties then engaged in caucus discussions, culminating in individual presentations by labour and employer representatives.

Employer representatives, Ms. Maggie Mogale and Ms. Thokozile Mkhonto, presented an assessment of progress. Progress made on 12 identified concerns, though information leaks remain a challenge. Eight new strategies were integrated into negotiations, but further training of negotiators on the Code of Conduct is needed. Eleven key practices continued, with a focus on better defining the roles of Facilitators and the Chairperson. Moving forward, an enforceable Code of Conduct and Practice Manual needs to be developed, alongside ongoing fiscal analysis updates, and pre-negotiation briefings by independent researchers on economic outlooks. Regular Council updates will also be implemented to address information leaks.

Labour representative Ms. Masedi Lonkokile highlighted key aspects of the negotiation process, emphasizing labour's unity in securing two agreements. The three-month negotiation period was deemed too short and required reassessment. Recommendations included developing an economic outlook document by the Office of the General Secretary, implementing induction and capacity-building programs for negotiators, and enhancing communication within the 8-a-side strategy. Regular employer updates on agreement implementation and trust-building initiatives were also suggested to strengthen collaboration.

The negotiation cycle takeaways include; the need for ongoing employer feedback on agreement implementation, targeted negotiator training based on a needs analysis, and regular updates to curb information leaks. A review of the three-month negotiation timeline was also recommended to allow sufficient deliberation. The maturity of Public Service wage negotiations was acknowledged, with a commitment to further progress. The debriefing session proved valuable in fostering continuous improvement, laying the groundwork for more effective future negotiations.



DENOSA Western Cape Provincial 9th Congress

The Democratic Nursing Organisation of South Africa (DENOSA) Western Cape held its 9th Provincial Congress from 15 to 17 January 2025. The PSCBC was honoured to be invited to exhibit and deliver a message of support at this important gathering.

Representing the PSCBC, Mr. Oomang Parag, Senior Manager ICT, addressed the Congress, emphasizing the need for unity, innovation, and practical solutions to meet the evolving demands of the nursing profession. He highlighted that collaboration, solidarity, and effective negotiation remain the foundation of collective success in advancing the interests of healthcare workers. "Together, we can champion decent work and improved working conditions for Nurses while strengthening the overall health of our communities," he stated.

The PSCBC remains committed to supporting initiatives that enhance the well-being and professional growth of nurses across South Africa.



Strategic Staff Operational Plan

The PSCBC hosted its annual strategic planning session from 05 to 07 February 2025. The session, facilitated by the General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin, brought together staff members from the various departments of the organisation for a focused and engaging programme.

The purpose of the session was to workshop the Council's revised policies and to develop operational plans for the 2024/2025 financial year. Key discussions centred around several strategic documents and policies, with a strong emphasis on alignment, efficiency, and the implementation of stretch targets designed to drive performance within the organisation.

Staff actively participated in in-depth discussions aimed at clearly defining strategic priorities and objectives. These engagements played a vital role in enhancing the Council's operational effectiveness and fostering a culture of collaboration and synergy across departments.

To further strengthen team cohesion, the programme included team-building activities and interactive games. These activities created a dynamic and positive atmosphere, promoting unity, strengthening interpersonal relationships, and reinforcing a shared vision for the future of the Council.

The strategic planning session was a resounding success, marked by productive engagements, valuable insights, and a renewed collective commitment to the PSCBC's vision and mission. The Council remains steadfast in its dedication to continuous improvement, good governance, and the implementation of policies that support and drive meaningful progress.



Government Employee Medical Aid Scheme (GEMS) Strategic Engagement Workshop

On 25 February 2025, the PSCBC held a strategic engagement workshop in Pretoria, led by the General Secretary, Mr. Frikkie De Bruin. The session focused on presenting and discussing the findings of two comprehensive GEMS Review surveys, conducted in 2022 and 2025. These surveys aimed to assess whether the Government Employees Medical Scheme (GEMS) remains aligned with its founding principles of providing equitable access to quality healthcare and affordable medical coverage for public servants. The workshop served as a crucial platform for sharing insights, highlighting challenges, and engaging stakeholders on the state of the GEMS scheme, particularly amid growing concerns over its affordability.

Presenting the survey results, Mr. De Bruin outlined key issues experienced by members of the scheme. A significant finding revealed that 58.54% of respondents perceive the scheme as unaffordable, with many citing financial strain when accessing healthcare services. Additionally, the surveys indicated that GEMS do not consistently offer value for money across all its benefit options.

Mr. De Bruin also referenced the transformation of GEMS, as guided by PSCBC Resolution 04 of 2017, reaffirming the importance of adhering to the founding principles that bind the scheme as per the PSCBC Resolution.

GEMS was afforded the opportunity to respond to the findings. The Principal Officer of GEMS, Dr. Stan Moloabi, provided a contextual overview of the scheme's establishment, referencing relevant PSCBC resolutions and the Summit Declaration. Addressing the controversial 13% increase in medical aid contributions, Dr. Moloabi explained that the hike was driven partly by members who temporarily add dependants to access healthcare services, this is an issue that results in cost inefficiencies and financial strain on the scheme. He further cited the high expenditure GEMS incurred during the COVID-19 pandemic as a contributing factor, noting that past increases of 2% and 5% were insufficient to maintain the scheme's financial health.

"If the 13% increase is not implemented, the scheme will face bankruptcy," Dr. Moloabi stated. However, he reassured attendees that GEMS remains committed to working closely with the PSCBC to ensure that the scheme stays both accessible and affordable to its members.

The strategic engagement also included remarks from key stakeholders, Mr. Mompoti Galorale, Vice Chairperson (Employer), emphasised the importance of strengthening the relationship between the employer, labour, and GEMS. He underscored the need for continued alignment among the three stakeholders to achieve shared objectives.

Echoing this sentiment, Mr. Aubrey Zungu, Vice Chairperson (Labour), noted that labour's continued support of GEMS hinges on the scheme's commitment to its founding principles and prioritisation of public servants. "For GEMS to earn the trust and backing of its members, it must demonstrate value and act in the best interests of public servants," he stated.

The PSCBC remains resolute in its mission to advocate for improved working conditions and social benefits for public servants through constructive dialogue and strategic partnerships. This engagement is one of many platforms through which the Council continues to drive accountability, transparency, and progress in support of its members.



NUPSAW's 2ND National General Council (NGC)



Mr. Frikkie De Bruin delivered a well-received message of support, encouraging NUPSAW members to remain true to their guiding principle, "Workers First," and to continue strengthening their voice within the bargaining council space. He acknowledged the significance of 21 February as Armed Forces Day, paying tribute to the 14 South African National Defence Force (SANDF) members who lost their lives during a peacekeeping mission in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC).

Commending NUPSAW for reaching this important milestone, Mr. De Bruin highlighted the union's vital role in the public service sector. Through collective bargaining, legal advocacy, and solidarity, NUPSAW continues to champion fair labour practices, job security, and improved living standards for its members. He also recognised the union's remarkable growth, with membership figures reaching an impressive 54,765.

In closing, Mr. De Bruin wished NUPSAW well in its deliberations and expressed hope that the union would emerge more united and energised, ready to continue its mission over the next 27 years and beyond—building a professional, empowered workforce that contributes to economic stability and social justice. The PSCBC's newly established Trade Union Management Unit (TUMU) also participated in the event, exhibiting and engaging with attendees. As part of its mandate, TUMU plays a vital role in capacitating, training, and promoting trade unions admitted to the Council—supporting sound labour relations and the empowerment of workers across the public sector.



PSCBC Webinar on Case Laws

On 27th of February 2025, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council hosted a two-sessions webinar for 09:00am and 16:00pm. The webinar focused on significant case laws with the primary objective to provide an in-depth analysis and interpretation of topical labour law cases, equipping attendees with valuable insights on current case laws.

The webinar was facilitated by the PSCBC Senior Resident Panelist, Advocate Mbulaheni Netshifhefhe, and the Resident Panelist, Ms. Cyla Kok.

The webinar focused on the following case laws:

- SACOSWU obo Brian Kasper v Minister of Justice and Correctional Services
- Tshabalala v Moqhaka Local Municipality and Others
- Qholomosha v Education Labour Relations Council and Others
- SAMWU obo Koopman v City of Cape Town and Others



The sessions were a resounding success as it received 244 attendees out of 317 people who registered to attend the webinar. The two sessions were met with overwhelming participation from attendees. The PSCBC will continue to impart knowledge on labour law to ensure that public servants are well equipped with information.

PSCBC Mourns the Loss of Chairperson Ms Ingrid Dimo

On the 2nd of March 2025, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) awoke to the heartbreaking news of the passing of its esteemed Chairperson, Ms Ingrid Dimo. In remembrance of her life and legacy, the PSCBC hosted a heartfelt memorial service that brought together a broad spectrum of dignitaries and stakeholders.

The memorial service was attended by representatives from the Employer and Labour parties, the PSCBC, various Sector Bargaining Councils, the Commission for Conciliation, Mediation and Arbitration (CCMA), the National Bargaining Council for the Chemical Industry (NBCCI), and other key partners in the labour sector. Their presence was a testament to the profound impact Ms Dimo had across the labour relations community.

In his address, PSCBC General Secretary Mr Frikkie De Bruin reflected on Ms Dimo's historic appointment in 2018 as the first female Chairperson of the PSCBC. Her nomination was unanimous—a recognition of her exceptional ability to lead with wisdom, grace, and a steadfast commitment to fairness. Under her guidance, the Council experienced great strides in fostering unity and cooperation among parties.



Several speakers during the memorial service echoed these sentiments, paying tribute to Ms Dimo's courage, humility, and deep dedication to the labour movement. She was celebrated not only as a skilled negotiator but also as a tireless advocate for women's rights. Her efforts to mentor and empower the next generation of women leaders were an integral part of her legacy.

It was clear from the tributes shared that Ms Ingrid Dimo's influence reached far beyond the Council chambers. Her life's work in collective bargaining and dispute resolution has left an indelible mark on the labour relations landscape of South Africa.

Her warmth, wisdom, and unwavering passion for justice and equality will continue to inspire all who had the honour of working alongside her. The PSCBC honours her memory and will carry forward her legacy with pride and gratitude.

May her beautiful and resilient soul rest in perfect peace!!

Hamba Kahle Mme Ingrid Dimo!!

DENOSA 9th National Congress

The PSCBC was honoured to attend and support the 9th Democratic Nursing Organisation of South Africa (DENOSA) Congress, which took place from the 25th-28th of March 2025 at Birchwood Hotel in Boksburg, Johannesburg, Gauteng. This congress was held under the theme “Promoting Organisational Growth Through Innovative Practices towards Resilient Quality Healthcare and Effective Member Servicing”.

The Congress focused on several emerging critical issues affecting its members and the broader healthcare sector such as, the implementation of the National Health Insurance (NHI), Post-COVID-19 Healthcare Landscape, Nurses’ Wages and Working Conditions, Global Healthcare Policy Shifts and Mental Health and Wellness of Healthcare Professionals.

The Congress was well attended, with representation from several esteemed dignitaries, including the President of the Republic of South Africa, Honourable Cyril Matamela Ramaphosa, the Secretary-General of the African National Congress (ANC), Comrade Fikile Mbalula, the Minister of Health – Dr. Aaron Motsoaledi, the leadership of the Congress of South African Trade Unions (COSATU), the South African Communist Party (SACP), the General Secretary of PSCBC Mr Frikkie De Bruin, international guests, and other key allies of DENOSA.



President Cyril Ramaphosa engaged with members at the Congress, urging DENOSA to take the lead in critical discussions on skilling and training within the healthcare system. He expressed his delight that the Congress will tackle key healthcare matters, ensuring the progress in strengthening the sector for both nurses and communities. This aligned with the Congress as DENOSA stands firm and more determined to champion the rights of nurses and advocate for improvements in the healthcare fraternity.

The PSCBC under the leadership of Mr Frikkie De Bruin extended their message of support congratulating the newly elected leadership of DENOSA, comprising of President Simon Hlungwani, 1st Deputy President Simphiwe Daniel Gada, 2nd Deputy President Linah Jiyane, National Treasurer Linda Eustacia Katz-Hulana, General Secretary Kwena Daniel Manamela, Deputy General Secretary (Operations) Dimakatso Sebopa and Deputy General Secretary –(Membership) Khaya Sodidi.

The PSCBC further hosted an exhibition for 2 days during the congress to promote the Council’s scope and actively engaged with the 490 delegates that were present, representing 87,000 nurses across all nine provinces. The council expressed deep appreciation to the leadership of DENOSA for an opportunity to engage with their members. The involvement of the PSCBC in the congress reflects its commitment to engaging with stakeholders and supportive bargaining efforts.



Corporate Social Responsibility Initiatives

School Shoes and Sanitary Towel Drive

As part of the Corporate Social Responsibility programme, the PSCBC under the leadership of the General Secretary Frikkie De Bruin, donated school shoes and sanitary towels to Gatang Secondary School in Mamelodi.

The school shoes and sanitary towel were officially handed over to the school management on the 9th of September 2024. This initiative began with an online call for school shoe donations, with the primary aim to support learners from disadvantaged backgrounds and to ensure that learners can be able to focus on their education without having to worry about social challenges. The drive yielded to donating 103 pairs of shoes and 500 sanitary towels.

The school principal expressed his profound gratitude and appreciation to the PSCBC noting that their contribution will make a positive impact on the learners. The overall drive was a success, providing needed support and making a positive impact by instilling hope and confidence among learners. The PSCBC remains committed to fostering support and building a better learning environment.



Mandela Commemoration at Little Rose Centre, Eldorado Park



In honour of Nelson Mandela's enduring legacy and as part of its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) program, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) commemorated Mandela's memory on December 5, 2024, through a heartfelt initiative supporting the Little Rose Centre in Kliptown, Soweto. This initiative was a testament to the values of unity, compassion, and service that Nelson Mandela championed throughout his life.

The Little Rose Centre, a non-profit organisation dedicated to meeting the basic needs of children in and around Kliptown, shares a mission to uplift vulnerable children and families—an ethos that resonates closely with PSCBC's vision of creating meaningful, sustainable change in underserved communities.

The day was brimming with purpose and joy as PSCBC staff worked hand in hand to bring hope and happiness to the children at the Centre. A warm and nourishing meal was prepared and served to 200 children, a gesture of care that encapsulated the spirit of the day. Each child also received a party pack, sparking smiles and adding excitement to the celebration. Adding to the festivities were the children's energetic dance performances, a vivid reminder of the resilience and vibrancy of the community and the power of togetherness.

A highlight of the day was a message of support delivered by Senior Manager for ICT, Mr. Oomang Parag, on behalf of the General Secretary of the PSCBC, Mr. Frikke de Bruin. Mr. Parag expressed the Council's deep honour in participating in this meaningful occasion and reflected on the importance of service, unity, and compassion values embodied by Nelson Mandela and echoed in the PSCBC's ongoing commitment to community upliftment.

As the PSCBC continues its journey of impactful engagement, it remains dedicated to investing in initiatives that create meaningful change. By supporting organisations like the Little Rose Centre, the PSCBC reaffirms its commitment to building a brighter, more inclusive future for all.



PSCBC Donates Stationery to ML Lethabo Children's home

Demonstrating its ongoing commitment to uplifting underprivileged communities, the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) donated school stationery and toys to the ML Lethabo Children's Home on 27 January 2025. This initiative forms part of the PSCBC's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) programme, which aims to build stronger communities and promote access to education and development.

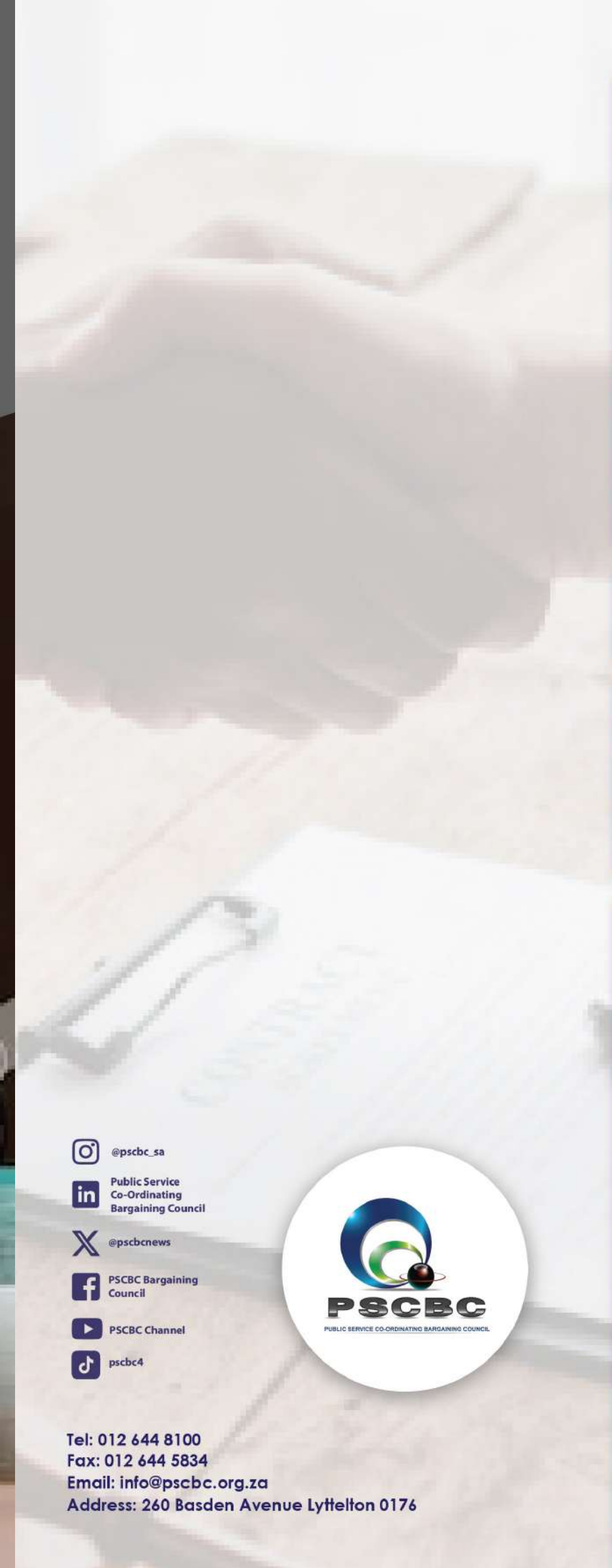
The donation helped provide essential learning materials to the children at the centre, ensuring they are better equipped with the tools they need to pursue academic success. The contribution not only addressed practical needs but also brought smiles, excitement, and hope to the young beneficiaries.

The donation was officially handed over by PSCBC Chairperson Ms. Ingrid Dimo, whose steadfast dedication to community development continues to inspire meaningful change. The PSCBC remains devoted to initiatives that create lasting impact in disadvantaged communities. By continuing to support education, empowerment, and social well-being, the Council reaffirms its commitment to making a difference where it matters most.



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